



Scammers don't take summer vacations.

Be alert and stay one step ahead of all seasonal scams.



Scam Pehchano, Mauka Ganwao.



Make the most of your summer with Google's built-in security, keeping your travel, shopping, and payments worry-free.



99.9%
spam automatically
blocked.



Google Pay

5.2 crore
warnings displayed for
transactions suspected to be scams.



Google Play
Protect

6 crore
attempts to install high-risk apps
blocked.

Scam Pehchano, Mauka Ganwao.



Government of Bihar

Viksit Bharat - Samriddha Bihar
Building the Future of Industrial India



India's Next Industrial Growth Engine

From the Land of Legacy to the Land of Limitless
 Opportunities — Bihar is Ready for Industry



SO... WHY BIHAR?

All clearances to be completed within 30 days



ROBUST INFRASTRUCTURE FOR INDUSTRIAL GROWTH

- 14,600+ acres of new industrial land
- 95 industrial areas with plug-and-play infrastructure
- 31 lakh sq. ft. ready sheds
- Industrial facilities with 24x7 power, water, roads & security
- Competitive lease rentals starting as low as ₹4/sq ft



POWERING INDUSTRY 24x7

- 24x7 reliable power supply with dedicated industrial feeders
- Rapid adoption of smart metering & energy infrastructure



UNMATCHED CONNECTIVITY & LOGISTICS ADVANTAGE

- Airports are operational in Patna, Gaya, Purnea and Darbhanga
- Airports are under construction in Supaul, West Champaran, Saharsa, Muzaffarpur, Gopalganj, and East Champaran
- Emerging as a multi-modal logistics hub with ICD Bihta & MMLP, Patna



EASE OF DOING BUSINESS – REDEFINED

- Single Window Clearance System
- Approvals like CTE/CTO within 12 days
- Digital processes, investor facilitation & dedicated nodal support
- simplified labour policies & compliance systems



ABUNDANT WATER RESOURCES

- Industrial-grade water availability across key clusters
- Inland waterways boosting sustainable logistics



ATTRACTIVE POLICIES & INCENTIVES

- Land Allotment & Management Policy 2026
- Bihar Industrial Investment Promotion Package 2025
- Biofuel Production Promotion policy 2025
- Bihar Semiconductor Policy 2026
- Bihar GCC Policy 2026
- BIADA Amnesty Policy, 2025
- Bihar RE Policy 2025
- Export Promotion Policy 2024
- Bihar Logistics Policy 2024
- Textile & Leather Policy 2022
- Startup Policy 2022



STRATEGIC PROJECTS DRIVING GROWTH

- Bihar Integrated Manufacturing City Gaya Limited (BIMCGL)
 - 1,670 acres | ₹16,000+ crore potential
 - 1 lakh+ employment opportunity
- Mega Food Park, Muzaffarpur
- Mega Leather Footwear & Accessories Cluster, Mahwal, Muzaffarpur
- SEZs at Buxar & Bettiah
- Strong push in logistics, food processing, manufacturing & new-age sectors



COST ADVANTAGE + HIGH RETURNS

- Lower cost of land, labour & operations
- High growth domestic market access
- Strategic location connecting North, East & Northeast India



BIHAR OFFERS MORE THAN OPPORTUNITY —
 IT OFFERS SCALE, SPEED & SUSTAINABILITY

#BIHARHAITAIYAR

For More Information Call Toll Free No **18003456214**



A firefighter at the site of an Israeli airstrike in the southern port city of Sidon, Lebanon, on Wednesday. REUTERS

‘Israeli spy’ enters Ukraine embassy, Lebanon in a tizzy

Associated Press
Beirut, June 10

AS ISRAELI warplanes pounded Beirut’s southern suburbs last March and residents fled in panic, one man found his opportunity. Amid the chaos, he slipped out of his imprisonment in a Hezbollah cell and made his way to the green hills overlooking the Lebanese capital.

There, in the posh diplomatic quarter of Baabda, he disappeared inside the gates of the Ukrainian Embassy. Where he is now is a mystery, tangled up in an ongoing spy game as Hezbollah attempts to root out Israeli intelligence operatives that have infiltrated the militant group.

The man identified by Lebanese officials as Khaled al-Aydi is said to be a Palestinian refugee from Syria who also holds Ukrainian citizenship. He had been detained by Hezbollah in the Beirut suburbs and accused by Lebanese officials of being part of a thwarted Israeli intelligence plot to carry out bombings and assassinations.

Details of al-Aydi’s escape and a Lebanese military court’s case against him were provided by three judicial officials and two senior security officials in Lebanon who spoke on condition of anonymity. A senior political official in Hezbollah also provided details.

Al-Aydi’s disappearance could have political implications for the Lebanese government, which has largely remained silent about the case.

If evidence were to emerge al-Aydi escaped Lebanon with help from government, it could inflame tensions with Hezbollah’s largely Shi’ite Muslim base.

The government already faces scrutiny for directly negotiating with Israel, which has been engaged in fierce fighting with Hezbollah since the early days of the Iran war. The Ukrainian Embassy asked Lebanese authorities in March to facilitate al-Aydi’s departure from the country after he escaped Hezbollah detention.

Tit-for-tat attacks come after US chopper downed

Reuters
Dubai, Washington, June 10

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Wednesday that the United States is going to attack Iran “very hard” if no peace deal is finalized, and announced the US has been taking oil out of Iran.

“We’re going to be attacking them, attacking them very hard,” Trump told reporters at the White House, citing Iran’s downing of an Apache helicopter in the Strait of Hormuz.

The president reiterated that Iran will be hit on Wednesday. Trump also revealed that the US has been taking oil out of Iran. “I’m just announcing today for the first time, but we’ve been taking out millions of barrels of oil, millions of barrels every night,” Trump said, adding that Iran “just figured it out.”

“Millions of barrels of oil has come out, and that’s why it’s at \$85-90 a barrel, instead of \$250,” Trump said, sharing no other details about these operations. Trump said he is still looking to make a deal.

“We want a deal that is meaningful, we want a deal that works,” Trump added.

Trump said that Iran has already agreed to not obtaining a nuclear weapon, but the agreement still needs to be signed.

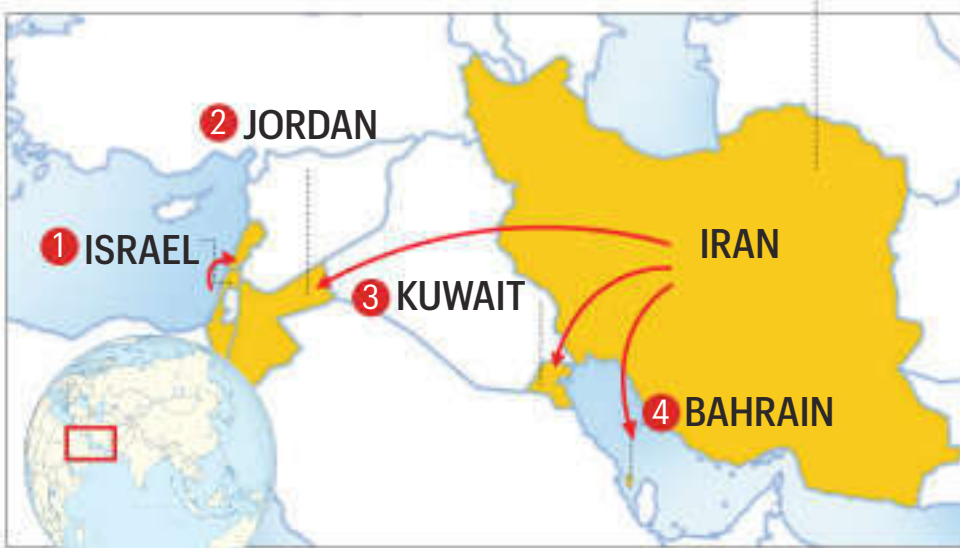
• FROM DE-ESCALATION TO ESCALATION



The US struck southern Iran, calling it a response to the downing of a US helicopter.



Iran said it retaliated by attacking US assets in the region.



1. ISRAEL said it was continuing strikes in Lebanon

2. JORDAN said it intercepted five missiles launched from Iran

3. KUWAIT said its air defenses intercepted hostile targets

4. BAHRAIN said it intercepted several Iranian drones and missiles.

Iran launched missile and drone attacks on US bases in Jordan, Kuwait and Bahrain in what it called retaliation for American strikes on Iranian targets around the Strait of Hormuz. The exchange of fire marks one of the most significant escalations since Washington and Tehran agreed to a ceasefire in April.

“Iran is all talk and no action,” Trump said in a social media post earlier on Wednesday. “They’ve taken too long to negotiate a deal that would have been great for them, now they

will have to pay the price!!!” Iran’s Gulf neighbours and Jordan activated air defences to intercept incoming missiles. Asked about Iran’s attacks on American bases, a US official told Reuters: “No significant damage. No harm to US personnel. Nearly all missiles and drones were intercepted or failed to reach their intended target.”

Meanwhile, Iran’s Foreign Ministry spokesperson said Tehran would reassess diplomatic engagement with Washington after what it called repeated ceasefire violations. “Any

diplomatic process requires a minimum stable environment,” Esmaeil Baghaei said.

Asked about Trump’s comments, Abolfazl Shekarchi, a senior spokesperson for Iran’s armed forces, said the country had proven it would respond appropriately to all threats.

Despite the belligerent language from both sides, there were signs of continuing diplomatic efforts. A delegation from Qatar, which has been mediating between the US and Iran, landed in Tehran on Wednesday to hold talks on the latest developments, Iran media reported.

The US strikes overnight lasted about four hours. Iran’s Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) said Qeshm Island and the port of Sirik were attacked. Iranian media also reported explosions in Bandar Abbas, another port city, and later near Jask at the entrance to the Strait of Hormuz.

On Wednesday, two crew members of a tanker were missing and another injured after what British maritime security company Ambrey described as a suspected missile strike by US forces imposing their blockade of Iran-related shipping.

The IRGC said it had responded to the US attacks by attacking its bases in Bahrain, Kuwait and Jordan with drones and missiles. Jordan’s military said it had intercepted five missiles launched toward al-Azraq, and that falling debris caused no injuries or damage.

Erdogan: Israel’s attacks on Syria and Lebanon a threat to Turkey as well

Reuters
Ankara, June 10



“The attacks by (Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu) and his network of murder on Lebanon and Syria have brought the issue to a point where it also threatens Turkey”

TAYYIP ERDOGAN, PRESIDENT OF TURKEY

TURKISH PRESIDENT Tayyip Erdogan said on Wednesday that Israel’s attacks on Syria and Lebanon had reached a point where they also threaten Turkey, adding Israel’s “aggression” posed a threat to the whole world and must be stopped.

NATO member Turkey has been one of the fiercest critics of Israel’s assaults on Iran, Gaza, and Lebanon, saying Israel was the biggest obstacle to regional peace. It has halted all trade with Israel and called for measures against it at international courts.

“The attacks by (Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu) and his network of murder on Lebanon and Syria have brought the issue to a point where it also threatens Turkey,” Erdogan told lawmakers from his ruling AK Party in parliament, and added that Ankara’s security was tied to that of these two countries.

Erdogan also said Israel was leading a “sneaky effort” to destabilise African countries and the Mediterranean by igniting “the fire of discord” on the ethnically-split island of Cyprus.

“These small entities, whose ambitions far exceed

their size, have boarded Israel’s boat of mischief, taken on the role of Zionist subcontractors, and are pursuing some pipe dreams in the Eastern Mediterranean,” he said.

Turkey, Iran’s neighbour, has blamed Israel’s “provocations” for starting the US-Iran war.

Gunmen kill 12, injure nine in South Africa mass shooting

Associated Press
Johannesburg, June 10

A GROUP of armed attackers drove into a poor neighborhood in South Africa’s biggest city, got out of a minivan and opened fire at residents in a late-night attack in Johannesburg that killed 12 people and wounded at least nine, police said Wednesday.

The attack unfolded late on Tuesday night in an informal settlement in the city’s Cleveland suburb, police said, adding that there were at least 10 suspected attackers who later fled the scene.

Johannesburg has long been the scene of organized crime gangs vying for control of illegal mining or other activities, though police said the motive of the latest shooting was still under investigation.

Police said the shooters were dropped off at the settlement in a minibus “and moved through the area, opening fire on residents and community members at multiple locations



Residents gather at the scene of the incident in Cleveland, Johannesburg on Wednesday. AP

before fleeing the scene.” The victims were nine men and three women, according to

police. Eleven died at the scene and another died in hospital.

Police said a search was launched for the suspects and the vehicle but that no arrests had been made.

Provincial police commissioner Tommy Mthombeni called the killings “insane, heartless and, to a certain extent, barbaric.” He said it was too early to link them to illegal mining gangs as an investigation was underway, but police were considering that as a possible motive.

He said a recent police operation in the area had confiscated illegal firearms, including assault rifles, and illegal miners were known to operate there.

Ambulances were on the scene on Wednesday morning to carry away the victims’ bodies while community members huddled in groups on the streets. Informal settlements in South Africa are unplanned residential areas that are common in and around big cities where people looking for housing live in shacks or other makeshift structures. Illegal miners sometimes operate in the same areas.

South Africa has seen several high-profile mass shootings recently, including two in December that killed more than 20 people. One of those attacks also involved multiple shooters.

Mass shootings in South Africa are connected to criminal gangs. In Johannesburg, gangs are involved in illicit mining in and around a city that has large gold reserves and many mines that have been abandoned.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Bill Gates says meeting Epstein was ‘grave error in judgment’



Bill Gates at the annual Gates Foundation Summit in Manhattan. FILE

BILL GATES said Wednesday that he made a “grave error in judgment” by ever meeting with Jeffrey Epstein as the Microsoft co-founder faced questions behind closed doors from lawmakers about his relationship with the disgraced financier. In an opening statement provided to *The Associated Press*, Gates said he “should never have met with Epstein in the first place,” but that he “never witnessed nor had any indication that Epstein was engaged in ongoing criminal conduct.” The tech billionaire became the latest powerful figure linked to Epstein to testify before the House Oversight Committee. As Gates arrived at the Capitol, he noted that he was there voluntarily and said: “I hope my testimony is helpful to the work, the important work, of the committee, to find justice for victims.” REUTERS

Pak army chopper crashes in PoK, all on board killed

Islamabad: An Mi-17 helicopter of the Pakistan Army Aviation crashed near Muzaffarabad in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir on Wednesday, killing all personnel on board, the army said. “There were no survivors,” the Inter-Services Public Relations (ISPR), the media wing of the Pakistan military, said, without giving the number of those killed.

In a brief statement, it said that the accident occurred “during take-off due to a technical fault”. Rescue and recovery teams immediately reached the crash site. A board of inquiry has been ordered to ascertain the exact cause of the accident.

Chief of Defence Forces a Asim Munir “expresses deep grief over the tragic loss of precious lives and extend heartfelt condolences to the bereaved families”, the ISPR said. PTI

Anti-immigrant protests erupt in Belfast after knife attack; Sudan man held

Reuters
Belfast, June 10

MASKED MEN burned families out of their homes in Belfast and torched a number of vehicles in a wave of anti-immigrant violence on Tuesday night that followed a knife attack for which a Sudanese man appeared in court charged with attempted murder.

Hundreds of protesters, many with their faces covered, attacked police and burned vehicles in a number of locations across Northern Ireland after a video of the attack, in which the victim lost an eye, went viral.

Political leaders said the violence was aimed at ethnic minorities. “It is clear that people were targeted last night because of their background and

I will not tolerate it,” British Prime Minister Keir Starmer said in a statement.

“Those responsible will feel the full force of the law.” The suspect in the attack in north Belfast, a 30-year-old Sudanese national named as Hadi Aلودid, appeared in court on Wednesday where he was remanded in custody.

The victim, in his 40s, suffered significant injuries to his face and back, the court heard.

Videos of the attack circulated online all day on Tuesday, sparking calls for violent protest on social media. Police had to help one family escape from a burning house.

“There can be no excuse and no justification for these attacks,” Northern Ireland’s First Minister Michelle O’Neill said.



Taiwan Tests HIMARS Rockets

Taiwan’s High Mobility Artillery Rocket Systems (HIMARS) during a live military exercise, which simulates an enemy invasion, in Taichung, Taiwan, on Wednesday. REUTERS

TAIWAN’S MILITARY Wednesday fired its new HIMARS rocket system, simulating an attack on an invading Chinese force and demonstrating its “shoot-and-scoot” ability to evade counterstrikes.

THE MILITARY said the drill was to demonstrate the HIMARS’ mobility and ability to “shoot-and-scoot” — withdrawing after firing to avoid enemy radar — so as to “greatly improve battlefield survivability”.

HIMARS IS one of Ukraine’s main strike systems and has been used multiple times during the war with Russia. With a range of 300 kms it could strike targets in China’s southeastern province. REUTERS

• PRESIDENT RUTO OF KENYA ACCUSED OF BOWING TO U.S. INTERESTS, RISKING KENYAN LIVES BY LETTING AMERICAN PATIENTS INTO THE COUNTRY WHEN THEY ARE BEING BARRED FROM THE UNITED STATES

Ebola unit for infected Americans sparks fury, protests, political crisis in Kenya

Matthew Mpoke Bigg & Eric Schmitt
Nairobi, Washington, June 10

THE US plan to open an Ebola quarantine facility in Kenya was meant to help contain the outbreak by isolating American patients exposed to the virus.

Instead, it has caused an outbreak of violence and political rancor, with hundreds of Kenyans taking to the streets in protest. Last month, Secretary of State Marco Rubio said that no Ebola patients would be allowed to enter the United States after the World Health Organization announced a dangerous outbreak in Congo. Rubio later appeared to soften that stance.

US government officials later told reporters that the Trump administration planned to send to Kenya all US citizens exposed to the virus, rather than bring them home. The Americans would be observed and treated at a 50-bed quarantine unit exclusively for them, set up at Laikipia Air Base in central Kenya, the officials said.

The outcry in Kenya has been fierce.

Hundreds of people have marched through the streets of Nanyuki, the town closest to the air base, to protest the facility. Police have used tear gas to disperse crowds, and at least three protesters have been shot and killed, according to the

Kenya Human Rights Commission. The Kenyan police did not respond to a request for comment Tuesday.

Critics of President William Ruto of Kenya accuse him of bowing to US interests and risking Kenyan lives by letting exposed American patients into the country when they are being barred from the United States. Others have asked why Kenya, which has never recorded an Ebola case, would agree to host the unit when US government officials say Kenyans would be excluded from receiving treatment there.

“We are utterly disgusted by the government’s apparent willingness to trade national



People gather to protest a US-backed Ebola quarantine plan in Nanyuki, Kenya, on Wednesday. REUTERS

biosecurity and the lives of its citizens for foreign aid,” the Kenya Medical Practitioners,

Pharmacists and Dentists Union said in a statement. The full details of the agree-

ment between the United States and Kenya have not been made public. But a US official told *The New York Times* that talks were still continuing when US government officials told reporters about the plan.

In a comment to the *Times*, the State Department said it planned to provide transportation for Americans to the Ebola unit but made no reference to whether Kenyans would be admitted.

Kenya’s High Court temporarily suspended the unit from opening last week, after a legal challenge brought by the Katiba Institute, a civil society organization. The court ordered the Kenyan government

to disclose the terms of its deal with the United States by Tuesday. It also said it would set a date for the next hearing on the case June 23.

Despite the court suspension and the protests, a second US official said that US Africa Command was still at work building out the unit at the air base as recently as Saturday, and that around 300 US troops from Djibouti, Europe and the US were helping to erect large tents and set up specialized medical equipment to treat Ebola patients.

The official, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss operational matters, said that the facility could

eventually hold up to 250 patients and that the State Department was coordinating with several Americans who are seeking to leave Congo, but whose exposure to the virus has not yet been determined.

The US military has continued the work on the unit because Ruto’s government has not told it to stop, the official said. Work on the facility was on hold Tuesday because of the protests, the official said.

Dr Mehmet Oz, a top federal health official in the United States, told journalists at the White House last week that the State Department would “be able to work out something with Kenya.” NYT



Thank You

Prime Minister

Shri Narendra Modi

for building a new India and leading the nation on the path of progress.

12 *Vishwas ke,
Vikas ke,
Saal Jan-kalyan ke*



"These 12 years have been an 'Age of Absolute Transformation'. We remain continuously committed to public welfare work for building a **Viksit Bharat** and a **Viksit Odisha**."

- Mohan Charan Majhi
Chief Minister, Odisha



• TECH

In AI giants’ listing plans, questions over valuations



Soumyaendra Barik

WITHIN DAYS of each other, two of the world’s most closely watched artificial intelligence (AI) companies in Anthropic and OpenAI have confidentially filed paperwork for public listings in the US, setting the stage for what could be some of the largest and most hotly anticipated technology initial public offerings (IPOs) in history. Elon Musk’s SpaceX is also gearing up for what could be the biggest IPO ever attempted, in terms of valuation.

The offerings are likely to draw intense interest from investors globally who, until now, have largely watched the AI boom from the sidelines. Much of the value created by the rise of generative AI has accrued to private investors, venture capital firms and strategic backers such as big technology companies. Public listings by the companies building the foundational models themselves would offer retail and institutional investors a rare opportunity to directly participate in what many see as the defining technological shift of the decade, even as concerns over a bubble around AI remain.

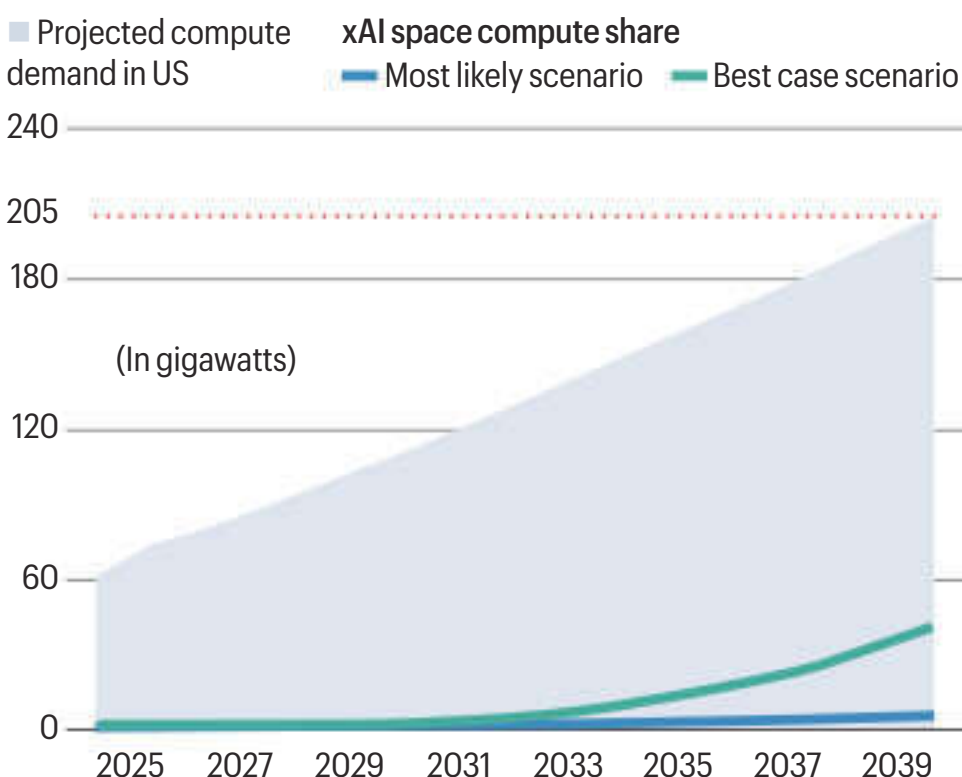
Anthropic, fresh off a \$65-billion funding round that valued it at roughly \$965 billion, has already begun the process, while OpenAI has followed with its own confidential filing and is targeting a valuation that could touch the \$1-trillion mark. SpaceX is seeking an even greater valuation, around \$1.75 trillion.

Yet, alongside the excitement lies a growing debate over whether private market valuations have raced ahead of business fundamentals. With investors pouring unprecedented sums into AI and frontier technology companies, some analysts have cautioned that expectations embedded in current valuations may prove hard to justify.

Here’s why some are cautious around lofty AI-linked valuations, especially for SpaceX, and how Indian investors — those who are willing to bet on the touted AI gains — can participate in these upcoming IPOs.

• SPACEX’S SHARE OF THE PIE

Estimates by investment research company Morningstar show that, SpaceX could control anywhere between 4% to 21% of the world’s global computing capacity by 2039, depending on how some of its offerings fare



The headquarters of SpaceX in Washington DC. WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Concerns around ‘AI-washing’

Analysts at the investment research company Morningstar have valued SpaceX at roughly \$780 billion — less than half its IPO target — arguing that investors may be placing overly optimistic bets on future growth and unproven businesses linked to AI. Morningstar has also questioned the economics of some of the company’s AI ambitions and said the market may be getting ahead of fundamentals.

“We see a wide range of possibilities around the newly acquired AI business and find its economic moat indeterminate, and it also poses a material threat of value destruction to the company, which limits our overall economic moat rating to narrow... Our discounted cash flow valuation of SpaceX is \$780 billion, about 48% below its private market valuation, including a wide range of probability-weighted scenarios for the AI business,” Morningstar said in a blog.

If the company achieves the valuation target of about \$1.75 trillion, it would surpass even Saudi Aramco’s 2019 debut as the world’s largest IPO.

Founded in 2002, SpaceX has evolved

Record valuations

Anthropic is fresh off a \$65-billion funding round that valued it at \$965 billion.

OpenAI is targeting a valuation that could touch the \$1-trillion mark.

SpaceX is seeking a valuation of \$1.75 trillion.

from a rocket launch startup into one of the world’s most influential technology firms, spanning space transportation, satellite internet, and AI infrastructure. Of the company’s total addressable market, which it pegs at \$28.5 trillion, about \$26.5 trillion is linked to AI.

Morningstar estimates that the company could control anywhere between 4% to 21% of the world’s global computing capacity by 2040, depending on how some of its fare (*see chart*).

The firm does not see Grok as one of the leading AI labs today, and it does not meaningfully add to how Morningstar values SpaceX. Instead, it sees capacity utilisation of the Colossus I and Colossus II terrestrial data centres, and in turn the potential for AI computational infrastructure in orbit, representing capacity expansion for SpaceX’s AI business, and the ability to commercialise it, as key profit drivers.

Underpinned by assumptions

There are echoes of Tesla in the debate surrounding SpaceX’s valuation. When Tesla went public in 2010, sceptics argued

that investors were paying a steep premium for a company that had yet to prove it could scale production or generate sustained profits.

Yet Tesla ultimately justified much of that optimism by reshaping the global automotive industry and becoming one of the world’s most valuable companies.

The key difference, though, is that Tesla’s valuation debate centred on a tangible product and a clearly identifiable market opportunity. In SpaceX’s case, critics argue that a significant portion of its proposed valuation rests on more speculative assumptions around Starlink’s future growth and the economics of AI-linked businesses.

How to invest in SpaceX IPO, other foreign IPOs

Indian retail investors can participate in SpaceX’s upcoming IPO, but the process isn’t as straightforward as investing through a demat account in the Indian stock market.

According to a blog post by the stock trading platform Upstox: “Indian residents cannot directly participate in this IPO. However, they may do so through their overseas brokerage accounts funded under the RBI’s Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS).” Under the Reserve Bank of India’s (RBI’s) LRS, Indians can freely remit up to \$250,000 per financial year for permissible capital and current account transactions, including for investments in foreign IPOs. Potential investors can set up an account with one of the many overseas brokerage platforms.

Upstox noted that while Indian investors can participate in the IPO, “the chances of allotment of SpaceX shares through the initial public offering are low”.

It is always a challenge for a foreign retail investor to get a US IPO allotment, because most of the US IPO allotments are typically made to institutional investors, the trading platform said. Reports suggest that nearly 30% of the offering will be earmarked for retail investors, with the rest reserved for institutional investors.

An IPO, however, is not the only way to buy shares of the company, and investors may purchase the stock once it is publicly listed.

• HISTORY

How Birsa Munda helped define Adivasi identity, rights

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, June 10

ON JUNE 9, the death anniversary of the iconic Adivasi leader and freedom fighter Birsa Munda, several tribal organisations in Jharkhand took a pledge to “protect his legacy”. This pledge came amid the fresh demands for “delisting” — removing tribal converts to Christianity or Islam from the Scheduled Tribes (ST) list — that have reignited a long-running debate over Adivasi identity. The latest delisting demand was made last month at a tribal gathering attended by Union Home Minister Amit Shah in Delhi.

The tribal organisations in Jharkhand said during the pledge event that Birsa Munda’s vision was rooted in Adivasi identity, sovereignty and land rights, and accused right-wing groups of attempting to reinterpret that outlook.

So what did Birsa stand for? More than 125 years after his death, here’s a look at the tribal leader’s life, beliefs and legacy.

Who was Birsa Munda?

Birsa Munda is one of the most influential figures in the history of the Chotanagpur plateau, the mineral-rich region spanning Jharkhand and adjoining states.

Revered by many as “Dharti Aba” (father of the Earth), he is remembered for

leading the Ulgulan, or the “Great Tumult” — a movement against colonial rule and “diku” (non-tribal outsider) zamindars amid the growing encroachment on Adivasi land and cultural institutions in the closing years of the 19th century.

Birsa’s influence, however, extended beyond the borders of the current Jharkhand state to the remote villages of Maharashtra, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh and more. In his seminal study *Birsa Munda and His Movement*, historian K S Singh described Birsa as a religious reformer, social mobiliser and political leader who transformed the Munda tribal society.

Adivasi historian Joseph Bara similarly argues that Birsa cannot be understood merely as the leader of an agrarian uprising. Rather, he articulated a broader vision of Adivasi identity, autonomy, land rights, religion and self-rule (known as *disum*).

Bara notes that his prominence in mainstream political and public discourse grew significantly during the decades preceding and following the creation of Jharkhand in 2000.

From resistance to statehood

The Ulgulan, led by Birsa Munda, reached its climax at Dombari Buru, a hill in a Khunti village, in January 1899. This was where thousands of Birsa’s followers gathered to assert their rights over land and

What is the Chotanagpur Tenancy Act?

● The CNT Act was enacted by the British in 1908 after decades of Adivasi resistance (including Birsa Munda’s uprising) to protect customary land rights in Chotanagpur region.

● The central objective was preventing the transfer of Adivasi land to non-Adivasis and legally recognising traditional land tenure systems.

● The Act remains one of the strongest safeguards for tribal land in Jharkhand.

challenge British authority, according to historian K S Singh.

The British forces eventually surrounded the hill and fired into the crowd. In Adivasi memory, this was a massacre that killed hundreds, though official records estimate a much lower toll. Birsa was arrested and died in Ranchi Jail on June 9, 1900.

While the British may have crushed the uprising, Dombari Buru became a symbol of Adivasi resistance.

The episode compelled the colonial administration to initiate land reforms that culminated in legal recognition of Khuntkatti rights and later the Chotanagpur Tenancy (CNT) Act, 1908. Khuntkatti was the traditional Munda system of collective land ownership and governance. Under the system, the descendants of the original settlers who cleared forests and established a village, known as Khuntkattidars, held collective rights over the village territory.

Bara writes that the aspiration for Adivasi self-governance articulated during Ulgulan was later channelled into the movement for a separate Jharkhand under Jaipal Singh Munda in the mid-1900s.

Religious views

According to family accounts shared by Budhram Munda, a descendant of the family, Birsa spent parts of his early childhood at his uncle’s village before studying

at missionary schools in Chaibasa.

Budhram Munda said that Birsa’s association with missionary education ended after a disagreement with church authorities over remarks about the Munda tribal community. After distancing himself from Christianity, Birsa came under the influence of Vaishnavism for some time.

“He was jailed in 1885 for two years and, eventually, after being released, he started preaching his teachings towards life and nature...,” said Budhram Munda.

These teachings created a religious movement that came to be known as the Birsait faith, different from Sarnaism (the traditional tribal faith), Christianity and Hinduism. His followers attribute various miracles to him and consider him a messiah, referring to him as “Bhagwan” and the aforementioned “Dharti Aba”.

Budhram Munda said: “Bhagwan Birsa never targeted any particular religion. He opposed both the outsiders from the caste society who were appointed as zamindars, and the Christian missionaries, as he saw them as part of the same system of exploitation,” he said. Opposing the demand for delisting of Christian tribals from the ST list, Budhram Munda said that descendants of Birsa’s family have followed Christianity for generations. He argued that Adivasi identity is determined by ancestry and community, not religion.

• INFRASTRUCTURE

Zojila Tunnel: The challenge of digging through the Himalayas

Sabab Virani

Sonamarg, June 10

THE BREAKTHROUGH of the Zojila Tunnel, a 13-km passage being carved through the Himalayas at an altitude of 11,578 feet, is a major milestone for one of India’s most challenging infrastructure projects. But unlike tunnels bored through relatively stable rock formations elsewhere, excavation in the Himalayas comes with a unique set of geological and environmental risks.

Building a Himalayan tunnel

Multiple reasons make tunnelling through the Himalayas a challenging feat. The altitude lends to difficult working conditions. So do the temperatures, which fall to as low as -30°C. Geologist Arnold Dix said that working in these conditions is difficult for both workers and combustion engine machines. The harsh winters often bring along avalanches, which can be fatal. Additionally, the rock strata in the Himalayas are highly variable, even differing metre to metre, said Dix. This means a long list of surprises lie in store for the engineers as they drill through. Loose rock, boulders, water ingress: the rock formations can be delicate and susceptible to disasters. Each variation requires a different treatment for structural integrity.

Particularly risky

The Himalaya range is a relatively new mountain range, making it far more tectonically active. “To a geologist,” said Dix, “the Himalayas are ocean floors that have been pushed upwards.”

This rock strata the engineers can encounter can be soft rock, characteristic

of a sea bed, to boulders and everything in between. The way the mountain has formed could have left cavities and cracks. A lot of water — even up to an ocean’s worth — is stored in the mountains. Due to its age, there are sheer zones where there is higher strain on the rock and tunnelling can lead to instability.

Methods of safe excavation

The Zojila tunnel was excavated using the New Austrian Tunneling Method, tailor-made for such conditions. The method involves selective blasting of the rock, followed by securing the tunnel wall with shotcrete (sprayed concrete) and rock bolts. The excavation is done in two steps, wherein the top half of the tunnel is excavated first, followed by the bottom half.

Besides the water stored in them, the mountains have melting snow coming through as well. Depending upon the level of water ingress, engineers will fit pipes and allow the water to drain out in a gradual manner so as to not allow water pressure to build up in the mountain, which could potentially lead to a collapse or flooding.

Cracks in the rock formation will alter the number, size, and spacing of the rock bolts, while the shotcrete glues the rocks together. Even the tunnel’s alignment can be tweaked to bypass a mountain’s weak segment and skirt around it. The tunnel’s shape and configuration is also moulded as per site conditions. “It’s like conducting an operation without anaesthesia. This is why tunnelling in the Himalayas has to be done slowly and carefully,” said Dix.

Drishti IAS		
IAS GS Foundation Course		
Offline & Live Online Batches		
Centre	हिंदी माध्यम	English Medium
9 Karol Bagh	29 जून शाम 6:00 बजे	12 June 8:00 AM
9 Noida	29 जून शाम 6:00 बजे	12 June 11:30 AM
9 Indore	22 जून सुबह 8:00 बजे	24 June 5:30 PM
9 Lucknow	17 जून सुबह 8:00 बजे	24 June 11:30 AM
9 Prayagraj	29 जून शाम 5:30 बजे	23 June 8:00 AM
9 Ranchi	एडमिशन आरंभ	Admissions Open
9 Patna	एडमिशन आरंभ	Admissions Open
9 Jaipur	एडमिशन आरंभ	Admissions Open
Call Us: 87501 87501		

• IMMIGRATION

Trump’s \$100,000 H-1B fee scrapped, but some Indians have paid the price

Vidheesha Kuntamalla & Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, June 10

A US FEDERAL judge’s decision to strike down President Donald Trump’s controversial \$100,000 fee on new H-1B visas will come as some relief to employers, but many foreign workers have already faced much of its brunt. Last week, US District Judge Leo Sorokin of Massachusetts ruled that the fee was unlawful, concluding that it functioned as a tax — something the President lacks the authority to impose without Congressional approval.

What is the H-1B programme and how did the fee affect it?

The H-1B visa allows US employers to hire foreign nationals in specific occupations or roles that require at a minimum a bachelor’s degree and a body of specialised knowledge. The US Congress has capped approvals at 65,000 per year for most private employers, with an additional 20,000 for holders of advanced degrees. Universities,

nonprofit research organisations and government research bodies are exempt from this cap and can file petitions at any time.

Before the \$100,000 proclamation, the petition fees ranged from \$960 to \$7,595. While signing the proclamation to increase the fee in September 2025, Trump had cited concerns that the H-1B programme had been used to replace American workers with foreign labour at lower wages, particularly in STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) fields.

Why did the court strike down the fee?

The central question was whether the \$100,000 payment was a legitimate immigration penalty or an unlawful tax.

The administration said the fee was a restriction on entry as the overall revenue collected fell after the proclamation took effect.

The court disagreed, stating that hiring H-1B workers is lawful conduct and that the payment did not operate as a penalty for unlawful behaviour. Instead, it generated revenue and therefore functioned as a tax.

It said that “purpose and effect are different” and added that “every \$100,000 payment made pursuant to the Policy does raise revenue. That is indisputable.”

The US Constitution gives Congress the power to impose and collect taxes. While Congress can delegate that to the executive branch, the court said it must do so clearly.

The court also cited the Supreme Court’s ruling this year in which tariffs imposed under a separate statute were struck down on the same logic. Robert Bray, a retired Immigration Officer with the United States Citizenship and Immigration Services’ Fraud Detection and National Security division, told *The Indian Express* that once the court characterised the payment as a tax, much of the government’s defence collapsed.

Why is the ruling important?

Indian citizens receive more than 70% of all H-1B visas issued annually and dominate the technology, engineering, healthcare and consulting sectors that rely heavily on the programme.

Washington DC-based immigration attorney Rajiv Khanna told *The Indian Express* that the ruling restores predictability to a system that many workers felt had become increasingly unstable.

“There is a system in place and that system cannot be disturbed at the whim or fancy of a government that decides matters without any empirical evidence of what will work, what will not work, and what they are trying to correct,” he said.

Bray described the ruling as potentially precedent-setting because it limits how administrations can impose immigration-related charges without a Congressional nod.

How has the fee affected workers?

While the court ruling is being celebrated by many immigration advocates, some lawyers say damage may already have been done. Asel Williams, a founding immigration attorney at New York City-based Williams Law, told *The Indian Express*: “Indian professionals on H-1B and STEM OPT status have already felt the impact of the

\$100,000 H-1B fee introduced last year.”

OPT, or Optional Practical Training, allows international students on F-1 visas to work in the US after graduation in jobs related to their field of study.

According to Williams, many employers became reluctant to sponsor foreign workers once the fee was announced. “Fewer companies are willing to sponsor Indian nationals, terminations are rising, and I am receiving a growing number of inquiries from laid-off H-1B holders with only 60 days to secure new employment,” she said.

Williams said that immigration restrictions have coincided with broader technological disruptions in the labour market. “These layoffs are being driven by a combination of AI displacement and increasingly restrictive H-1B policies. The damage to Indian H-1B holders and STEM OPT workers has in large part already been done,” she said. Similarly, Bray noted that the fee appeared to suppress demand for new H-1B sponsorships. “The number of H-1Bs originating in other countries was re-

duced exponentially,” he said.

The consequences were particularly severe for workers who had already obtained H-1B status but later lost their jobs. “For people who got laid off on an H-1B and had to leave the US to come back, they would have had to pay \$100,000,” Khanna said.

What now for H-1B holders?

A legal challenge from the government is expected. Khanna said the administration generally has about 30 days to file an appeal and could simultaneously seek a stay of the ruling. “If the stay is granted, then this ruling does not come into effect until the appeal is decided, which can take a few months.”

Williams urged foreign workers to avoid assuming that the ruling resolves immigration uncertainties. “I recommend H-1B holders avoid international travel,” she said. “The court ruling does not automatically make it easier to obtain an H-1B visa through consular processing. Both the US Department of State and DHS retain discretion to deny any H-1B petition.”

THURSDAY, JUNE 11, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

₹7.00 (₹8 RAIPUR, ₹15 SRINAGAR) • www.indianexpress.com

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

Empowered Annadata, Flourishing Agriculture



₹1.40 lakh crore agriculture budget, increased fivefold in 12 years

Nearly 28 lakh hectares covered under National Mission on Natural Farming and Paramparagat Krishi Vikas Yojana, boosting organic farming

12 Saal

Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke



CNC 01/01/23 0006 72627

‘Gross abuse of law’: HC quashes police FIR, ED probe against NewsClick, its founder

‘No offence made out... not a whisper of any incriminating allegation found’

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 10

THE DELHI High Court has quashed the Delhi Police FIR and Enforcement Directorate (ED) proceedings against news portal NewsClick and its founder and editor-in-chief Prabir Purkayastha.

While the 2020 FIR by the Economic Offences Wing of Delhi Police had invoked sections related to charges of criminal breach of trust, cheating, criminal conspiracy and alleged violation of FDI norms, the subsequent ED action was on alleged money laundering.

In an order made public Wednesday, Justice Neena Bansal Krishna, while noting that ingredients of the offences

CITY

PAGE 3

BAIL RULE, DENIAL AN EXCEPTION: DELHI HC GRANTS BAIL TO KHURRAM PARVEZ IN UAPA CASE

were not made out, quashed the EOW FIR and said, “The continuation of such FIR is nothing but a gross abuse of the process of law and is hereby quashed.”

With the scheduled predicate offence quashed, the High Court also quashed the ED proceedings.

It noted that despite “extensive investigations carried out”

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

FIRST SUMMONS SINCE TRUMP’S RETURN

3 Indians missing after attack, Delhi summons US diplomat

21 Indian crew members rescued from ship near Oman, second incident in 2 days

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, June 10

FOR THE first time in its dealings with the Trump administration, India Wednesday summoned a top US diplomat in New Delhi following an attack earlier in the day by American forces on a commercial ship off the coast of Oman. Of the 24 Indian seafarers on the ship Setebello, 21 were rescued while three remained missing.

Sources said a senior official of the Ministry of External Affairs summoned the US charge d’affaires Jason Meeks over the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



PM Narendra Modi enjoys ‘jhalhuri’ with West Bengal CM Suvenud Adhikari during an NDA meeting in New Delhi, Wednesday. ANI

Cabinet hails Modi’s ‘historic’ PM stint; Trump, world leaders send greetings

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

AS NARENDRA Modi became India’s longest continuously serving elected Prime Minister on Wednesday — 4,399 days, surpassing the previous record of 4,398 days held by Jawaharlal Nehru — the Union Cabinet passed a resolution applauding him and terming it as a “historic milestone in the journey of Indian democracy”.

Many world leaders, including US President Donald Trump, German Chancellor Friedrich Merz, President of the European Commission Ursula

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

THE IDEAS PAGE P9

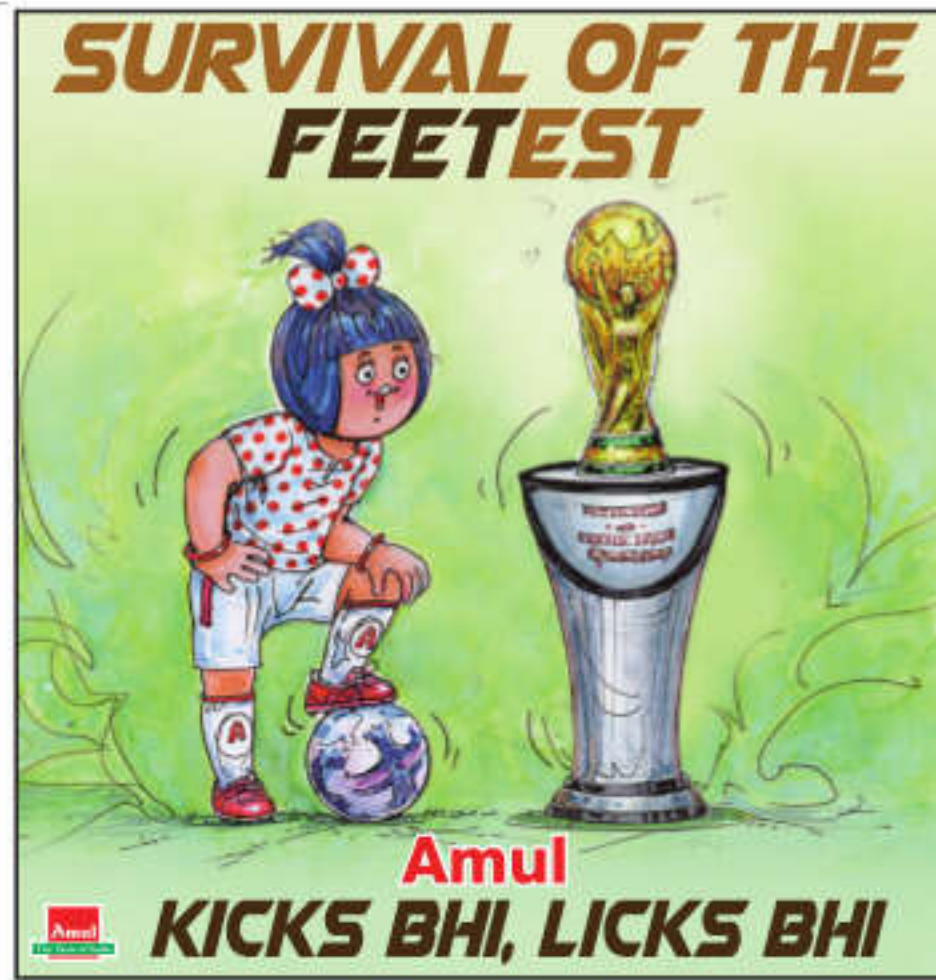
PM MODI IS BARAI BHAI, WHO OFFERS WARMTH AND WISDOM, HIS LEGACY PERSONAL

By DASHO TSHERING TOBGAY
PRIME MINISTER OF BHUTAN

POLITICS

NDA HAS GIVEN COUNTRY STABILITY, BHARAT RUNNING AT FULL SPEED, PM TELLS ALLIANCE LEADERS

PAGE 10



Gd/Cunha/AB/1107

Urea prices crash in latest import tender as China partially lifts restrictions

Harish Damodaran
New Delhi, June 10

IN A relief for India, the state-owned National Fertilizers Limited’s (NFL) latest tender for import of 1.7 million tonnes (mt) of urea has received landed price (cost plus freight) quotes

of \$444.9-449.3 per tonne. This is less than half the winning landed price bids of \$935-959 per tonne for an earlier tender issued by Indian Potash Limited (IPL) for import of 2.5 mt.

Industry sources attributed the lower price quotes in the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Suwendu Adhikari picks Swapan Dasgupta for Finance, Tapas Roy for Industries

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, June 10

ALLOCATING PORTFOLIOS nine days after he expanded his Cabinet, West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari Wednesday handed Finance to BJP leader and columnist Swapan Dasgupta, and Industries to Tapas Roy, a minister in the previous Mamata Banerjee government before joining the BJP in 2024.

Roy has also been allocated the portfolios of Commerce, Public Enterprises and Industrial Reconstruction and Non-Conventional and Renewable Energy Sources.

According to a notification issued by the government, the entire 41-member Council of Ministers, including the Chief Minister, have now been allotted portfolios.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Human contribution to global warming highest ever in 2025, says study

Amitabh Sinha
New Delhi, June 10

AT A time when global political attention to climate change appears to be receding, a new assessment has confirmed earlier estimates that 2025 was the third warmest year on record. Importantly, this annual study, called the Indicators of Global Climate Change or IGCC, found that the contribution of human activities to the overall warming observed in 2025 was possibly the highest ever.

The IGCC study, first published in 2023, is the work of an independent international

E. EXPLAINED

‘35% by 2035’

The ongoing climate meet in Germany has proposed a global commitment to ensure that electricity accounts for at least 35% of final energy consumption by 2035. Currently, it accounts for 20% of global energy consumption. This is a key step towards the transition from fossil fuels.

group of climate scientists which

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

● PM NARENDRA Modi will chair the 11th Governing Council Meeting of NITI Aayog.

TRACK THESE AND MORE ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY



Honey-trapped, judicial officer gets domestic help to file complaint: Court

Varinder Bhatia
Chandigarh, June 10

A WOMAN judicial officer from Haryana connects with a man on a dating app, gets “ensnared in a honey trap” and loses nearly Rs 53 lakh. Struck by “profound personal embarrass-

ment” but keen to recover the money, the judicial officer gets her domestic help to lodge a police complaint in her place.

These are the key elements at the heart of a case being heard in a Delhi court, which on Tuesday dismissed the bail application of the man who al-

legedly duped the judicial officer — and came down harshly on the officer herself, while pulling up police for lapses in the investigation.

“A matter that ought to be relatively straightforward — a cyber fraud case with a clear

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● INSIDE FOOTBALL’S SACRED GROUND IN MEXICO WHERE PELE AND MARADONA LIFTED WORLD CUPS

At the Azteca Stadium, a spring, a serpent god, and 87,500 people on opening day



Sandip G
Mexico City, June 10

TWO MILES from the Azteca Stadium, in Coyoacan’s Cafe Cruco, Jose Alvarez, the cafe owner, throws in a trivia: “Do you know what is in Azteca’s tummy?” Then, he informs



The Estadio Azteca will host a third World Cup in its storied history after 1970 and 1986. Mexico is scheduled to host nine games. SANDIP G

with a proud smile: “It’s water, a large spring that almost touches the other world.” But, with a raised eyebrow, he adds:

“When there is a match, we face water shortage, because the stadium has a thousand restrooms!”

He is not far wrong about the dimensions. The Azteca sits like a giant concrete sombrero, the traditional Mexican hat, in the Saint Ursula Coapa neighbourhood, over parts of a volcano that gushed its last fumes in the fourth century.

The narrow roads with murals of Mexican revolutionary Emiliano Zapata with his bristling moustache are cordoned off, mainly to ease traffic for players, and partly to keep off the teachers demanding a 100 per cent pay rise and

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

DDA KARMAYOGI AWAAS YOJANA

ON HEAVY DEMAND SCHEME EXTENDED UP TO 30th JUNE 2026

Newly Constructed Homes Facing Vast Urban Forest

Where Nature Meets Urban Living

Actual Site Photograph

FIRST COME FIRST SERVE BASIS

Only Few Flats Left Book Now !

Pocket-6, 9 & 13, A1-A4, Narela

1 BHK Completely Sold Out in Pocket-6 & 9

Scheme exclusively for all Serving and Retired Government Employees
(Central, State, PSUs, PSBs, Universities & Autonomous Bodies)

1 BHK - Starting Price ₹33.63 Lakh
(Starting Size Approx. 61.27 Sq. Mtr.)

2 BHK - Starting Price ₹75.55 Lakh
(Starting Size Approx. 126 Sq. Mtr.)

3 BHK - Starting Price ₹106.45 Lakh
(Starting Size Approx. 164 Sq. Mtr.)

PRICE AFTER 25% DISCOUNT

KEY FEATURES

- Excellent Connectivity: In the vicinity of UER II and GT Karnal Road, 40 mins. drive to Airport
- Enhanced Security with Ex-Servicemen deployment
- Narela emerging as Education Hub
- Spacious Balconies
- Ample Parking
- Big Common Space
- Community Centre/Club House
- Metro Connectivity Coming Soon
- Scheme completely Online
- Ready-to-move-in Flats
- Freehold Property
- Sample Flats open for visit

DELHI DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
FOR ASSISTANCE CALL AT : 1800 11 0332

For Booking & Registration, please visit:
www.dda.gov.in or <https://reservices.dda.org.in>
Follow us on: @official_dda @ddaofficial @official_dda_

Two arrested for Dalit youth’s death after ‘assault by minor girl’s family in Uttarakhand’

Aiswarya Raj
Dehradun, June 10

AN 18-YEAR-OLD Dalit youth was killed, allegedly by the family of a 15-year-old girl he was in a relationship with, in Uttarakhand’s Tehri district on Monday, police said.

Police identified the victim as Ketan Lal. “On Sunday night, he received a call from the girl’s phone, and when he visited her house, her family caught him and allegedly started beating him up. He was kept there till Monday morning and allegedly assaulted by her father and grandfather. The girl’s father later called Keran’s father, Dhampal Lal, to inform him of the matter. He was taken to the hospital, where he died during the treatment,” said Senior Superintendent of Police, Tehri, Shweta Choubey.

The postmortem has been completed, and the police are awaiting the report. The father and grandfather have been arrested after an FIR was registered under the sections of murder and the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act.

The complaint, registered by the boy’s father, states that around 5 am on Monday, he received a call from his son’s phone. “The caller identified himself and asked me where my son had been all night. I looked for him at home and told the caller he was not there. The man then said that my son and his friend had remained in his custody through the night, and that he and his family had broken their arms and legs. He said that he had killed my son and thrown him into a stream,” alleges the complaint.

The father rushed to the spot and saw his son lying in a severely injured condition. His friend was also injured. “I asked my son what had happened, and he told me that the girl’s father and his family called them to their house around midnight as a conspiracy to kill them. He said that throughout the night, they beat him brutally because he belonged to a Scheduled Caste and continued assaulting him until morning,” the father alleged. According to him, Ketan said that he was beaten with sticks, batons, and an iron rod, and had iron nails pierced into his body.

The complaint said that he recorded a video of the statements and injuries and handed it over to the police administration. After he was hospitalised, Ketan succumbed to his injuries. “This is an injustice committed against a Scheduled Caste person,” states the complaint.

Police said the forensic team has been instructed to collect evidence. “We are examining whether the family called the boy to the house as set-up. We are interrogating the accused,” police said.

The boy’s father told *The Indian Express* said they want the rest of the family arrested. “I do not know about the girl or the nature of their relation,” he said. “It is a case of caste violence. My boy could not even tell me what they had done to him. He was asking for water, and when I insisted, he could barely mouth the words he had been tortured with a belt and rods. His body bore signs of assault and puncture by nails. We need police security; if they could kill my son, they can kill any of us,” the father said.

SC asks Kerala govt to take custody of elephant caught in ownership row

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

THE SUPREME Court has asked the Kerala government to take custody of Uttoly Raman, a well-known elephant in the state, and house it in a rehabilitation centre, pending a final decision on its ownership.

“In the given circumstances, where the issue pertaining to the custody of the elephant in question is yet to be decided finally, and with a view to prioritise the health and overall well-being of the elephant in question, this court deems it appropriate to direct the State of Kerala to take over the custody of the elephant in question i.e., Raman; and house it in an appropriate rescue/rehabilitation centre,” a bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and S C Sharma said in an interim order on Tuesday.

The bench clarified that this “arrangement is only temporary and will be subject to the final orders” it passes on the issue of who will have interim

custody of the tusker while the appeals are being decided.

The order came on a contempt plea by Jayakrishnan Menon. He claimed that the elephant belonged to the Mata Amritanandamayi Mutt and one Krishnankutty, who was given temporary custody, had flouted the assurance given to the court on August 6, 2025, that it “would not be used for any commercial or temple activities in the meanwhile”.

On December 8, 2023, a trial court had granted Raman’s interim custody to Menon on execution of a bond for Rs 25 lakh. The Kerala HC set it aside and remanded the matter to be heard afresh by the trial court. Menon challenged this before the Supreme Court.

According to Menon, Krishnankutty was only temporarily entrusted with Raman’s custody for upkeep and care, but the latter “unlawfully...retained custody...and asserted ownership on the strength of forged and fabricated gift deeds...”

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Delhi summons US diplomat

incident — Ambassador Sergio Gor was not in the country, away on a tour of Kazakhstan.

Providing details of the incident, the MEA said, “We condemn the attack on the commercial vessel Settebello off the coast of Oman, earlier today. Of the 24 Indian crew onboard, 21 Indians have been rescued thus far and 03 Indians are reportedly missing. Our Embassy in Oman is closely monitoring the situation and proactively coordinating with the Omani authorities in the ongoing Search and Rescue operation.”

“The continuing incidents of attacks on shipping in the region are deeply worrisome and a direct result of the ongoing conflict in the region. We reiterate our call for immediate de-escalation of tensions, and the conclusion of ongoing negotiations for a diplomatic solution so that peace and stability can return to the region,” it said.

“The targeting of commercial shipping and civilian infrastructure in the region must end, and free and unimpeded navigation and commerce through the international waterways in the

region in keeping with international law must be restored at the earliest,” the MEA said.

Earlier in the day, the Indian Embassy in Muscat said it was “closely monitoring” an incident involving a vessel off the coast of Oman. In a post on X, the mission said it was in close touch with local authorities on the issue.

The incident came a day after the Indian Coast Guard (ICG) said that 24 Indian crew members of a Palau-flagged merchant tanker were rescued in coordination with Omani

authorities, following a “missile attack” on the vessel off the coast of Oman.

While the summoning of the US diplomat was the first since President Donald Trump returned to the White House in January 2025, Delhi had summoned American diplomats in the past to convey its displeasure. In March 2024, an American diplomat was summoned to protest the Biden administration’s comments on the arrest of then Delhi Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal. And in March 2023, Delhi lodged a strong protest with the US over the attack on the Indian consulate in San Francisco by Khalistan sympathisers.

Modi

von der Leyen, and Italy’s Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni, also congratulated Modi.

An NDA conclave, held to celebrate the completion of 12 years of the BJP-led government and Modi’s personal milestone, also passed a resolution lauding his record term.

Briefing reporters after the Cabinet meeting, I&B Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said, “The (Cabinet) resolution states that this occasion stands as a symbol of India’s democratic consciousness, public trust, and the power of public participation, reflecting the unprecedented support bestowed by the people upon a leader guided by the ‘Nation First’ resolve.”

The Cabinet members gave Modi a standing ovation at the start of the meeting.

The resolution “expresses gratitude for his unique dedication and tireless hard work towards serving the nation; appreciates his efforts directed towards inclusive growth and

social justice; praises his leadership in strengthening national security and protecting India’s interests; expresses its full support for his visionary resolve and leadership in building a ‘Viksit Bharat,’” said a statement.

It appreciates “the policies... that have enabled more than 25 crore poor people in India to defeat poverty under his leadership,” it said.

“The resolution further maps the empowerment of key demographics. It recognises the focus on youth power that propelled India into becoming the world’s third-largest start-up ecosystem and a scientific power through Mission Chandrayaan. A new chapter of ‘women-led development’ is detailed through comprehensive policies ranging from smoke-free kitchens and the Lakhpati Didi campaign to the historic 33 per cent reservation for women in legislative bodies,” it said.

“The resolution attributes the advancement of India’s manufacturing capabilities in sectors from defence to AI, to the momentum gained by the

‘Make in India’ and ‘Aatmanirbhar Bharat’ campaigns. Simultaneously, it highlights India’s strengthened global role through the successful G-20 presidency, International Yoga Day, and initiatives like the International Solar Alliance and Mission LIFE,” it said.

Vaishnaw said the resolution also weighed in on the PM’s ‘Nation First’ spirit in enacting pending reforms, commending the abrogation of Article 370, implementation of GST and OROP, the CAA and the consolidation of labour codes.

In a post on Truth Social, US President Donald Trump said: “Congratulations to my friend, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, on becoming India’s longest-serving Prime Minister -- And a Great One he is! He is a strong, healthy, and wise man, and will have many years of Greatness and Success ahead of him!”

Responding to his message, Modi said on X: “Thank you, President Trump, for your warm wishes. I look forward to working with you to further advance the India-US Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership, for

the benefit of both our nations and the world.”

“Congratulations to @narendramodi for being the longest serving democratically elected Prime Minister of India. Looking forward to further strengthening the strategic partnership between our countries and welcoming you to Germany for the next intergovernmental consultations,” German Chancellor Friedrich Merz said.

“Congratulations! With you, India not only landed on the moon, it is shooting for the stars. And so is our friendship... Thank you for all that we have achieved together,” President of the European Commission, Ursula von der Leyen, said in a social media post.

“Congratulations to @narendramodi who today becomes the longest-serving elected Prime Minister in the history of India. It has been a pleasure to meet again in Rome in recent weeks and to launch together a Special Strategic Partnership that looks to the future to create new opportunities for our Nations and our peoples,” Italy’s PM Giorgia Meloni posted on X.

Judicial officer

digital money trail — has been complicated, obfuscated, and rendered murky by the conduct of all three protagonists: the accused, the victim, and the investigating officer,” the court stated.

The accused, Deepak Vats, was arrested by Delhi Police’s Special Cell in February in the alleged cyber fraud case involving over Rs 52.81 lakh. Dismissing his bail plea in an order dated June 9, Additional Sessions Judge (New Delhi District) Saurabh Partap Singh Laler observed that the complainant in the case, a domestic help, “did not initiate or make a single digital payment

throughout the entire period”.

The court noted that “the overwhelming majority of the transactions — all except the final cash deposit of Rs 5 lakh — were made not from the accounts of the complainant...but directly from the accounts of a Haryana Judicial Officer, who is the actual and real victim in the present matter”.

The FIR had been registered on the complaint of the domestic help, who alleged she was cheated of Rs 52,81,999 through an online dating app. But the court recorded that “a closer examination of the facts and documents placed on record re-

veals that the complainant...is in fact, the maid employed by a Judicial Officer serving in Haryana”. The court said: “A judicial officer — a person who is herself entrusted with the solemn duty of dispensing justice, of upholding truth before the law, and of expecting others who appear before her to present the complete facts — has chosen to approach this Court obliquely, through her maid’s name, rather than coming forward herself”.

The court acknowledged the “profound personal embarrassment and professional sensitivity that a judicial officer must feel upon discovering that she has been ensnared in a honey trap”. However, it said “the officer’s personal discomfort cannot be permitted to

compromise the integrity of a criminal investigation”.

It said the judicial officer “should, at the earliest opportunity, come before the IO — or, if she so chooses, before the... Magistrate — and place on record the complete and unvarnished truth”.

In its order, the court stated: “The singular and most striking aspect of this case...is that while the complaint has been filed in the name of the domestic help...every material transaction that forms the substratum of the alleged fraud was made not from [the help’s] account, but from the accounts of her employer.” It added: “This Court is constrained to record that the complaint as filed does not seem to reflect the true complainant.”

Global warming

includes several contributors to the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) that produces periodic reports on the state of climate change, which are considered the most authoritative word on the subject.

The latest IGCC study said average global temperatures in 2025 were about 1.39 degree Celsius higher than the average of 1850-1900 baseline. Of the total increase, it said 1.37 degree Celsius was due to human activities, primarily greenhouse gas emissions, while the rest could be the result of natural variations in climate systems.

The IGCC study, published in the peer-reviewed open access journal called Earth System Science Data, confirms the earlier estimate of the World Meteorological Organisation (WMO) which, in January this year, had said that 2025 was likely to emerge as the third warmest year, after 2024 and 2023. WMO had said the average glo-

bal temperatures in 2025 were likely to be 1.44 degree Celsius above the 1850-1900 baseline.

The warmest-ever year, 2024, was about 1.55 degree Celsius hotter than the 1850-1900 baseline. That year, human activities had contributed about 1.36 degree Celsius of warming, according to the IGCC study for 2024, the rest being attributed to natural variations. The year 2023 was about 1.45 degree Celsius warmer than 1850-1900 baseline. Human contribution that year was assessed to be about 1.31 degree Celsius.

For 2025, the contribution of human activities to global warming is possibly the highest ever, but the scale of natural variations in climate differ from year to year. 2025 happened to be a La Nina year, a year in which the equatorial Pacific Ocean, off the western coast of South America, was cooler than normal. La Nina is known to have a general cool-

ing effect on the planet. This could have been the reason why the year, despite the potentially record-breaking contribution of human-induced warming, was slightly cooler than 2024 and 2023.

The IGCC study said human-induced warming had been increasing at the rate of about 0.27 degree Celsius per decade, as a result of record levels of greenhouse gas emissions. It found that greenhouse gas emissions had reached 56.8 billion tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent in 2025, an all-time high.

It said the world could emit no more than 130 billion tonnes of additional carbon dioxide from the start of 2026, if it entertained any hopes of restricting global rise in temperatures to within 1.5 degree Celsius from the 1850-1900 baseline. At current rate of emissions, this ‘carbon budget’ would be exhausted in less than three years.

The IGCC study is being released in a week when countries are assembled in Bonn, Germany, for the annual mid-year climate talks. The discussions

are centred mainly around ways to increase the ambition of climate action which has suffered a major blow due to the withdrawal of the United States from the 2015 Paris Agreement last year. Global climate action has been unable to keep pace with the requirement to significantly cut greenhouse gas emissions in the near term.

The findings of the IGCC study are a further reminder to the rapidly rising global temperatures. Just last month, a WMO study said there was a 91 per cent chance that at least one of the next five years, between 2026 and 2030, would break the 1.5 degree Celsius threshold, just like 2024 did. It further said that there was a 75 per cent possibility that the average temperature of this five-year period also exceeded 1.5 degree Celsius level from the 1850-1900 baseline.

This year, a strong El Nino is predicted to develop in the equatorial Pacific Ocean. This year’s El Nino is expected to persist not just through the end of the year, but possibly also continue into early next year.

Azteca

truck drivers protesting kidnappings on the highways.

None of these tensions has spilled onto the arena, a canyon, a planet unto itself, the most sacred of footballing venues. The Guardia Nacional’s trucks scream by, the cadets toting guns in stiff grey fatigues, ensuring calm the day before the opening game.

The locals call it simply Azteca or Coloso, trimming Colossus of Santa Ursula. A few bends away is the church of Santa Ursula, the locale’s patron saint. “We live under the gaze of Santa and Azteca. Santa has blessed Azteca. That is why so much history has happened here,” says

Alvarez. He addresses the arena as she. “She has a life of her own.” A throbbing soul inside bricks and cement.

Under that gaze, football’s gods have roamed freely. Pele and Diego Maradona have both hoisted World Cups here, now re-christened Estadio Banorte after a Mexican banking group, although nobody cares or bothers, and they still call it Azteca.

Pele lifted the trophy here in 1970 and scored in the final, an imperious header that opened the scoring against Italy. The room he stayed in during that tournament, at the Inter-American Conference on Social Security building nearby, is preserved.

Maradona’s Hand of God goal is etched in a bronze relief in the arena’s museum. During

his stint managing Mexican club Dorados in Culiacan, Maradona visited and, according to the newspaper Reforma, had a hearty laugh at the sight of it.

There is a less famous statue too: of Ignacio ‘Nachito’ Villanueva, the most loyal fan of Azteca, a supporter who did not miss nearly three decades of Club America’s home games. The club calls Azteca home.

The museum volunteers are exhausted. “We are putting in extra shifts because the tourists have been rushing,” says Amanda Lopez. “I wonder how the stadium will be during a match. 100,000 turning up!”

Its official maximum capacity is 87,500.

“Before renovation it was around 100,500, but in club games before the security got

strict, we used to pack in 150,000,” says Javier, another volunteer. “It’s an experience we can’t put in words.”

Even Pele felt the same. “There’s just something very special about the Azteca. You need to be inside it, to feel it, to understand. It’s unique.”

The vibe has to be experienced to fathom, but you can feel the thinning air, as the city is 2,200 metres above sea level.

Away teams historically gasp for breath. The architecture intensifies the ambience: steeply banked seats, difficult sightlines, the distance of about 20 yards from the sideline to the team benches. According to a study, since 1986, Mexico’s World Cup matches at the Azteca have averaged crowd noise above 118 decibels. The noise can

NewsClick

by ED for about a year and a half”, not a whisper of any incriminating allegation had been found till date “which would even remotely suggest the commission of the offence punishable under Section 4 PMLA”.

For the offence of cheating, the High Court said, it is necessary to have an aggrieved person who has been cheated out of property, absent in this case.

On August 26, 2020, the EOW filed an FIR under IPC sections 406 (punishment for criminal breach of trust), 420 (cheating and dishonestly inducing delivery of property), and 120B (punishment of criminal conspiracy).

The FIR had alleged that foreign direct investment was received by PPK NewsClick Studio Private Limited, which owns the digital portal, from Worldwide Media Holdings LLC, US, (WWMH) during 2018-19, in violation of the FDI norms and other laws of the country. Through the FDI, WWMH came to hold 7.69% shares of PPK NewsClick Studio.

At the time of the fund transfer from WWMH, the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting had clarified that there was no cap/restriction on receipt of FDI in digital media.

Based on the EOW FIR, the ED lodged a complaint under

PMLA on September 2, 2020 and conducted searches in February 2021.

The High Court observed that “no offence” under IPC of fences for cheating and criminal breach of trust was made out. “From the response of ED also, it is evident that they are trying to claim that the offence under Section 120B IPC is still made out. However, on what basis the criminal conspiracy is being alleged is not explained, except that Prabir Purkayastha and Jason Pfetcher (WWMH manager), had entered into an agreement... Merely because the parties entered into an agreement is not sufficient to constitute criminal conspiracy, unless the ED is able to show what is the illegal objective or the means which have been adopted... which can be termed as criminal conspiracy.” Justice Krishna observed, while quashing the criminal proceedings.

NewsClick, while seeking quashing of the cases, had submitted that the “FIR and the ECIR and the investigations conducted therein” were “merely an attempt to silence the independent and impartial reporting of various issues of national importance and are intended to create a chilling effect on various persons, including journalists, discouraging them from exercising their constitutional right of freedom of speech.” It was also highlighted that RBI too had found no wrongdoing.

Urea

latest tender mainly to China issuing export quotas for urea. “China partially lifting export restrictions has not only eased soaring global prices, but also came at the right time with kharif (monsoon) crop plantings underway,” a source said.

The NFL tender, issued on May 27 and opened on June 8, received bids for 6.25 mt. That included 3.17 mt for supplying to the country’s eastern ports and 3.08 mt to the western ports. The lowest bids were at \$444.9 per tonne, by Aditya Birla Global Trading for delivery to the eastern coast, and at \$449.3 per tonne by Ameropa Asia for delivery to the western coast.

The previous IPL tender for import of 2.5 mt, issued on April 4 and opened on April 15, received offers for over 5.9 mt. But the suppliers agreed for de-

liveries to the western coast at \$935 per tonne and to the eastern coast at \$959 per tonne.

In March, China had restricted export of the nitrogenous fertiliser following the supply shock from the Iran war and closure of the Strait of Hormuz, through which India imported a record 11.17 mt of urea in 2025-26 (April-March) valued at \$5.16 billion, up from 6.91 mt (\$2.38 billion) in 2024-25. Of the total 11.17 mt imports, China alone accounted for 2.23 mt, followed by Oman (1.91 mt), Russia (1.64 mt), Qatar (0.95 mt), Indonesia and Saudi Arabia (0.65 mt each), United Arab Emirates and Finland (0.46 mt each) and Nigeria (0.45 mt).

The NFL tender had specified that the shipments for the contracted quantities should leave the loading ports by July 20. This would allow the shipments to land by August, in time for use by farmers in the later part of the kharif season.

Swapan, Tapas

Besides Home and Hill Affairs, Adhikari will hold the charge of the departments of Land and Land Reforms, Refugee Relief and Rehabilitation, Power, Information and Cultural Affairs, Personnel and Administrative Reforms, and other departments not allotted to any other Minister. Former state BJP chief Dilip Ghosh will continue to hold the portfolios of Panchayats, Rural Development and Agriculture Marketing.

Agnimitra Paul will handle Urban Development and Municipal Affairs. Significantly, Paul was in charge of both Urban Development and Women and Child Development ministries in the earlier notification. In the new notification, the Women and Child Development ministry has been allocated to Malati Rava Roy, a party MLA from Tufanganj with links to RSS.

Nishith Pramanik, a former Union Minister, has been allotted the portfolio of North Bengal Development and Water Resources.

Dipak Burman, a former school headmaster, has been given the charge of the School

Education department. Former journalist Jagannath Chattopadhyay is the Higher Education Minister. Duddh Kumar Mondal has been named the Agriculture Minister.

Shankar Ghosh, who was with the CPI(M) before switching to the BJP in 2021, will hold the charge of Parliamentary Affairs and Tourism. Arjun Singh, a former MP, will handle the Labour and Transport departments.

Dr Sharadwat Mukherjee, an oncologist who made headlines for campaigning with a fish during the Bengal elections, has been allocated the Health and Family Welfare portfolio. Another doctor in the Svenduv government, Indranil Khan, will handle the departments of Youth Services and Sports, and Consumer Affairs.

Ashok Dinda, former cricketer, is now Minister of State for Agricultural Marketing, MSMEs and Textiles. Kalita Maji, who once worked as a household help and battled against all odds to become an MLA, has become the MoS for Housing.

On May 9, Adhikari was sworn in along with five Cabinet Ministers — Dilip Ghosh, Agnimitra Paul, Ashok Kirtania, Nisith Pramanik, and Kshudiram Tudu — who were assigned their portfolios after a couple of days.

precisely: “Even when it’s relatively quiet, it still buzzes because there are so many people in there. It gets louder when their opponents start to fade. You can’t get close, you can’t get the ball off them, and it makes it so much worse. You start to implode.”

Mexico’s coach Javier Aguirre has urged the crowd to roar and fuel his team toward something historic. El Tri — the name given by locals to the national side — have won 68 of their 92 international games at this ground, losing only seven.

Somewhere far below all of it, under the concrete and the volcanic rock, the spring Alvarez described is still there, almost touching the other world. Thursday night, 87,500 people will stand above it.

UAPA CASE IN HIGH COURT

‘Bail rule, denial exception’: Khurram Parvez gets bail

Activist to remain in jail since bail plea in another UAPA case pending

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 10

UNDERLINING THAT bail is the rule and its denial an exception, the Delhi High Court Wednesday granted bail to Kashmiri human rights activist Khurram Parvez in a 2021 terror case. The National Investigation Agency (NIA), which filed the case, had accused him of recruiting overground workers for the banned terror outfit Lashkar-e-Taiba.

Parvez will, however, continue to remain in jail, owing to a 2020 NIA case also under the stringent anti-terror law. His bail plea in the second case is pending before the trial court.

Observing that the trial in the case is at the stage of arguments for framing of charges,

and that the prosecution intends to examine 197 witnesses in case charges are framed, the court recorded that there “is no likelihood of the trial ending soon”.

“(Allegations) must be tested against the long period of incarceration of (Parvez), the fact that there is no likelihood of the trial ending soon, as also against the yardstick of bail being the rule, while denial thereof being an exception. (Parvez’s) rights (to liberty)... need to be balanced and may even trump the restriction imposed under Section 43D(5) of the UAPA,” the bench of Justices Navin Chawla and Ravinder Dudeja said.

While granting Parvez bail, the bench also took into account that he is infirm “and de-



Khurram Parvez was accused of recruiting overground workers for banned terror outfit LeT.

serves special consideration”. In 2004, Parvez had lost a leg in a landmine blast, resulting in permanent disability.

As part of his bail conditions, Parvez has been directed to not leave NCT of Delhi without prior permission of the court and “not upload/share/disseminate or circulate any anti-national ma-

terial on any social media platform or otherwise”.

In November 2021, the NIA arrested Parvez for offences of waging war against the state, criminal conspiracy, as well as for allegedly raising funds for terror funding under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). The FIR in this case was lodged on November 6, 2021. Parvez was arrested on November 22, 2021.

Earlier, in 2020, the NIA lodged a case accusing NGOs of terror funding by allegedly diverting funds meant for charitable activities to “secessionist and separatist activities” in Jammu and Kashmir. This case was registered on October 8, 2020, under various sections of the IPC and the UAPA. While Parvez was not named initially, he was subsequently arrested in this case in March 2023.

In 2016, Parvez was arrested under the Public Safety Act and spent 76 days in custody.

• Skywatch


Forecast: June 11, 2026
Light rain, thunderstorm
MAX: 40-42
2.1°C above normal
MIN: 27-29
1°C above normal

• AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar
Satisfactory
AQI: 96

Burari
Moderate
AQI: 170

Chandni Chowk
Moderate
AQI: 158

ITO
Moderate
AQI: 142

● Good (0-50)

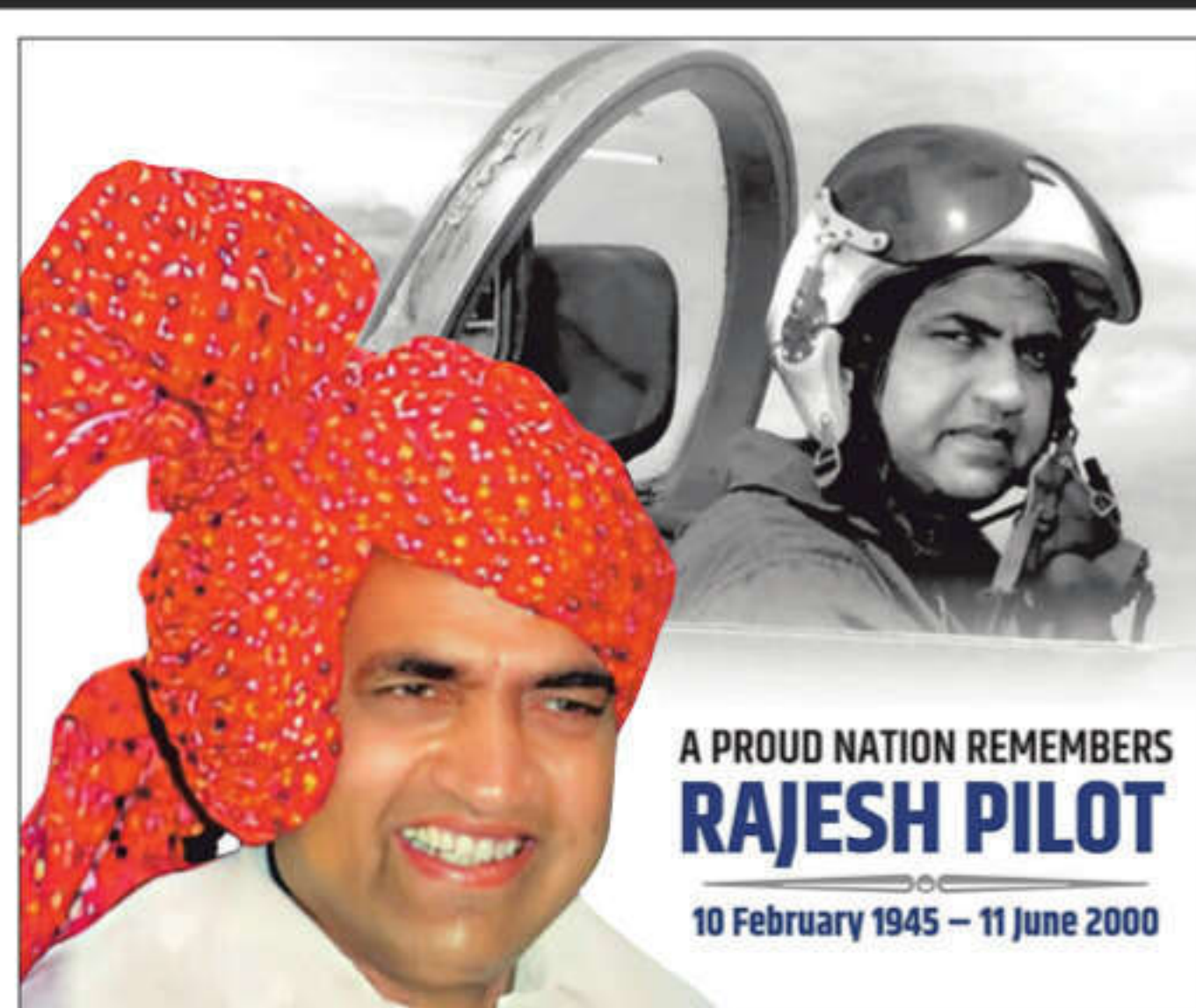
● Satisfactory (51-100)

● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)



A PROUD NATION REMEMBERS
RAJESH PILOT
10 February 1945 – 11 June 2000

RERA Registration Number : DLRERA2026P0005
weblink: https://rera.delhi.gov.in/registered_promoters_list





A Life time GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY to own prime property
Sale open through e-Auction

Bharat Business Park (BBP)

Sarojini Nagar, New Delhi

A rare opportunity to own commercial space in a landmark business address, offering two modern towers and premium amenities for future-ready enterprises.



Freehold Commercial Space

Key Highlights

- Strategically located on Ring Road, Sarojini Nagar, Opposite WTC, New Delhi
- Walking Distance from Sarojini Nagar Metro Station (Pink Line) and AIIMS Metro Station (Yellow Line)
- IGI Airport - 17 km & New Delhi Railway Station-12 km

Key Features

- Centralized AC and energy-efficient fixtures
- EV Charging Facilities
- 3-level basement parking
- GRIHA Compliant Building
- Roof top solar panels
- Sewage Treatment Plant
- Solid Waste Management

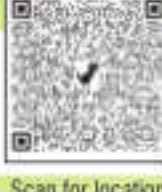
Last Date of receiving EMD: 12.06.2026

Date of e-Auction: 13.06.2026

HURRY UP!
to own this prime property in Tower 1 & Tower 5 through this E-Auction



Reserve price: **₹39,100 /sq.ft.**



REDEVELOPMENT OF SAROJINI NAGAR BY - NBCC (INDIA) LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ENTERPRISE)
ON BEHALF OF : MINISTRY OF HOUSING AND URBAN AFFAIRS
CORPORATE OFFICE : NBCC BHAWAN, LODHI ROAD, NEW DELHI-110003 | CIN-L74899DL1960G01003335

* Refer application form available at:
Website: www.nbccindia.in/buyproperties
Follow us on:  /OfficialNBCC  @OfficialNBCC



Scan to download application form.

Call @ 9899179426, 8168059012, 8527509652

‘Judgment indicates what we have held’: NewsClick founder as HC quashes money laundering charges

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, June 10

AFTER DELHI High Court’s verdict quashing money laundering proceedings, and a predicate offence of cheating against digital news portal NewsClick and its founder Prabir Purkayastha was made public on Wednesday, Purkayastha told *The Indian Express*, “The judgement has indicated what we have always held.”

The court, noting that the offences alleged by the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) are not

made out, held that continuing the FIR “is nothing but a gross abuse of the process of law”.

The FIR by the EOW was lodged on August 26, 2020, alleging violations of FDI norms. Thereafter, the Enforcement Directorate (ED) lodged a complaint based on the EOW’s FIR, on September 2, 2020.

In June 2021, the HC granted Purkayastha interim protection against coercive steps in the ED case and a month later, in the EOW case.

The protection of anticipatory bail in the EOW case was

made final in July 2025. The HC had taken the prolonged probe, as well as the fact that Purkayastha is “a respectable man, aged about 75 years, having roots in the society”, to reason that there is “no likelihood of tampering with the evidence or of influencing the witnesses”.

In August 2023, Delhi Police carried out raids at the residential and official premises of PPK NewsClick Studio Pvt Ltd, and lodged an FIR under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). Purkayastha was arrested in connection with

this FIR on October 3, 2023. He challenged his arrest and remand and the violation of due procedures of custody, including not being provided with the grounds of arrest.

The Supreme Court, in a landmark verdict in May 2024 declaring his arrest and remand invalid, had extended procedural safeguards to arrests under UAPA. The verdict came after police had filed a chargesheet in the case in March that year. The SC had also directed his release on bail in this case, after he spent seven months in jail.

MIT Art, Design & Technology University, Pune.



ADMISSIONS OPEN 2026-27

Ph.D. PROGRAMMES
(FULL TIME / PART TIME)

Full-time Research scholars are eligible for a monthly stipend as per latest university norms

PROGRAMS OFFERED

- Aerospace | Civil | Electronics & Communication | Mechanical Engineering
- Physics | Chemistry | Mathematics | Statistics | Bioengineering
- Computer Science & Engineering | Food Technology
- Design | Architecture | Management
- English | Education | Fine Arts
- Psychology | Vedic Sciences
- Drama | Law

(PET Application Fees : Rs. 3000/-)

Important Dates	Application Start Date	Application End Date	Ph. D. Entrance Test (PET)
	5 th June 2026	14 th July 2026	18 th July 2026

www.mituniversity.ac.in/research | **Apply Now**

7391082725 | admissions.phd@mituniversity.edu.in
Vishwarajbaug, Loni kalbhor, Pune 412 201.



FORGOTTEN MONEY IN YOUR OLD BANK ACCOUNTS?



RBI will help you recover what’s yours.

Money in Inoperative Accounts (inactive for more than 2 years and up to 10 years) lying with your bank / Undaclaimed Deposits (Beyond 10 years) is transferred to DEA Fund of RBI.
You or your legal heirs can claim it anytime.



3 EASY STEPS TO CLAIM YOUR MONEY

1. Visit any branch of your bank, even if it’s not your regular branch
2. Submit a form with KYC documents (Aadhaar, Passport, Voter ID, or Driving Licence)
3. Receive your money with interest, if any, after verification

To find your undclaimed deposits

Search your bank's website or check RBI's UDGM portal (<https://udgam.rbi.org.in>) covering 30 banks currently.





For more details, visit <https://rbikehtahai.rbi.org.in>
For feedback, write to rbikehtahai@rbi.org.in

Official WhatsApp No. 99990 41935



Issued in public interest by
भारतीय रिज़र्व बैंक
RESERVE BANK OF INDIA
www.rbi.org.in

epaper.indianexpress.com

RED FLAGS IN CLUB RECORDS, DRAFT FORENSIC REPORT

Delhi Gymkhana files: Dead members dining, drone over VIP zone, crores in legal fees, auditor exit



The Union Government has asked Delhi Gymkhana to vacate its 27.3-acre plot. EXPRESS FILE

Jay Mazoomdaar
New Delhi, June 10

DECEASED MEMBERS' cards used for food and drink purchases; a drone flown near the Prime Minister's residence; members hired by the club for legal and other services; spiralling legal expenses; and, a long-serving auditor stepping down after raising concerns about access to records.

These are among the several unresolved questions hanging over the Delhi Gymkhana Club, according to internal records reviewed by *The Indian Express*, even as the Government has asked the capital landmark to vacate its 27.3-acre plot for "strengthening and securing defence infrastructure" — a matter now in court.

Club records also show that members have refused to approve its audited accounts while the Government-appointed administration continues to withhold a forensic audit it had commissioned shortly after taking charge in April 2022.

This newspaper reviewed a draft report of that forensic audit — covering financial expenses during 2017-18 and 2021-22 — prepared by Baker Tilly Business Advisory Services and submitted by the administration in November 2022 to the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) as part of a quarterly status report.

The findings are telling. Reviewing catering sales data, the draft report listed 31 potential instances of alleged billing in the names of "expired members", concluding that the possibility of non-members enjoying the club's facilities could not be ruled out.

Asked about the contents of the draft report and club records reviewed, club president Malay K Sinha declined to comment, saying "every matter of Gymkhana is in some court or the other".

Club veteran and former General Committee member Major (Retired) Atul Dev said, "After a member's death, the wife becomes a member under the Lady Subscriber category. This process may take some time, and it is possible that some deceased members' cards were continued to be used by their wives under the advice of the club management till their own cards were issued."

Questions about the alleged misuse of members' cards re-

surfaced in 2024. According to a general diary entry on July 13 that year at the Chanakyapuri police station, the club's Food and Beverage manager Rajesh Bhatnagar allegedly misused the card of an ailing, elderly member to buy drinks for four unauthorised guests and made the payment in cash. Bhatnagar, who now also serves as Gymkhana's officiating secretary, said: "I have received your mail. I'll do the needful." He did not respond to subsequent emails or messages.

The final forensic report was submitted shortly after the draft, and a five-member committee constituted in December 2022 to examine the findings recommended follow-up action in 2023. Three years on, the final report remains under wraps.

High legal fees

The draft forensic report, meanwhile, recorded multiple instances of club members being allegedly engaged as vendors and lawyers. They include: ● Eight instances "where directors of the vendor companies (including relatives) are members" of the club, and total purchases of Rs 36 crore between 2016-17 and 2020-21 from vendors who were "not disclosed as related parties".

● Members appointed as the club's lawyers and paid a total of Rs 1.95 crore, including Rs 77 lakh to Arun Kathpalia, Rs 28.76 lakh to Gaurav Mohan Liberhan, and Rs 20 lakh to Harish Salvie.

The new governing body stopped hiring club members as lawyers after it took charge in April 2022. But, records show, that did not bring down the club's legal bill — from Rs 1.84 crore in 2021-22 to Rs 2.09 crore in 2022-23. From 2018-19 to 2022-23, records show, the club spent Rs 8.22 crore on litigation.

Noting that "legal costs have become a material cost incurred by the Club", the 2022-23 auditor's report highlighted legal expenses as an area where verification was difficult because of incomplete records, unavailable legal files, and lack of information regarding the status of litigation matters.

Red flags

In its 2021-22 audit report, auditor Khanna and Anandhanam raised multiple red flags, including club expenditure not controlled through a budgeting process, no internal audit, lack

of internal control over financial reporting, mismatch between accounts maintained in software and in manual records and unavailable records.

These alerts reappeared in the 2022-23 report after the Government-appointed management took charge with the stated purpose of ushering in reforms and best practices.

After nine years, records show, Khanna and Anandhanam resigned with effect from March 31, 2024, citing the impending retirement of one of its partners who handled the Gymkhana account. The club's last annual general meeting, held in December 2023, refused to approve its accounts.

In the 2023-24 annual report, new auditor AVA & Associates also raised the issues of not having access to certain records.

Mystery drone

A reference to the club's location as "a highly sensitive and strategic area of Delhi" in the latest Government notice has also revived the spectre of an alleged security breach in August 2022 — related to the use of a drone allegedly from the club premises, which shares a boundary with the PM's residence.

In a note to the Ministry of Corporate Affairs dated October 1, 2022, the Delhi Police acknowledged a complaint that certain officials of the club "and some anti-social elements carried out the drone activities in the prohibited area endangering the security" of the PM.

"During inquiry, it was revealed that an unauthorised Tiranga Yatra was carried out on 13.08.2022 at a place where movements of VVIPs were expected soon... Investigation is in progress. Accordingly, action will be taken against the violators," the note said.

In June 2023, an inspector with the Chanakyapuri police station told a Patiala House court that a "concerned security agency" detected, through its technical equipment located at Lok Kalyan Marg, drone activity for approximately two minutes on August 13, 2022, but information on the "exact location" was still awaited.

Asked if a closure report was filed, a senior officer with the Chanakyapuri station said the case was transferred to the EOW. When contacted, a senior EOW officer could recall "no such case".

ALLEGATION OF Rs 3 CRORE BRIBERY DEMAND

Delhi Police inspector held, officer posted with DGCA under CBI lens

Mahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, June 10

THE CENTRAL Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested a Delhi Police inspector for allegedly accepting a bribe of Rs 1 crore from the prime accused in the Rs 5,000-crore counterfeit medicine racket in Pudukkottai on the promise of securing relief in the cases filed by the agency.

The Central agency is now probing the role of "an IPS officer serving in a post of Regional Director with the Directorate General of Civil Aviation, who allegedly told N Raja alias Valliappan alias Rajasekar — the main accused in the counterfeit medicine racket case — that he could arrange relief in the CBI cases through his connections within the agency and demanded Rs 3 crore from him.

"We have identified him and after informing his department,

are likely to summon him in the coming days to join the investigation," a source said.

On June 8, the CBI had registered an FIR against Raja, Pradeep Kumar Singh, an inspector with the Delhi Police Crime Branch's Southern Range and Rajkumar alias Madhanraj, who is alleged to have acted as an intermediary. The FIR also names unknown public servants and private individuals.

"Raja had arranged a payment of Rs 1 crore through a hawala transaction. Pradeep Kumar Singh received the payment through hawala operator and gave it to one Prabhat, who was known to an IPS officer. Singh kept the remaining Rs 25 lakh in his house. The CBI had arrested Singh and Rajkumar with the balance amount of Rs 24.70 lakh," the agency said.

The amount was the first instalment of a larger payoff, according to CBI.

Police sources said the IPS officer is likely to be summoned in the coming days to join the investigation

The source said that according to the FIR, Singh, in criminal conspiracy with the other accused, had been indulging in corrupt activities by facilitating the payment of illegal gratification to secure undue relief in the CBI cases. He also claimed he had influence over investigating officers and other public servants connected with the probe.

The counterfeit and spurious medicines manufacturing operation was uncovered following raids by the police and the CB-CID in Pudukkottai last year, during which massive stocks of fake drugs and raw

materials were seized. Raja was arrested in December. The Pudukkottai Police later found the involvement of several politicians, and, given the gravity of the case, the investigation was transferred to CBI. The agency officially registered a fresh case against Raja in March this year.

"After the fresh registration of the FIR, Raja started looking for a source in the CBI and met Inspector Singh, who assured him that he could secure major relief in the CBI case through his contacts. He was told that his senior officer would help him and would charge a fee for doing so," an official said.

According to the FIR, Raja and Rajkumar met Singh at Aerocity near IGI Airport on May 14. "Singh allegedly escorted both of them to the office of an unidentified senior public servant located in the vicinity and introduced them to him. During the meeting, the senior

public servant allegedly assured Raja that favourable relief in the CBI cases could be secured through his connections within the agency," the FIR alleged.

It further alleged that on May 16, Raja told his wife that the public servant had agreed to help in the pending cases in return for Rs 3 crore and had sought an advance of Rs 1.5 crore. "Raja then allegedly began arranging the money through his contacts. Rajkumar later travelled to Vadodra and met Singh to work out the modalities for delivering the bribe money to public servants in Delhi. After the meeting, both allegedly travelled to Delhi together. Raja asked his wife to keep the funds ready, as the advance payment had to be delivered urgently, and contacted a hawala operator in Chennai to transfer Rs 1 crore to Delhi as part of the advance bribe payment," the FIR said.

BUILDING COLLAPSE NEAR SAKET METRO STATION

Contractor hid in Dehradun, Manali; used 'dumb phone' to evade police

Pragynesh & Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 10

A "DUMB phone" used to evade police surveillance and a Rs 1.8-crore contract to add two illegal floors have emerged as key findings in the probe into the May 30 building collapse at Saidulajab near Saket Metro station that claimed six lives, even as the MCD has issued notices to owners of nearly 100 structures in the area and its surroundings that fall under the jurisdiction of Mehrauli over illegal construction.

On Tuesday, contractors Manish Khatri and Avinash Gupta were arrested near the office of Khatri's lawyer in Vasant Kunj. Earlier, the owner of the building, Karambir Sejwal, had been arrested in connection with the case.

"Khatri used a dumb phone — a basic mobile device meant for calls and texts — in order to escape tracking. Right after the building collapsed, he fled to Manali initially, and then to Dehradun," a source in the police said.

A team from Mehrauli police station tracked Khatri across the hill towns, but the absence of a smartphone made it difficult to pinpoint his location. Investigators said he frequently changed motels to avoid detection.

"On Monday night, we got a tip that he and Gupta would be coming to meet their lawyer in Vasant Kunj. A trap was laid, and he was arrested on Tuesday afternoon," said a source.



The MCD has issued notices to owners of nearly 100 structures in Mehrauli. (Above) The site of the collapse. SHREYA SINGHAI

Sources further said that Khatri, a relative of Sejwal, has allegedly been involved in several illegal construction projects in Saidulajab and nearby areas. "He was also involved in the construction of two other properties owned by Sejwal in Paryavaran Colony. His company is around eight years old. For this project in Saidulajab in Saket, Khatri and Gupta were awarded a contract worth Rs 1.8 crore," a police officer said.

Police said the probe so far has found that the building that collapsed had been constructed eight years ago and that its basement was not structurally capable of bearing the additional load of two more floors.

"One extra floor had already been constructed, while work on another was underway. However, construction had reportedly been halted for several days due to a payment dispute when the building collapsed,"

said a source.

Meanwhile, taking cognisance of letters written by the Delhi Police regarding illegal constructions in Saidulajab and nearby localities in Mehrauli, the MCD has served notices to the owners of around 100 such buildings over the last two weeks, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Sources said the notices were primarily served to buildings that have floors constructed beyond the permissible limit.

According to MCD officials, the South Zone has taken action against around 80 such buildings, including several structures located in Saidulajab. The South Zone covers areas such as Malviya Nagar, Hauz Khas, Greater Kailash, RK Puram, Munirka, Vasant Vihar, Mehrauli, Chhattarpur, Aya Nagar, and Green Park. Officials added that Saidulajab falls under the jurisdiction of Mehrauli.

B&B fire: Bangladeshi national who had come for husband's kidney transplant dies; toll 23

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

FOR A week, 38-year-old Rahana Akhtar fought for life in a hospital after a fire at Flourish Stays B&B in South Delhi's Malviya Nagar claimed the lives of her brother and 21 others. On Wednesday, the Bangladeshi national — who had come to the Capital for her husband's kidney transplant — succumbed to her injuries, becoming the 23rd casualty of the June 3 blaze.

She is the 14th foreign national to lose her life in the fire.

Rahana had arrived in Delhi from Dhaka on June 2 along with her husband, Mosharaf Hossain (44), who was scheduled to undergo a kidney transplant at near Max Hospital in Saket — located near the B&B — and her brother Md Nurul Amin (44), who had accompanied the couple to assist them during their stay in Delhi. Hossain's sister Zohra, the donor, and her daughter had also come with them.

"They landed in Delhi on June 2 evening and stayed the night at the Delhi airport. The next day, they went to a cafe to eat," Md Robiul (33), Amin's brother-in-law, told *The Indian Express*.

The cafe was located on the first floor of the B&B. As Amin and the family ate, just before they planned to visit the hospi-



Outside the B&B in Malviya Nagar. SHREYA SINGHAI

tal, a fire broke out in the building. Amin was among the initial 22 people who died in the fire, while Hossain, Rahana, Zohra and her daughter sustained injuries.

"People from the Embassy told me that they were eating at the restaurant when the fire broke out. I think because they were on the first floor, at least the others managed to get out in time. Amin couldn't," Robiul added.

Police suspect the fire was triggered by a short circuit. As per the FIR, B&B owner Lavkesh Bajaj owner did not ensure adequate safety measures at the building, resulting in the fire.

Police have found that Bajaj purchased the property in 2022, when it was a three-storey building being used for a garment business. He converted it into a bed-and-breakfast facility and, seeing the demand from foreign patients visiting hospitals in the area, and added more floors.

On-duty traffic cop injured after being hit by speeding car

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

A TRAFFIC police head constable sustained injuries after he was allegedly hit by a speeding car being driven from the wrong side in Southeast Delhi's Sarai Julena on Tuesday morning, Delhi Police said.

According to the police, information regarding a medico-

legal case was received from Fortis Escorts Hospital through a General Diary entry at New Friends Colony police station on Wednesday. A team rushed to the hospital and found that the injured traffic police officer was undergoing treatment.

The victim was identified as Head Constable Rahul Kumar who was on duty at the Sarai Julena red light at the time of

the incident, officers said.

During inquiry, Kumar told police that the incident happened around 10.30 am when a vehicle, allegedly being driven rashly, negligently and at high speed, from the wrong side of the road, hit him while he was performing his duties.

Police said the offending vehicle fled immediately after the collision, leaving the injured of-

ficer at the spot. Kumar was taken to Fortis Escorts Hospital later.

Based on the complaint and preliminary findings, a case has been registered at New Friends Colony police station under relevant sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, along with Section 184 of the Motor Vehicles Act.

During the initial investiga-

tion, police examined footage of CCTV cameras installed in the area and the surrounding routes that helped them identify the offending vehicle — a black Kia car.

Efforts are underway to trace the vehicle and apprehend the accused driver, police said, adding that teams have been deployed and further investigation is underway.

● KILLED BY TENANTS AT HER APARTMENT IN EAST DELHI'S VASUNDHARA ENCLAVE

At 43, DU asst professor finally had the life she wanted... then she was murdered

Vidheesha Kuntamalla & Alok Singh
New Delhi, June 10

LAST WEEK, 43-year-old Debosmita Paul, an Assistant Professor at Delhi University's Shivaji College, had a chat with her colleague Nidhi Garg about a trip she wanted to take during the summer break.

Garg, also an Assistant Professor, was preparing for a trip to Kashmir. Paul wanted to take her elderly parents to her maternal grandfather's home near West Bengal's Bardhaman, where her mother loved spending summers.

"Now I am like a parent to my parents," she told Garg. The

two women then drifted into a conversation about sarees. She jokingly asked Paul to bring her a saree from Bengal and Paul promised she would.

But the trip never happened.

On June 4, Paul was found murdered inside her apartment in East Delhi's Vasundhara Enclave.

She lived alone; her husband was in Bengaluru.

CCTV footage led police to the accused — a couple from Bengal, who travelled to Delhi, along with their 13-year-old son, to murder Paul. While the couple were arrested, their son was apprehended.

Police said the couple wanted to buy from Paul the

house in Bardhaman where they were living as tenants. Paul, however, refused and asked them to vacate the house by June.

The crime, police said, appeared premeditated. The accused man (42) frequently travelled to Delhi for work. He allegedly conducted reconnaissance of Paul's residence.

On June 4, they were captured in CCTV cameras entering Paul's apartment complex wearing masks. According to investigators, Paul offered the couple to vacate her property and that led to an argument, after which she was attacked on the head with a



Debosmita Paul (left) with Shivaji College Principal Virender Bharadwaj and colleague Nidhi Garg.

mortar and pestle. To ensure that she was dead, the man allegedly attempted to cut her

wrists with the razor.

The incident has shocked Paul's colleagues across DU.

In a condolence message issued on June 5, Shivaji College described her death as "an irreparable loss".

Paul was a member of the college's cultural committee, the Women's Development Cell, and the editorial board of the college magazine. She mentored students and organised programmes.

For Shivaji College Principal Virender Bharadwaj, the loss is difficult to comprehend. "She was like my daughter."

At the college, where Paul spent the last two-and-a-half years of her life as a permanent faculty member, conversations have turned towards the woman they knew.

Bharadwaj had watched Paul become an integral part of campus life. Paul had also taught at Maharaja Agrasen College as an ad hoc faculty member.

Bharadwaj described Paul as sensitive, responsible. "I never heard any complaint about her."

An English literature scholar, Paul worked closely with student theatre groups and cultural societies.

For two years, Garg and Paul organised workshops through Udaan, a cultural initiative.

Together, they introduced students to traditional Indian art forms. The workshops became some of their proudest

projects. "We all called her Debo," Garg said.

"Many teachers spend years pursuing permanent appointments and eventually settle into routine. Not Paul... she was always thinking..." she added.

However, colleagues knew little about the difficulties Paul carried beyond campus. "I knew she was married but living separately from her husband. She had no children," Garg said.

But the colleagues knew how devoted she was to her elderly parents.

"It is not easy being a single woman and taking care of elderly parents," Garg said.



SIMPLE ACCESSIBLE EMPOWERED



Shri Vishnu Deo Sai
Hon'ble Chief Minister, Chhattisgarh

POSITIVE REFORMS AND INNOVATION

Turning the Vision of Progress and
Prosperity into Reality



Shri Narendra Modi
Hon'ble Prime Minister of India

Administrative Reforms

- ▶ Department of Good Governance and Convergence established
- ▶ Promotion of e-Governance and e-Office systems
- ▶ Atal Dashboard
- ▶ Chief Minister's Good Governance Fellowship
- ▶ CM Helpline 1076



Revenue & Registration Reforms

- ▶ **119** Registration Offices being transformed to smart offices
- ▶ Geo-referencing to prevent land disputes
- ▶ Simplified registry process through **10** revolutionary reforms and the Sugam App
- ▶ Ownership rights granted through forest rights titles (patta)



Ease of Doing Business

- ▶ First state to implement **Jan Vishwas 2.0**
- ▶ Faster approvals through the **Invest Chhattisgarh Portal** with one-click single-window clearance
- ▶ **Startup and Innovation** Policy 2025–30 implemented
- ▶ Recognised as a "High Performer" among landlocked states/regions in **LEADS 2025** by the Government of India



Digitalisation of Public Services

- ▶ Atal Panchayat Digital Service Centres in **6,090** Gram Panchayats
- ▶ More than **441** citizen services on the single Seva Setu digital platform
- ▶ Online facility for temporary electricity connections



Transparency & Anti-Corruption Measures

- ▶ Government procurement through the GeM Portal
- ▶ Transparency in recruitment examinations and stringent Anti-Cheating Laws
- ▶ Transparent mineral transit pass system
- ▶ Transparent e-auction of timber and mineral blocks



12
Saal

Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rajiv Kumar Sharma** S/o Triloki Nath Sharma R/o H. No. 29/438, New Moti Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 44/2017 U/s 323/354A/354B/509/506/34 IPC, PS South Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rajiv Kumar Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajiv Kumar Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajiv Kumar Sharma** in **FIR No. 44/2017 U/s 323/354A/354B/509/506/34 IPC, PS South Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.07.2026**.

By order
Ms. Neha Goel
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/7637/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Naseem** S/o Aslam R/o R-7/A, Gali No. 20, Brahampuri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 136/2017 u/s 498/406 IPC & 4 DP Act at P.S. G.T.B. Enclave, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Naseem** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Naseem** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Naseem** accused of FIR No. 136/2017 u/s 498/406 IPC & 4 DP Act at P.S. G.T.B. Enclave, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **06.08.2026**

By Order: **Ms. Shipra Dhankar,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class (Mahila Court)-01,
Room No. 55, 2nd Floor,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7683/SHD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Veena Kapoor, W/o: Shashi Kapoor, R/o: B-44, Rama Park Road, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI ACT.: 2417/2021, U/s: 138 NI ACT, P.S. Prashant Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Veena Kapoor** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Veena Kapoor** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Veena Kapoor of P.S. Prashant Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Aakash Sharma
JMFC-03, Room No. 213,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7716/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Devesh Joshi** S/o Harish Chander Joshi R/o H. No. WZ-470, Khasra No. 698, 2nd Floor, Village Basai Darapur, Near Ramesh Nagar Metro Station West, Zakhira, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence Case Reg. No. 4447/2023 u/s 25 Passa Act at P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Devesh Joshi** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Devesh Joshi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C. has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Devesh Joshi** accused of Reg. No. 4447/2023 u/s 25 Passa Act at P.S. Maurya Enclave, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **31.08.2026**.

By Order: **Sh. Sanyam Jain,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04 (North-West),
Room No. 112, 1st Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6807/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Mohan Singh Vohra** S/o Sh. Sher Singh Vohra R/o H. No. 219/A Street No. 15, Sadatpur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CT No. 1343/2019 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Shakarpur, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Mohan Singh Vohra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mohan Singh Vohra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Mohan Singh Vohra** in **CT No. 1343/2019 U/s 138 NI ACT, PS Shakarpur, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.10.2026**.

By order
Sh. Sachin
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
East District, Court No. 16
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/7473/ED/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused persons Namely (1) **Fardeen** S/o Jhar R/o E-1/272, Nand Nagari, North East, Delhi, **Also At: H. No 1417, Jania Flats, Near GTB Hospital, Delhi** (2) **Saharukh S/o Abdul Hafiz R/o 60B, LIG Flats, Tulsi Niketan Sahibabad, Gaziabad UP,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 225/2021 U/S 392/411/34 IPC PS: Patparganj Industrial Area, East District, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused (1) **Fardeen** (2) **Saharukh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) **Fardeen** (2) **Saharukh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said (1) **Fardeen** (2) **Saharukh** accused of **FIR No. 225/2021 U/S 392/411/34 IPC PS: Patparganj Industrial Area, East District, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. P. Bhargav Rao
JMFC-05, Room No. 03 Second Floor
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/7087/ED/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Pramod, S/o: Prem Pal, R/o: Pana Dulan, Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 80111403/2024 U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Bawana, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pramod** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pramod** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Pramod** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 80111403/2024 U/s 392/411/34 IPC, P.S.: Bawana, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **31.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7704/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Pedro Maria Tobar Garcia** S/o Bram Kayzer has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 778/2014 U/s 20/22/22(C)/29 NDPS ACT, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Pedro Maria Tobar Garcia** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pedro Maria Tobar Garcia** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Pedro Maria Tobar Garcia** in **FIR No. 778/2014 U/s 20/22/22(C)/29 NDPS ACT, PS Anand Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **25.07.2026**.

By order
Sh. Gajender Singh Nagar
Special Judge (NDPS)
Shahdara, Room No.11, Second Floor
Shahdara Karkardooma Courts Complex, Delhi

DP/7569/SHD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sachin Kapoor, S/o: Shashi Kapoor, R/o: B-44, Rama Park Road, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC NI Act No. 2417/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S.: Prashant Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sachin Kapoor** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sachin Kapoor** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sachin Kapoor** accused of offence in case **CC NI Act No. 2417/2021, U/s 138 NI Act, P.S.: Prashant Vihar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Aakash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 213, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/7720/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **SONU S/o Bheem Singh, R/o 51/09 Kishangarh, New Delhi,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 000012/2021, U/S 356/379/411 IPC, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, South-East Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **SONU** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **SONU** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that **SONU** the said accused of **FIR No. 000012/2021, U/S 356/379/411 IPC, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, South-East Distt., Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
South-East, Court No.-512,
Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/7788/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Santosh Yadav S/o Balashwar Yadav R/o Gali No. 26, Vill. Zumrudpur, New Delhi,** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 194/2015, U/s: 392/511/452/454 IPC,** registered at P.S.: **Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi,** and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Santosh Yadav,** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Santosh Yadav,** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Santosh Yadav, FIR No.: 194/2015, U/s: 392/511/452/454 IPC,** registered at P.S.: **Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi,** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-3
South East Distt., Room No.512
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/7793/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Saurabh Kumar S/o Lt. Vipin Mishra, R/o: H. No. F-27, Gali No. 1, Hari Nagar, Part-2, Jaitpur, New Delhi** also O-375, Saurabh Vihar, Jaitpur, New Delhi (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 194/2023, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS Act,** Date: 04.04.2023, registered at P.S.: Jaitpur, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Saurabh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Saurabh Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Saurabh Kumar** accused **FIR No. 194/2023, U/s 27/61/85 NDPS Act,** registered at P.S.: Jaitpur, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Chhavi Bansal, LD.
Judicial Magistrate First Class -11
Court Room No. : 09, Main Building
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/7729/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

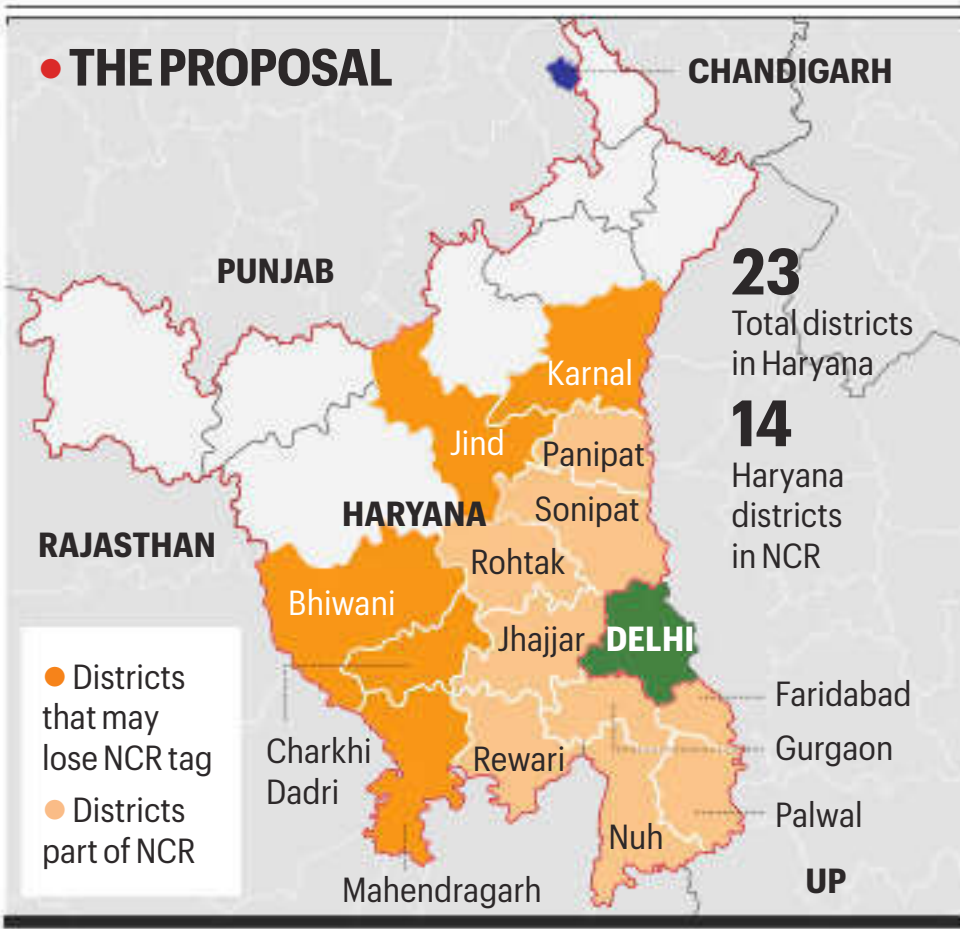
Haryana seeks to reduce NCR footprint, limit it to areas within 100 km of Delhi

Sukhbir Siwach
Chandigarh, June 10

CITING LOSSES arising from regulatory restrictions imposed across the National Capital Region (NCR) — be it to curb pollution or for other infrastructural matters — Haryana has proposed limiting NCR's footprint in the state to tehsil located within a 100-km radius of Delhi, instead of the current nearly 200 km, *The Indian Express* has learnt.

The proposal, which could see at least two to three districts lose their NCR status, is set to come up before the NCR Planning Board at its June 16 meeting. The board is headed by Union Minister for Housing and Urban Affairs Manohar Lal, who was the Chief Minister of Haryana when the demand was first made by the state in 2021.

The NCR currently covers 14 of Haryana's 23 districts and spans 25,327 sq km, accounting for 45.98% of the total NCR area — the largest so far.



For the last four years, the Haryana government has been pushing for the exclusion of Jind, Bhiwani, Mahendragarh, Charkhi Dadri and Karnal from the NCR list. It has maintained that these districts located far away from Delhi, do not serve

the NCR's original objective of reducing developmental and urbanisation pressures on the Capital.

In 2022, the then Haryana government led by Manohar Lal had sought at least a one-third reduction in the state's

share of the NCR. Manohar Lal had then argued that Haryana was facing more disadvantages than benefits due to the extensive NCR footprint.

"The state is facing losses due to an excessive area under NCR," he had said.

"The area under NCR was expanded to reduce the urbanisation burden on the National Capital of Delhi. Thus, it was decided to develop the adjoining areas also with parallel facilities, infrastructure and other amenities. The area kept on exceeding. However, with that expansion, certain ill-effects were also being noticed," he had said.

Referring to regulatory restrictions imposed across NCR, he had further said, "For instance, when NGT imposes restrictions — be it to curb pollution or other infrastructural curbs — the entire portion (of Haryana in NCR) gets affected. With reduction in the area under NCR, at least a large proportion of such areas shall be free from such restrictions."

Rs 67.92-cr cyber fraud linked to over 159 cases unearthed: Mule account identified, 1 arrested

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

OFFICERS AT East Delhi Cyber Police Station were looking at some complaints registered on the National Cybercrime Reporting Portal (NCRP) when they came across an account multiple times. Opened at the National Urban Cooperative Bank's New Kondli branch, the account, officers found, was not only linked to complaints registered in the district, but over 159 cyber fraud cases reported across India.

On Wednesday, officers arrested a deputy manager of the bank for allegedly facilitating the opening of the said account. Investigators found that nearly Rs 67.92 crore had been routed through the account, making the case one of the significant ones involving mule accounts, unearthed by Delhi Police in the recent months. A case was filed.

"The account was registered in the name of Mahakal Enterprises and purportedly belonged to one Shailendra Kumar Yadav. However, when police

traced and questioned him, he denied opening it, visiting the bank branch or signing any document," DCP (East) Rajeev Ranjan said.

Investigators subsequently found that he actually did not visit the bank during the period when the account was opened. Further inquiry revealed that the signatures on the forms did not match his. Officers thus concluded that his identity and credentials had allegedly been misused without his knowledge. As officers looked for the of-

ficial who was associated with the process of opening the account, bank records pointed to Pabitra Kumar Biswal, the deputy manager at the New Kondli branch.

During questioning, Biswal allegedly told police that he did not visit the address mentioned by the firm in the bank documents. Investigators further revealed that mandatory KYC checks, customer due diligence measures and verification procedures had not been properly carried out.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jitender @ Jain, S/o Shyamlal R/o H.No.222, Metro Vihar, Holambi Khurd, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.482/2019 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jitender @ Jain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jitender @ Jain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jitender @ Jain** of **FIR No.482/2019 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Narela Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.07.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Jyoti Nain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07, North
Court No.06, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/5296/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons (1) **Krishan @ Kishan S/o Banwari Lal R/o H.No. 6/10, Gali No.-8, Chanchal Park, Ranhola, Delhi,** (2) **Boby @ Golu S/o Bhrahm Prakash R/o Chanchal Park, Main Road, Ranhola Bus Stand, Delhi,** have committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 018785/21, U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Nangloi, Outer Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused persons cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused persons have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that (1) **Krishan @ Kishan** (2) **Boby @ Golu** the said accused of **FIR No. 018785/21, U/S 379/411/34 IPC, PS Nangloi, Outer Distt., Delhi,** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.07.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aishwarya Singh Kashyap
Judicial Magistrate First Class-10,
(West), Court No.-345,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/7740/OD/2026
(Court Matter)



NORTHERN RAILWAY

DELHI DIVISION

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

For Hiring of Consultant for Industrial Mapping & Business Development Activities



Delhi Division, Northern Railway invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from eligible Consultancy Firms / Logistics Service Providers / Transportation Entities for providing consultancy services for Industrial Mapping and other Business Development activities in Delhi Division.

BACKGROUND/OBJECTIVE

- Indian Railways has targeted 3000 Million Tonne freight loading by 2030.
- Delhi Division has set an ambitious target of 50 Million Tonnes cargo loading by 2030.
- The objective is to identify untapped industrial hubs, engage with industries, logistics service providers and aggregators, and attract additional freight traffic to Railways.
- The EOI seeks interest from eligible consultancy firms for Industrial Mapping and other Business Development activities in Delhi Division.

SCOPE OF WORK

- Industrial Mapping of various industries in NZM-PWL section
- Industrial Mapping of various industries in ANDI-MOY section
- Coverage to include KKDE-NRW branch line
- Identification of potential freight traffic and business development opportunities

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

S.No.	Criteria	Supporting Document
1.	Entity: Proprietorship Firm / Company/LLP/Partnership Firm / other legally constituted entity	 Self-attested copy of Certificate of Incorporation and constitutional documents
2.	Overall Experience: Minimum 03 years' experience as a Consultancy Firm/Logistics Service Provider/ Transportation Entity	 Self-attested copies of experience certificates / relevant documents

SUBMISSION DETAILS

-  Submit EOI on official letterhead along with required documents
-  Submission Mode: Sealed envelope or signed proposal by email
-  Address: Senior Divisional Operations Manager, DRM Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi - 110055
-  Email ID: scdomcdli@gmail.com
-  Contact No.: 9717648914
-  Office Hours for Enquiry: 10:00 hrs. to 18:00 hrs. IST

 Detailed terms and conditions of the EOI can be accessed on: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

Office of the Senior Divisional Operations Manager

Delhi Division, Northern Railway, DRM Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi - 110055



LAST DATE FOR SUBMISSION: 25.06.2026

1976/2026

epaper.indianexpress.com

Rs 2,169-cr Ahmedabad Metro Phase 2A gets Union Cabinet approval

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

THE UNION Cabinet in a meeting chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday approved the Phase 2A of the Ahmedabad Metro rail project, covering 6.032 km and five stations at a cost of Rs 2,169.04 crore. The new corridor will connect Koteswar Road to the Airport, with stations at Ashram Road, Koteswar Prachin Mandir, Sabarmati River, Sardar Nagar and Airport.

Announcing the decision, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the new corridor would also give a boost to the city's infrastructure for the Commonwealth Games 2030. Once completed, the new corridor would increase Ahmedabad and Gandhinagar's Metro network to 77.63 km. "This phase aims to seamlessly integrate key zones, including residential and commercial hubs, with the existing Ahmedabad-Gandhinagar corridor. Further, likelihood of sports facilities also

being developed in the vicinity for the World Police Games 2029 and Commonwealth Games 2030... Phase 2A will not only enhance connectivity, but also stimulate economic activity, tourism, and ease urban mobility for residents and visitors," a government statement said.

It added that the project would generate employment for around 2,000 people during the peak of the construction phase and 500 people for operation and maintenance of the system.

The Cabinet also approved the construction of a Central government General Pool Office Accommodation in Andhra Pradesh's Amravati. It will be spread over 5.53 acres. "It is designed to accommodate nearly 8,000 officials and staff members. The estimated cost is Rs 1,299.08 crore..." a statement read. The Cabinet also approved a General Pool Residential Accommodation campus for Central government employees in Amravati. The campus would be spread over 17 acres. The estimated cost of the project is Rs 1,234.91 crore.

Will try to bring Tatas back, says BJP minister 18 years after Nano exit from Singur

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata June 10



Tapas Roy, the newly inducted West Bengal Industries Minister

IN HIS first remark after taking charge as the Industries Minister of West Bengal in the newly formed BJP government, Tapas Roy has said his priority would be to convince the Tatas to invest in the state.

The remark is significant because it comes 18 years after an agitation led by Mamata Banerjee forced the Tatas to abandon their Nano project in Bengal's Singur. The Banerjee-led TMC reaped political dividends from the movements against land acquisition in Singur and Nandigram and came to power in Bengal in 2011. Fifteen years on, they have been voted out and lack of industrialisation in Bengal has been one of the BJP's key political planks this poll season.

And now, a month after the BJP came to power and hours after he got his new charge, Roy

has set the tone of the state government's stand on industrialisation. "...Industry and businesses have left Bengal during the former government's tenure. Industry will usher in more job creation in Bengal," Roy said.

"Our priority is to bring back the Tatas. Look what happened to Singur. If needed, I will personally go and hold a meeting (with them). We will try and convince them to return to Bengal." Roy was earlier with Congress and TMC, and was also a minister in the Banerjee government. He joined the BJP in 2024.

Teacher suspended days after she joined 'CJP' protest in Delhi

Express News Service
Chandigarh, June 10

DAYS AFTER a guest teacher from a government school in Rohtak participated in a protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) at Jantar Mantar in Delhi, the Haryana Education Department sus-

pended her from service.

According to an order issued by the District Elementary Education Officer, Rohtak, on June 10, guest teacher Sulekha Dalal was placed under suspension with effect from June 8. The order stated that she would not be permitted to leave her headquarters without prior ap-

proval from the competent authority, but did not specify the reasons for the action.

Dalal had come into the spotlight after a video of her speaking at the June 7 protest went viral online. In the clip, she is heard saying: "This is a fight; this time it is a fight of do or die. Now the mother of the

cockroach has stepped into the field. We are with our children. One mother is the mother of the entire nation."

When contacted, Dalal said that she only spoke as a concerned parent. "I had just made a request being a mother whose son is also preparing for competitive exams," she said.



LEASE OF 07 PLOTS FOR

Star Category Hotel (3 Star & Above) at Kharghar, Kamothe, CBD Belapur & Pushpak Nagar Node of Navi Mumbai

THROUGH E-TENDER CUM E-AUCTION PROCESS

Scheme No. MM/SCH-50/2026-27

CIDCO invites application through e-TENDER cum e-AUCTION process for lease of 07 plots for **Star Category Hotel (3 Star & Above) at Kharghar, Kamothe, CBD Belapur & Pushpak Nagar Node** of Navi Mumbai from eligible applicants. The detailed information of the scheme including the time schedule is available on the website:

<https://eauction.cidcoindia.com>

Salient features of the scheme

- Star Category Hotel (3 Star & Above) plots are available under Scheme No. 50
- Plots are located at prime locations at Kharghar, Kamothe, CBD Belapur & Pushpak Nagar Node
- Largest Plot Area- 7105.13 Sqm, Smallest Plot Area- 3999.90 Sqm
- Nodes are well equipped with all infrastructure facilities and have greater connectivity
- All the procedures will be carried out through the online transparent e-auction cum e-tender process.

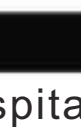
Time Schedule

- Payment for document fee for close bid will start on **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** and will continue till **06.07.2026 at 23.59 hrs.**
- Payment of EMD fee for close bid will start on **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** and will continue till **06.07.2026 at 23.59 hrs.**
- Prospective bidders can submit their queries from **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** till **19.06.2026 at 17.00 hrs.**
- Corporation will reply to the queries on **25.06.2026**
- Documents can be uploaded and submitted as mentioned in the Tender Booklet from **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** till **07.07.2026 at 12.00 hrs.**
- Submission of closed bids will start on **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** and will end on **06.07.2026 at 23.59 hrs.**
- Payment of document fee for e-auction will start on **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** and will continue till **07.07.2026 at 12.00 hrs.**
- Payment of EMD for e-auction will start on **15.06.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** and will continue till **07.07.2026 at 12.00 hrs.**
- The online e-auction will start on **07.07.2026 at 11.00 hrs.** and will continue till **07.07.2026 at 18.00 hrs.**
- Documents will be verified from **08.07.2026**
- The result Declaration Date & time : **will be Intimated.**

For details, please contact the office of **Marketing Manager (Commercial)**, 3rd Floor, Raigad Bhavan, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai- 400614

Marketing Manager (Commercial)

CIN-U99999 MH 1970 SGC-014574 www.cidco.maharashtra.gov.in CIDCO/PR/086/2026-27



PUBLIC INFORMATION

This is to inform that Tata Main Hospital, Jamshedpur is going to destroy its medical records of **General Discharges** from April 2020 to December 2022, **TMH Emergency** period up to 2023 and **TMH Tinplate, General Discharge** period up to 2021.

Any body requiring a copy of these records may contact Medical records section before 31.07.2026

Registered Office: Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Fort, Mumbai 400 004, India
Tel.: 022 66658282 Fax: 022 66657724 (CIN) – L27100MH1907PLC000260
Website: www.tatasteel.com



पूर्वोत्तर आयुर्वेद और लोक चिकित्सा अनुसंधान संस्थान
(आयुष मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के अश्विनी एक स्वायत्त संस्थान)
NORTH EASTERN INSTITUTE OF AYURVEDA & FOLK MEDICINE RESEARCH
(An Autonomous Institute under the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India)

File No. Admin-16/1/2025-NEAFMR-ADMIN Date: 08.06.2026

VACANCY NOTICE
(Advertisement No. 03/2026)

The North Eastern Institute of Ayurveda & Folk Medicine Research (NEIAFMR), Pasighat, Arunachal Pradesh, an Autonomous Body under the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, invites applications from eligible retired Government/Autonomous Body Officers for engagement of one (01) Project Consultant/Senior Project Consultant (Architectural) on contractual basis and to be posted at the Ministry of Ayush, New Delhi.

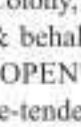
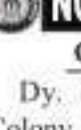
Eligibility: Retired Officers who have held responsibilities at the level of Deputy Secretary/Director to the Government of India or equivalent in Autonomous Bodies, possessing a Degree/Post Graduate Degree in Architecture and having a minimum of 10 years' experience in Healthcare/Hospital infrastructure projects in the public sector.

Age Limit: Not exceeding 64 years as on the closing date of application.

Last Date for Submission of Application: 25.06.2026.

Detailed advertisement, eligibility criteria, terms & conditions, and Application format are available on the Institute's website: www.neiafmr.org.in

Sd/-
Director (I/c)
CBC 17218/11/0003/2627 NEIAFMR, Pasighat



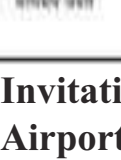
NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Open E-Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/ Colony, N.E. Railway, Gorakhpur for & behalf of President of India Invites "OPEN" E-Tender through online (e-tendering) for the following work:

Sl.No.-1, Tender Notice No. & Description of Work: 05-2026-Colony,
Name of work: Strengthening of Power Supply by Augmentation of overaged, dilapidated Overhead/Underground lines of LT Feeders, Street Light Feeders and LT panels in various depot unit under jurisdiction of Dy.CEE/ Colony. Approx. Value: ₹ 3,64,02,641/-, E.M.D. Money (Rs.): ₹ 7,28,100/-, Cost of Tender Form (Rs.): Zero, Completion time/Period from the date of issue of acceptance letter: 09 Months.

- E-tender online will be submitted upto 15:00 hrs. on dated 30-06-2026.
- Manual offer are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway IREPS official website www.ireps.gov.in

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/Colony CPRO/Vidyut-65 Gorakhpur
Never travel on roof and foot boards.



Government of India
Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India
3rd Floor, Udaan Bhawan, Safdarjung Airport, New Delhi-110003

Invitation of applications for Senior Consultant (Legal) (1 post) on contract basis in Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India (AERA)

Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India (AERA) invites applications from eligible candidates as Senior Consultant (Legal) (1 post) for various legal tasks, assignments as elaborated in the Terms of Reference (TOR) available in vacancy notice published on the AERA's website: www.aera.gov.in. Candidate with requisite qualification and experience as prescribed therein would be hired as Senior Consultant (Legal) purely on contract basis. The details including eligibility criteria, remuneration and the terms & conditions etc. are available in the vacancy notice published on AERA website. Vacancies are liable to be changed without any prior notice and without assigning any reason whatsoever.

2. Last date of receipt of application is 08.07.2026 upto 5.30 P.M. Applications to be submitted as per details mentioned in the vacancy notice. Applications received after due date and time will not be entertained.

Deputy Chief
Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India, 3rd Floor, Udaan Bhawan, Safdarjung Airport, New Delhi - 110003
CBC 03112/12/0001/2627



Office of the Principal, Veer Chandra Singh Garhwali Government Institute of Medical Science & Research, Srinagar (Garhwal), Uttarakhand

Telephone: 01346-244701, 244704 | Website: <http://vcsgsrinagar.org> | Email: principalvcsg@gmail.com

L.No. MCS/Inteview/2026-27/1451 **Date: 10/June/2026**

Walk-in-Interview-Faculty, SR & JR

A ***walk-in interview*** for the recruitment of ***Specialist Faculty Members*** as well as ***Super-Specialist Faculty Members*** on a contractual basis will be conducted under the chairmanship of the Hon'ble Vice-Chancellor of Hemwati Nandan Bahuguna Uttarakhand Medical Education University, Dehradun. The interview will take place at the **"H.N.B. Uttarakhand Medical Education University, New Central Hope Town, Bhayakhala, Seshambara, Dehradun."** on dated ***25 June, 2026 (Thursday) from 10:00 am Onwards***.

Details regarding the above vacancy positions and post of Senior Residents & Junior Residents in the respective departments are available on the college website: [\[www.vcsgsrinagar.org\]](http://www.vcsgsrinagar.org) (<http://www.vcsgsrinagar.org>).

Principal/Dean VCSGIMS&R Srinagar (Garhwal) Uttarakhand.



TATA POWER
THE TATA POWER COMPANY LIMITED
Corporate Identity No. (CIN): L28920MH1919PLC000567
Regd. Office: Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Mumbai 400 001.
Tel: +91 22 6665 8282 email: talapower@tatapower.com Website: www.tatapower.com

NOTICE OF THE 107th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that the 107th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of The Tata Power Company Limited (the Company) will be held on **Tuesday, July 7, 2026 at 10:30 a.m. (IST)** through Video Conferencing (VC)/Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM), to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of the AGM, in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 (the Act) and rules made thereunder, pursuant to General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020, 02/2022 dated May 5, 2022 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, the latest being 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025, issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, (collectively referred to as MCA Circulars).

In compliance with the above Circulars and provisions of Regulations 36(1), 44(4) and 58(1) of the Securities Exchange Board of India (SEBI) (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (Listing Regulations), the Company has emailed the Notice of the 107th AGM along with the link for the Integrated Annual Report of the Company for FY26 on **Wednesday, June 10, 2026**, to the Members whose email addresses are registered with the Company/ MUFG Inline India Private Limited (Formerly Link Inline India Private Limited) - Registrar to an Issue and Share Transfer Agent (RTA)/ National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) and/or Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL), (NSDL and CDSL collectively referred to as Depositories)/ Depository Participants (DPs). In addition, a letter is being sent to those Members whose email addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/Depositories/DPs, providing the weblink where the Integrated Annual Report can be accessed on the Company's website. The Company shall send the physical copy of the Annual Report for FY26 only to those Members who specifically request for the same at investorcomplaints@tatapower.com or raise request with RTA by using URL: https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/helpdesk/service_request.html or email to RTA at investor.helpdesk@in.mpms.mufg.com by mentioning their Folio numbers/DP ID and Client ID.

The Integrated Annual Report along with the Notice of the 107th AGM will also be available on the website of the Company at <https://www.tatapower.com/investor-resource-center/annual-reports-tab>, the websites of BSE Limited (BSE) at www.bseindia.com and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (NSE) at www.nseindia.com, and on the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

Members can attend and participate in the AGM through the VC/ OAVM facility ONLY, as indicated in the Notice of the AGM without the physical presence of the Members at a common venue. Members may also view the live webcast of the AGM provided by NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com.

REMOTE E-VOTING:

The detailed instructions pertaining to (a) Remote e-voting before the AGM and (b) e-voting on the day of the AGM will be provided in the Notice of the AGM. The Company has appointed NSDL for facilitating voting through electronic means. The remote e-voting facility would be available during the following period:

Commencement of e-voting	Friday, July 3, 2026 from 9:00 a.m. (IST)
End of e-voting	Monday, July 6, 2026 till 5:00 p.m. (IST)

A person whose name is recorded in the Register of Members or in the Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the Depositories as on the cut-off date only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting, as well as voting at the meeting.

Members of the Company holding shares either in physical form or electronic form, as on the cut-off date i.e. **Tuesday, June 30, 2026**, may cast their vote by remote e-voting. The remote e-voting module shall be disabled by NSDL for voting thereafter. Once the vote on a resolution is cast by the Member, the Member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently. The voting right of Members shall be in proportion to their share in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the cut-off date, being **Tuesday, June 30, 2026**.

REGISTRATION OF E-MAIL ADDRESS WITH COMPANY/DEPOSITORIES AND OBTAINING USER ID AND PASSWORD FOR E-VOTING:

Eligible Members who have not registered their email addresses with the RTA, are required to provide the same to the RTA, on or before **5:00 p.m. (IST) on Tuesday, June 30, 2026**, to receive the Notice of the AGM and the Integrated Annual Report for FY26 by clicking the link https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/EmailReg/Email_Register.html and completing the registration process as guided therein. The email addresses registered through the above process shall be used solely for the purpose of sending the Notice and other communications relating to the current event.

Members are requested to register the email addresses with their concerned DPs, in respect of electronic holding and with the Company/RTA in respect of physical holding, by submitting Form ISR-1 duly filled and signed by the shareholders.

To facilitate faster responses to shareholder queries, the RTA has launched an initiative that requires shareholders to submit their queries or requests only electronically through their website at https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/helpdesk/Service_Request.html.

Any person holding shares in physical form and non-individual shareholders, who acquire shares and become Members of the Company after the Notice is sent through email and holding shares as of the cutoff date i.e. **Tuesday, June 30, 2026**, may obtain the login ID and password by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.com. However, if the person is already registered with NSDL for remote e-voting, then the existing user ID and password of the said person can be used for casting vote.

Individual Shareholders holding securities in demat mode who acquire shares of the Company and become Members of the Company after dispatch of the Notice and holding shares as of the cut-off date i.e. **Tuesday, June 30, 2026** may follow steps mentioned in the Notice of the AGM under "Access to NSDL e-voting system". Other methods for obtaining/ procuring User IDs and passwords for e-voting are provided in the AGM Notice.

HELPDESK FOR ANY TECHNICAL ISSUES RELATED TO LOGIN THROUGH NSDL OR CDSL:

Login type	Helpdesk details
NSDL	E-mail: evoting@nsdl.com / Tel.: 022-48867000
CDSL	E-mail: helpdesk.evoting@cdsfindia.com / Tel.: 18002109911

RECORD DATE:

The Record Date for the purpose of payment of dividend for FY26 is **Tuesday, June 23, 2026**. The dividend of ₹ 2.50 per equity share of ₹ 1 each (250%), if approved by the Members at the AGM, will be paid subject to deduction of tax at source (TDS), on or after **Friday, July 10, 2026** only through electronic mode.

The Board of Directors has appointed Mr. P. N. Pankh (Membership No. FCS 327, CP No. 1228) or failing him, Mr. Mitesh Dhabaliwala (Membership No. FCS 8331, CP No. 9511) or failing him, Ms. Sarvani Shah (Membership No. FCS 9697, CP No. 11717) of M/s. Pankh and Associates, Practising Company Secretaries as Scrutinizer to scrutinize the voting at the AGM and remote e-voting process, in a fair and transparent manner.

In case of any queries, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) for Members and e-voting user manual for Members available at the download section of www.evoting.nsdl.com or call on: 022-48867000 or send a request to Ms. Pallavi Mahatre, Assistant Vice-President - NSDL or Mr. Amit Vashil, Deputy Vice-President - NSDL at evoting@nsdl.com.

The results of the remote e-voting and votes cast during the AGM shall be declared not later than two working days from the conclusion of the AGM. The results declared, along with the Scrutinizer's Report, shall be placed on the Company's website www.tatapower.com/annual-general-meeting and on the website of NSDL www.evoting.nsdl.com immediately after their declaration, and communicated to the Stock Exchanges where the Company's Equity Shares are listed viz. BSE and NSE and be made available on their respective websites viz. www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com.

For The Tata Power Company Limited
Sd/-
Vispi S. Patel
Company Secretary
FCS No.: 7021



TECH-PERFECT SOLUTIONS FOR THE NATION'S DEFENCE

BHARAT ELECTRONICS LIMITED
(A Govt. of India Enterprise under the Ministry of Defence)
(CIN: L32309KA1954GOI000787)

Bharat Electronics Ltd., a Navaratna Defence Public Sector Undertaking and India's Premier Professional Electronics Company requires dynamic and result oriented personnel for the following posts for Panchkula Unit.

S. No.	Post	No. of Posts
1	Engineering Assistant Trainee (Electronics)	1
2	ITI (Electronic Mechanic)	6
3	Havildar (Security)	6

Interested candidates may visit the careers page of our website www.bel-india.in to view the detailed advertisement. Last date of receipt of application is 02.07.2026.

'Har Ek Kaam Desh Ke Naam'



READ. THINK. SHARE.

Scan the QR code to explore curated editorials and opinions from leading voices

9

● **WHAT THE OTHERS SAY**
Netanyahu looked for a way to restart the war — and found one.
— *Haaretz, Israel*

The Ideas Page

THURSDAY, JUNE 11, 2026

PM Modi is barai bhai, who offers warmth and wisdom. His legacy is also personal



DASHO TSHERING TOBGAY

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi has reached a historic milestone, becoming the longest-serving elected prime minister of India in continuous office, completing 4,399 days since first assuming this responsibility on May 26, 2014. For India, this is a moment of historic significance. For the world, it reflects the confidence that the people of the world's largest democracy have repeatedly placed in a leader who has guided their nation through a transformative period. For me, however, this occasion is more than a political milestone. It is an opportunity to reflect on a relationship that has evolved over the years — one that I value deeply. I have come to know PM Modi as a friend, regard him as an elder brother, and look up to him as a mentor whose dedication to public service continues to inspire me.

I first met PM Modi in 2014, when I had the privilege of attending his swearing-in ceremony as Prime Minister of India. From that very first meeting, his warmth and graciousness left a lasting impression on me. What began as an official interaction soon evolved into a personal friendship that I have come to value deeply over the years. Soon thereafter, PM Modi chose Bhutan as the destination of his first overseas visit after assuming office. That decision reaffirmed the deep bonds of goodwill and shared destiny that connect our peoples and reflected the affection he has always held for Bhutan.

In all my interactions with him, what has consistently stood out is his sincerity, humility, and remarkable ability to connect with people, regardless of their position or background. Despite the immense responsibilities of serving more than a billion people, he never loses sight of the importance of personal relationships. Our conversations over the years have ranged from matters of state



ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

and development to the opportunities and challenges confronting our societies. Despite his demanding schedule, he has always enquired about my family, especially my children, and often shared his insights on food, healthy eating, exercise, and yoga.

In our part of the world, the term *barai bhai* or elder brother signifies far more than an elder sibling. It evokes affection, trust, guidance, and protection. It describes someone who encourages you when challenges seem overwhelming, celebrates your successes as his own, and offers wisdom when difficult decisions must be made. Over the years, in moments of both celebration and challenge, I have experienced this generosity of spirit first-hand. When discussing matters of national importance, he has always listened with patience, shared his thoughts candidly, and extended support with the affection and reassurance of an elder brother. His encouragement has often reinforced my own conviction during demanding moments of public life.

PM Modi may be older than me, but the significance of *barai bhai* goes far beyond age. It is rooted in the confidence that one can seek counsel without hesitation and receive it with sincerity and goodwill. Throughout my years of public ser-

vice, I have found in him not only a trusted friend but also someone whose perspective is valuable, whose guidance is thoughtful, and whose support is steadfast.

Perhaps the aspect of PM Modi that I admire most is his extraordinary dedication to public service. Leadership is not merely about occupying high office. It is about commitment, discipline, and an unwavering focus on improving the lives of others. PM Modi exemplifies these qualities. For more than a decade, he has carried the immense responsibilities of leading one of the world's most populous and diverse nations. Yet what stands out is not merely the scale of those responsibilities, but the energy, discipline, and consistency with which he approaches them. As a fellow public servant, I have often drawn inspiration from his example.

Under his leadership, India has expanded its economic influence, embraced technological innovation, strengthened its infrastructure, and elevated its standing in global affairs. Equally important is that he has emerged as a strong voice for the aspirations of developing countries and the Global South, advocating for a more inclusive and equitable international order. Few democratic

What stands out is not merely the scale of those responsibilities, but the energy, discipline, and consistency with which he approaches them. As a fellow public servant, I have often drawn inspiration from his example

leaders have had the opportunity to shape their nations over such an extended period. Fewer still have done so while continuously earning the trust and confidence of their people. History will record the transformation of India during PM Modi's tenure, the country's growing influence on the global stage, and the aspirations he helped ignite among millions of people.

For me, however, his legacy is also personal. I will remember him as a trusted friend whose warmth transcends official protocol; as *barai bhai*, an elder brother whose guidance and support I deeply cherish; and as a mentor whose dedication to public service serves as an enduring example for leaders everywhere. Yet what will perhaps be remembered most fondly by the people of Bhutan is the unwavering support and goodwill he has extended to our entire nation.

Under the wise leadership of His Majesty The King and with PM Modi's steadfast partnership, the friendship between Bhutan and India has continued to deepen. His support has extended beyond Bhutan's immediate developmental priorities to embrace our long-term national aspirations. More recently, he has lent his wholehearted support to His Majesty The King's visionary Gelephu Mindfulness City initiative — a transformative undertaking designed to create opportunities for future generations of Bhutanese. He has demonstrated an abiding faith in Bhutan's potential and in the Royal Vision that seeks to secure lasting peace, prosperity, and well-being for our people.

For this enduring partnership, and for the friendship and support he has shown for our country, the people of Bhutan remain profoundly grateful. On behalf of His Majesty The King, the Royal Government, the people of Bhutan, and from my own heart, I extend my warmest congratulations to PM Modi on this remarkable achievement. May he continue to serve India with the same wisdom, energy, and commitment that have defined his years of distinguished service. And may the enduring friendship between Bhutan and India continue to flourish for generations to come.

The writer is Prime Minister of Bhutan

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

12 years of PM Modi

THE EDITORIAL effectively situates Prime Minister Narendra Modi's record tenure within themes of continuity, welfare expansion, youth engagement, and rhetorical unity, offering useful political context and noting the fragmentation of the Opposition ('Milestone in history, long road to future', IE, June 10). It rightly praises outreach and institutional consolidation while urging inclusivity. However, it glosses over important trade-offs: Centralisation of power, federal tensions, constraints on dissent, and uneven economic and social indicators. For informed observers, some promises have been fulfilled, some remain works in progress, and some actions remain difficult to explain.

Abhinav Shah, Lucknow

Now is the time to assess Narendra Modi's 12 years in office objectively ('Milestone in history, long road to future', IE, June 10). During his tenure, the country has witnessed religious polarisation, democratic backsliding, the weakening of institutions, economic slowdown, soaring prices and inflation, rising unemployment, and a foreign policy that, in the view of many critics, has not always asserted the country's sovereignty effectively. This makes it difficult to award the BJP-led NDA government a passing grade. What matters is not how long a government remains in power, but how well it governs.

C David Milton, Maruthancode

FDI warning

The sharp decline in net FDI inflows is a warning that cannot be explained away by global factors alone ('Mind investor sensitivities please', IE, June 10). Gaps in Bilateral Investment Treaties (BITs), prolonged dispute-resolution timelines, and uncertainties arising from retrospective taxation have cumulatively eroded investor confidence. The government's recognition of the problem and its ongoing BIT renegotiations are welcome. However, legal certainty and predictable dispute-resolution mechanisms matter more than incentive packages.

SM Jeeva, Chennai



VINAY SAHASRABUDDHE

AS NARENDRA MODI emerges as the longest-serving continuously elected Prime Minister of India, it is natural that his contribution over all these years is reviewed. While there is much to be said about his distinct imprint on national governance, from internal security to foreign relations, this article aims to do justice to his thought leadership.

The most distinctive aspect of PM Modi's thought process has been his emphasis on drawing inspiration from our civilisational past to face contemporary challenges and to shape our aspirations for a great future. A case in point is the mantra of "*vikas bhi, virasat bhi*" — a departure from the established thinking of ignoring our heritage. Take the renaming of public places and new buildings. Kartavya Path, Lok Kalyan Marg, Kartavya Bhavan and Lok Bhavan underline his emphasis on de-Macaulayising our national ethos. It was under his regime that we were able to rename Aurangzeb Road as Dr A P J Abdul Kalam Road. PM Modi has promoted not only Bharatiya sports and toys but also indigenous talent in consulting. His emphasis on education in the mother tongue not only serves the cause of Indian languages but also provides sound pedagogical advice. At the same time, he has made it clear that his efforts do not advocate a blanket anti-foreign/anti-English-language mentality.

PM Modi institutionalised historically important occasions in the form of Vibhajan Vibhishika Smriti Divas (August 14), Janjati Gaurav

The most distinctive aspect of PM Modi's thought process has been his emphasis on drawing inspiration from our civilisational past to face contemporary challenges and to shape our aspirations for a great future

Prime Minister and thought leader

Divas (November 15), Veer Bal Divas (December 26), Lok Tantra Hatya Divas (June 26), etc. Supremely important is the International Yoga Day (June 21). The IYD has proved instrumental in creating a deeper understanding of India's uniquely rich yoga traditions globally and has added to our soft power. His ideas always have a practical, operational dimension. His *panch pran* include the idea of Viksit Bharat, freedom from colonial mindset, taking pride in our heritage, unity and integrity and also an emphasis on our duties as citizens.

Conceptions like "Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat" remind countrymen that a united and integrated India is the precondition for restoring our greatness. He has also tried to blend our cultural moorings with developmental needs with concepts like Atmanirbhar Bharat and Vocal for Local. Unlike Jawaharlal Nehru's "*aaram haram hain*" or Rajiv Gandhi's "*mera bharat mahaan*", Modi has inspired people to think big and aspire to make India "*viksit*", shaping a collective national aspiration.

His thought leadership is reflected in governance. While in Gujarat, he underscored the centrality of people's participation in development. To that end, he advocated a P2G2 approach — people's participation for good governance. He is perhaps the first PM who minced no words in telling people that they cannot just outsource development to the government, sit pretty and do nothing. Placing empowerment over entitlement has always been at the core of PM Modi's thinking.

Without necessarily using the phrase, PM Modi has been a reflective public voice on gender justice. His idea of women-led development is not just innovative, but more meaningful as it automatically puts gender justice at the centre of any new developmental project.

PM Modi has also articulated his thoughts, with clarity, on environmental challenges. He advocated the idea of Lifestyle for the Environment. Through this, he tried to hold a mirror to the harm caused by affluent nations. At the same time, he made the global community realise that manifesting our concern for environmental challenges through our conduct is much more difficult but equally essential. He linked the environment to our emotions and ethos and mooted the idea of a campaign called "Ek Ped, Maa Ke Naam". His emphasis on solar energy, organic farming and using less fertilisers while promoting the idea of "Per Drop, More Crop" is another example of his sincere attempts to educate people in an unobtrusive manner. The G20 motto, "One Earth, One Family, One Future", reminded global leaders of our inescapable inter-dependence.

Prime ministers in democracies have to educate without tutoring, moot ideas without sounding revolutionary and share new approaches without sermonising. Whether academia and the intelligentsia recognise this or not, PM Modi stands head and shoulders above his predecessors on this front.

The writer is a national executive committee member of the BJP

Economic story is one of transition. Challenges exist, but so do strengths



SOUMYA KANTI GHOSH

IN TWO recent articles, Surjit Bhalla argues that the weakening of reforms, declining investor confidence, and the revised BIT framework signal a loss of economic momentum. While the concerns raised deserve attention, the conclusions drawn are neither fully supported by evidence nor reflective of the broader economic reality.

First, any analysis of economic performance must account for global shocks. When crisis years are excluded, India's average GDP growth during 2005-2014 stands at approximately 7.2 per cent, compared to nearly 7.4 per cent during 2014-2024, achieved despite Covid, supply-chain disruptions, geopolitical conflicts, and tightening global financial conditions. The evidence suggests considerable resilience in India's growth trajectory despite far more adverse external conditions.

Second, the assumption that BITs are the primary drivers of FDI is not supported by global evidence. A major 2014 UNCTAD study covering 146 economies over 27 years found no conclusive evidence that BITs significantly increase bilateral FDI inflows.

Third, investment decisions are shaped by larger factors. The G20 Investment Report (2020) found that investor protection ranked only 10th among decision-influencing factors. Political stability, market size, infrastructure quality, and long-term growth prospects remain the principal determinants. India continues to hold strong advantages across these dimensions.

Fourth, India's own FDI experience does not support the claim that the revised BIT framework has weakened investor confidence. FDI inflows have remained robust even after the 2015 restructuring of India's BIT regime and the subsequent decline in the number of BITs in force. Gross FDI inflows were around \$95 billion in 2025-26. If BIT protections alone determined investment decisions, such sustained inflows would have been difficult to explain. While net FDI is desirable from a balance of payments perspective, a lower number should not be interpreted as weakening investor confidence. As economies mature and integrate with global markets, profit repatriation by foreign firms and overseas investments by domestic companies increase. Lower net FDI figures do not establish that investors have lost confidence in India. India's BIT reforms should therefore be viewed not as a retreat

from reform, but as an effort to balance investor rights with the state's legitimate regulatory interests.



Fifth, international comparison overlooks certain realities. Brazil refrained from ratifying traditional BITs containing Investor-State Dispute Settlement (ISDS) provisions but remained among Latin America's largest FDI destinations. South Africa, Indonesia, Ecuador, and Bolivia also revisited or terminated

investment treaties over concerns about sovereign policy flexibility. Long-term investment confidence is shaped by economic fundamentals, not arbitration clauses alone. India's approach reflects a wider global reassessment.

Sixth, investors are only required to first pursue domestic legal remedies for a specified period before bringing an international claim against the sovereign state. This reflects the well-established principle in customary international law. Arbitration under India's Model BIT remains international in character, conducted before neutral arbitral tribunals, not Indian domestic courts.

Seventh, concerns regarding the rupee must be viewed through the lens of macroeconomic fundamentals. It has depreciated by 10.6 per cent in FY26 — a much sharper move than what the broad dollar strength alone can explain. Context matters. The current account deficit is expected to remain manageable at around 2 per cent of GDP in FY27 and the RBI holds substantial foreign exchange reserves. Despite cumulative RBI foreign currency sales of around \$53 billion in FY26, India's forex reserves were at \$682 billion by April 2026, providing import cover for nearly 11 months. Recent steps taken are positive for the rupee.

We must resist the flawed narrative that the rupee's depreciation is the delayed consequence of the RBI's earlier exchange rate management of holding it back. That is not supported by data. Periods of depreciation have been accompanied by reserve depletion as the RBI intervened to defend the currency. It is remarkable that over a period of nearly 25 years, the average annual depreciation of the rupee has been similar across episodes. This is exchange rate management of the highest order. Pandering to the whims of markets allows market players to dictate terms to the central bank by taking positions for their own benefit. The argument about the rupee being a shock absorber is the easiest way of allowing a limitless fall in the value of the currency, completely delinked from macro fundamentals. India's economic story is one of transition. Challenges exist, but so do strengths. Public debate on economic policy must remain grounded in evidence.

The writer is member, PMEAC, member, 16th Finance Commission and group chief economic advisor, State Bank of India. Views are personal



SHIVKUMAR KALYANARAMAN AND KISHORE PAKNIKAR

IN TODAY'S world, scientific capability is closely linked with economic competitiveness, technological sovereignty, public health, sustainability, national security, and long-term resilience. India's future will depend not only on what it manufactures but also on what it discovers. Research and innovation remain outside the active imagination of large sections of industry, philanthropy, CSR ecosystems, and society at large. This gap deserves more attention. Historically, India's expenditure on R&D

as a percentage of GDP has remained modest compared to technologically advanced economies. Funding has traditionally relied heavily on government support. This is not because India lacks social commitment. In fact, India has built one of the world's largest CSR ecosystems and possesses a deep tradition of philanthropy. The problem is that research and innovation are still seen as someone else's responsibility. Research and innovation are not alternatives to social investment — they are force multipliers.

Every modern technology that society today takes for granted was once an uncertain research idea pursued in a laboratory somewhere. Society experiences the visible outcomes but rarely notices the invisible scientific journeys behind them. Research is therefore a form of invisible national infra-

structure. Its returns are often delayed, unpredictable, and difficult to quantify immediately, but their eventual societal impact can be enormous. Nations that consume technology without investing sufficiently in its creation risk becoming dependent on external innovation ecosystems, external intellectual property, and external strategic choices. Scientific capability is deeply linked to economic independence, geopolitical resilience, industrial competitiveness, and na-

The returns of research are often delayed and difficult to quantify immediately, but their eventual societal impact can be enormous

tional confidence. The idea of ANRF is not just to distribute grants, but to catalyse partnerships among government, academia, industry, start-ups, philanthropy, and society.

Strategic co-investment in research often stimulates substantially larger downstream investments within companies themselves. Every rupee co-invested through such partnerships can potentially catalyse several-fold higher internal R&D investments within participating organisations. This is significant because innovation ecosystems rarely grow through isolated grants alone. They grow when research begins to trigger wider institutional confidence, industrial participation, risk-taking, and scientific ambition. Participation need not always begin with massive investments. Companies can support targeted translational projects aligned with na-

tional priorities. Philanthropic foundations can help create doctoral fellowships, advanced instrumentation facilities, interdisciplinary research centres, or regional innovation clusters. Industry associations can co-create challenge-driven innovation programmes. Successful start-ups can reinvest in deep-technology ecosystems that create the next generation of innovation.

The vision of an innovation-driven India will ultimately depend on how successfully the country can transform science from the responsibility of a few institutions into a wider societal movement.

Kalyanaraman is CEO, Anusandhan National Research Foundation (ANRF), Government of India, Paknikar is ANRF Prime Minister Professor, COEP Technological University, Pune



Guess Who?

KNOWN FOR his straight talk, Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav’s remark during Monday’s INDIA bloc meeting left some Congress leaders guessing. Akhilesh is learnt to have told a few Congress leaders that he knew who all from their party were speaking against him. Since Akhilesh didn’t name anybody, the Congress leaders were left wondering who he was referring to. Incidentally, many state unit Congress leaders in UP are not in favour of an alliance with the SP and they do speak out against Akhilesh in private conversations.

In Contrast

THERE IS resentment among some BJP’s Karnataka unit leaders with party’s state in-charge Radha Mohan Das Agarwal, so much so that they have appealed to the party high command to replace him for he is “inactive”. The BJP leaders are contrasting their point by citing the example of Congress in-charge for Karnataka, Ran-deep Singh Surjewala, crediting him for the recent peaceful transition of power from Siddaramaiah to D K Shivakumar, it is learnt.

Keep A Watch

TWO DAYS after the Cockroach Janta Party’s protest rally at Jantar Mantar, Delhi Police Commissioner Satish Golchha congratulated the force for their hard work in avoiding a law and order situation. Golchha is learnt to have asked the Special CP (Intelligence) to keep a close watch on the organisation’s social media activities to pick signals on any future mobilisations.

NDA CONCLAVE TO MARK 12 YEARS OF MODI GOVERNMENT

PM: Story of Bharat has started running at full speed for 1st time

Vikas Pathak
New Delhi, June 10

SPEAKING AT the National Democratic Alliance conclave to mark 12 years of his government in the Capital on Wednesday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said that “this is the story of a Bharat that has started running at full speed for the first time”.

“The fortunes of the country turned when the NDA came back to power in 2014... Work that was done in decades started happening in months,” the PM said while addressing the NDA leaders at the Bharat Mandapam to celebrate the completion of 12 years of the BJP-led government and his personal milestone of becoming the longest continuously serving elected PM, bettering the record of Jawaharlal Nehru. “Many decades before 2014 were full of instability and upheavals, but people are now witnessing the work of a stable government and admiring its decisiveness... People have understood the importance of political stability at the national level. It is their maturity that they gave me an opportunity to serve them for such a long time.”

Modi said a big achievement of 12 years of NDA rule was that it had freed the country from the Congress. “The country has been liberated from the Congress. They made people believe that development would beslow in India. They gave it a name — Hindu rate of growth. The failures were of the Congress, but the blame came on Hindus. It should have been called Congress rate of growth,” he said. This was the difference between the Congress growth rate and the NDA growth rate, he said.

“I never thought that I would get the opportunity to be the longest serving elected Prime Minister. This is my good fortune. It’s only with God’s grace that this was possible, and for me the people are like God... I thank all...,” the PM said, adding that it was a collective achievement of the NDA constituents. He said 25-crore people had come out of poverty in these years, showing that the policies of the government were correct. He added that this gave confidence to all poor people that their dreams would come true. He underlined that the government would have to work round the clock to fulfil



Prime Minister Narendra Modi being felicitated by BJP national president Nitin Nabin during the National Democratic Alliance Conclave at Bharat Mandapam in Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

the aspirations of the people.

In his 37-minute speech largely focussed on his government’s achievements of the last 12 years and his vision for achieving Viksit Bharat, Modi said the dream of a ‘Viksit Bharat’ does not belong to a person or any party, but has become the resolve of every person in India. He underlined the growth of airports, Metro, highways, defence exports, and the number of internet users in the country going up from 25 crore to 100 crore. “When economies across the world are struggling, our rate of growth is 7.7-pc. This hasn’t been easy. We have come out of the fragile five and are the fastest growing economy. In the womb of aspirational India, Viksit Bharat is being nurtured,” he said.

“We recognise the challenges faced by the middle class, as well as their aspirations for a better future. To support them, income up to Rs 12 lakh per annum is now tax-free. Today, the country benefits from a simple and faceless tax system. Improved infrastructure has made daily life easier, and over the past 12 years, new opportunities have been created for the children, students and the middle class,” the PM said.

He recalled the abrogation of Article 370 in J&K and success of Operation Sindoor. The PM also highlighted how the Maoist problem was wiped out, something which seemed impossible earlier. “We have to look forward now. We have to look at 2047. We have to speed up our growth...”

• TRUMP, OTHER LEADERS WISH PM

DONALD TRUMP, President of the United States
Congratulations to my friend, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, on becoming India’s longest-serving Prime Minister — And a Great One he is! He is a strong, healthy, and wise man, and will have many years of Greatness and Success ahead of him!

ANURA KUMARA DISSANAYAKE, President of Sri Lanka

I extend my warm congratulations to Prime Minister @narendramodi on becoming the longest-serving elected Prime Minister in the history of India. Sri Lanka values our close partnership and looks forward to further strengthening the enduring ties between our two nations.

LEE JAE-MYUNG, President of South Korea

Prime Minister Modi, I sincerely congratulate you on becoming the longest-serving Prime Minister of India, the world’s largest democracy. Over a long period of time, you have led India’s growth and development and played an important role in elevating India’s stature in the international community...

ANWAR IBRAHIM, Prime Minister of Malaysia

Heartiest congratulations to PM Modi on this historic milestone of becoming India’s longest-serving

elected Prime Minister. This achievement stands as a testament to his years of dedicated public service and leadership in advancing India’s development, prosperity and standing on the global stage...

METTE FREDERIKSEN, Prime Minister of Denmark

Congratulations on the distinction of the longest uninterrupted service as democratically elected PM of India @narendramodi. I look forward to continuing working with you and to further strengthening and expanding our partnership to new areas.

NIKOS CHRISTODOULIDES, President of Cyprus

Congratulations to Prime Minister @narendramodi on becoming the longest-serving Prime Minister in India’s history. This remarkable milestone reflects years of dedicated service and leadership. Cyprus values its strategic partnership with India...

WILLIAM SAMOEI RUTO, President of Kenya

Congratulations to Prime Minister Narendra Modi on attaining a historic milestone in public service, as today you become the longest-serving elected Prime Minister in India’s history... Kenya values its strong and enduring partnership with India and looks forward to deepening cooperation for the mutual benefit of our peoples.

REBELLION IN PARTY AFTER LOSING POWER IN BENGAL

TMC’s house of cards: Sushmita Dev quits as RS MP, meets Himanta

Earlier, senior leader Sukhendu Ray gave up his RS membership

Ravik Bhattacharya & Sukrita Baruah
Kolkata, Guwahati, June 10

IN ANOTHER blow to the Mamata Banerjee-led Trinamool Congress, senior leader Sushmita Dev quit the party and resigned as its Rajya Sabha MP on Wednesday. In a letter to Vice President and Rajya Sabha chairman CP Radhakrishnan, Sushmita Dev requested that her resignation be accepted with immediate effect. Earlier, senior Trinamool leader and Rajya Sabha MP Sukhendu Sekhar Roy gave up his Rajya Sabha membership.

Dev has met Assam CM and BJP leader Himanta Biswa Sarma, sparking speculation about her next move. Neither she nor BJP functionaries from Assam immediately responded to queries about the same. The development came amid a massive meltdown within the TMC, which suffered a crushing defeat in the recently held West Bengal Assembly poll. Barely a month after losing power in Bengal, TMC has started unravelling. Earlier, 60 of its 80 MLAs rebelled against Mamata Banerjee’s choice of Sovandeb Chatterjee as the LoP. Shortly after, a rebel faction claimed that 20 out of the party’s 28 Lok Sabha MPs want to side with the NDA. And now, two Trinamool Rajya Sabha MPs have resigned.

Dev was a Rajya Sabha MP from Bengal, although she is from Assam’s Barak Valley region. She joined the TMC in 2021, after quitting Congress months after Assam Assembly polls. Soon after, the TMC nominated her as its candidate for the Rajya Sabha. She had been one of the Congress’s most prominent faces in Assam. She has earlier served as an MLA and a Lok Sabha MP for the Congress. Dev is the daughter of Congress leader and former Union Minister Santosh Mohan Dev.



Ex-Rajya Sabha MP and TMC leader Sushmita Dev with Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma in New Delhi on Wednesday. ANI

Amid rumblings in party, Abhishek meets Rahul

Asad Rehman
New Delhi, June 10

A DAY after TMC chief Mamata Banerjee met Congress leader Sonia Gandhi, TMC general secretary Abhishek Banerjee on Wednesday met Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi. Sources said the two leaders discussed the coordination in the INDIA bloc and its Hyderabad meeting scheduled for August.

As Abhishek and Rahul met at 10, Janpath, on Wednesday, there was speculation of the two parties coming together. “Any speculation is baseless. The meetings were just about the coordination between INDIA bloc parties and also, about INDIA bloc meeting in Hyderabad in two months time. Mamata Banerjee is a senior leader in the bloc and she will play a role in getting everyone together once again in Hyderabad and hashing out issues,” said a TMC MP.

The meeting of the INDIA bloc in Hyderabad in August is significant as it was decided during Monday’s meeting of the bloc that parties need to meet more often and that the next meeting will be held in August in Hyderabad. A source close to Abhishek said: “They discussed the state of affairs in Bengal, how the TMC and the Congress can work together to strengthen their position in West Bengal as INDIA bloc partners... and prepare together for 2029 to counter the BJP.”



Lok Sabha LoP Rahul Gandhi and TMC national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee in Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

Senior leaders of the Congress also echoed what the TMC leaders said. “It was to discuss how the bloc goes ahead. That is all,” said a Congress leader.

Since the Bengal election results came out, the relationship between the Congress and TMC has become better with Mamata herself leading from the front on making sure the Congress knows its importance in the INDIA bloc. During Monday’s INDIA bloc meeting, Mamata defended the Congress when other allies criticised the grand old party.

The TMC is now facing an existential crisis less than a month since it lost power in West Bengal. The first blow came when 60 of its 80 MLAs, led by Ritabrata Banerjee, defied the party leadership’s choice of Leader of Opposition. The crisis then shifted to Delhi, with several MPs resigning from the party and as MPs in both Houses.

After Gehlot’s broadside, Pilot counters with Rahul’s ‘mohabbat ki dukaan’

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, June 10

THREE DAYS after former Chief Minister Ashok Gehlot launched a scathing attack on Sachin Pilot, the former Deputy CM said on Wednesday that he has respected everyone he has worked with and that contentment is necessary in politics.

Decrying what he termed “advance booking” in politics, Pilot said he has seen plenty of scheming in his 25 years of public life but is simply walking on the path of “*mohabbat ki dukaan*” (shop of love) shown by Rahul Gandhi, and that while there may be discord every now and then, he has no personal feud with anyone and the party is united in serving the people.

Inaugurating a statue of his father Rajesh Pilot in Karauli, a day ahead of his 26th death anniversary on June 11, Pilot said: “I have no personal feud with anyone; and you all know, I speak very carefully. Once a word has escaped your mouth, it cannot be taken back. Hence, *sangharsh* (struggle) is necessary, standing with *sachai* (truth) is necessary; *sanyam*, *santosh* (patience, contentment) are necessary, and giving *samman* (respect) is necessary too... If someone is doing politics only to reap the fruits, then that person will be unhappy most of the time,” he said, adding that “*lobh*, *lalach*, *irshya* (greed, avarice, jealousy)... times have changed in politics, but the principles still stand today. People today still like those who stand with the truth, those who work hard.”

On June 7, Gehlot had lashed out at Pilot for allegedly failing to move on from issues during



Congress leader Sachin Pilot in Rajasthan’s Karauli on Wednesday. EXPRESS

his tenure as CM, saying that Pilot has not learned to accept the truth, nor has he accepted that he made mistakes in 2020.

“How people behave is not up to us. But it depends on us what *sanskar* (values) we give to a child. This country will be on the right track only if we give *sanskar* along with education to the next generation,” Pilot said. “In life and in politics, discipline and patience are necessary; and the first priority should be the people of the country and the state, and then our ideology and our party. And if someone works hard, then it doesn’t go to waste,” he said, adding that he has always respected all the politicians he has worked with.

On Wednesday, Pilot said he is walking on the path shown by Rahul Gandhi of “*mohabbat ki dukaan*” (shop of love). “Even if someone disagrees with us, or doesn’t listen to us, give them so much respect and love that they automatically start walking with you,” Pilot said.

With Gehlot’s attack being seen as an attempt to scuttle his chances of a leadership role in the state, Pilot said: “If we politicians start predicting the future, then who will worship the people?...”

Despite Cong stir, NDA pick’s nomination cleared for Jharkhand Rajya Sabha race

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, June 10

A DAY after objections were raised by the Congress and the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) against the nomination papers of NDA-backed Independent Rajya Sabha candidate Parimal Nathwani, the Returning Officer (RO) on Wednesday cleared his nomination, finding the documents submitted by him to be valid.

With the decision, the path is now clear for Nathwani, a Gujarat-based businessman and sitting YSR Congress Party (YSRCP) Rajya Sabha MP, to contest the June 18 poll for two Rajya Sabha seats from Jharkhand. The scrutiny of nomination papers was conducted on Tuesday for the three candidates in the fray, JMM nominee Baidya-



BJP’s Seema Singh (left) and Congress’s Rama Khalkho argue during a protest over Nathwani’s nomination in Ranchi on Wednesday. ANI

nath Ram, Congress candidate Pranav Jha, and Independent candidate Nathwani who is backed by the NDA. While the nominations of Ram and Jha were accepted during the initial scrutiny, Nathwani’s papers were kept pending after objections by the Congress and JMM.

The controversy also trig-

gered political protests outside the Assembly on Wednesday. While BJP workers staged a demonstration demanding acceptance of Nathwani’s nomination papers, Congress workers held a protest against the Centre, raising slogans against the BJP-led Union government. Officials informed that police stopped

Nishant’s affidavit puts spotlight on unfinished degree, rising income ahead of Bihar MLC polls

Santosh Singh
Patna, June 10

HE IS only Nishant, not Nishant Kumar, has not finished his engineering degree, and has seen his income jump over 1600% between 2020-21 and 2024-25 — that’s what Bihar Health Minister Nishant’s affidavit shows as he prepares to contest the legislative council election.

The affidavit, submitted ahead of the June 18 MLC poll for 10 seats, shows that contrary to the name used in JD(U) posters and banners, former Bihar CM Nitish Kumar’s 44-year-old son goes by a single name — Ni-



Bihar Health Minister Nishant Kumar during an event in Patna on Wednesday. PTI

shant. It also shows that he completed only five of the eight semesters of his Bachelor of Engineering course, meaning he did not finish the degree. This

glimpse into his affidavit comes at a time when the rival RJD has been raising questions about his educational qualifications.

For Nishant, one of nine NDA candidates in the MLC polls, the poll is crucial to retaining his Cabinet berth: the Constitution mandates that a minister must become a member of either House within six months of taking oath. For Nishant, however, the poll is largely a formality. The NDA holds 202 of 243 seats in the Bihar Assembly, and each MLC candidate requires the votes of 25 MLAs. His affidavit shows that he passed his intermediate (10+2) exam from

Patna Science College in 1998, enrolled in Bachelor of Engineering (Computer Science) programme at Birla Institute of Technology, Mesra, Ranchi, and completed five of eight semesters until 2001. Sources close to him said he could not complete the course due to health reasons.

Nishant lists his current address as 7, Circular Road, the official residence of his father. He is registered as a voter in Patna’s Digha Assembly segment. The affidavit shows that his income rose from Rs 7,16,780 in 2020-21 to Rs 1,28,28,400 in 2024-25, while his movable and immovable assets stand at Rs 4.63 crore.



Vishwas ke, Vikas ke, Jan-kalyan ke

UTTAR PRADESH Driving India's Renewable Future

Uttar Pradesh is rapidly emerging as India's powerhouse of green growth and renewable energy transformation. Ranked No. 1 in Green Energy Corridor implementation, the state is driving an ambitious clean energy transition with a target of 22,000 MW solar capacity and 50% power generation from renewable sources. Over 5.64 lakh solar rooftops, 2,815 MW utility-scale solar projects, and 2.65 lakh+ solar street lights are reshaping urban and rural landscapes. Ayodhya is emerging as the state's first Model Solar City with a 40 MW solar project and extensive smart solar infrastructure. From 86,128 solar pumps for farmers to 743 electric buses across 15 cities and India's highest operational CBG plants, Uttar Pradesh is powering sustainable, inclusive, and future-ready development.



RENEWABLE ENERGY & SOLAR EXPANSION

- Solar energy share in Uttar Pradesh's renewable mix rises to 27%, marking rapid green growth.
- Vision to achieve 50% power generation through renewable energy while reducing thermal dependence.
- More than 2.65 lakh solar street lights illuminated across the state since 2017.
- 53,354 solar power packs installed in remote villages under Saubhagya Yojana along with 17,602 additional packs under DDG Scheme.



- Over 5.64 lakh solar rooftop systems installed under PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana with 1844.87+ MW generation capacity.
- A thriving solar industry ecosystem comprising nearly 5,000 companies has generated direct employment for more than 65,000 people.
- 2,815 MW solar capacity commissioned under Utility Scale Solar Energy Programme.
- 202 MW solar rooftop capacity installed across government and semi-government buildings.
- Under other Solar City programmes, 1,036 smart solar street lights, 13,222 solar street lights, 2,128 high-masts, 55 solar trees, and 170 heritage high-masts installed.
- Uttar Pradesh Solar Energy Policy 2022 aims to develop 22,000 MW solar capacity over the next five years.
- Target includes 14,000 MW utility-scale solar projects, 6,000 MW solar rooftops, and 2,000 MW solarization under PM Kusum Yojana.

URBAN TRANSPORT & GREEN MOBILITY



- 743 electric buses operational across 15 cities, accelerating sustainable public transport.
- 500 e-autos planned in 7 cities, with 50% reserved for women drivers to promote inclusive green mobility.
- Electric depot hubs operational in Prayagraj, with Sahibabad and Fort Depot hubs under development.
- Roadmap underway to induct: 3,000 new electric buses before 2030 & 5,000 additional e-buses through contractual operations
- Uttar Pradesh moving steadily towards zero-carbon mobility through renewable energy and clean transport technologies.
- EV charging infrastructure being developed at 272 locations across 19 districts.



AGRICULTURE & RURAL ENERGY

86,128 solar pumps installed on farmers' fields under PM Kusum Yojana between FY 2017-18 and 2025

Solarization of 5,858 private on-grid pumps completed under PM Kusum Scheme (C-1)

PPAs signed for 1,708.1 MW grid-connected solar plants for agricultural feeder solarization under PM Kusum (C-2)

Uttar Pradesh Bio Energy Policy 2022 promotes green fuel production from agricultural residue, livestock waste, press mud, and municipal solid waste

BIO-ENERGY & GREEN FUELS

- Strong push for Compressed Bio Gas (CBG), bio-coal, biodiesel, and bio-ethanol production across the state.
- Gorakhpur emerges as a key green energy hub with establishment of a Compressed Biogas Plant.
- Under Uttar Pradesh Bio Energy Policy 2022: 62 bio-energy projects approved & 36 projects already operational
- Uttar Pradesh ranks first in India in bio-energy development with maximum operational CBG plants.



GREEN HYDROGEN & FUTURE ENERGY

Approval granted for establishment of 2 Centres of Excellence to promote the Green Hydrogen ecosystem.

Uttar Pradesh Green Hydrogen Policy 2024 paves the way for future-ready clean energy transition.

KEY OPERATIONAL & UPCOMING SOLAR PARKS IN UTTAR PRADESH DRIVING THE STATE'S RENEWABLE ENERGY REVOLUTION

- Jalaun Solar Park (1,200 MW): Set to become Uttar Pradesh's largest ultra-mega solar park, developed by Bundelkhand Saur Urja Ltd., a joint venture of UPNEDA and NHPC.
- Chitrakoot (800 MW): Major solar hub under development.
- Jhansi & Lalitpur (600 MW each): Large-scale projects boosting renewable capacity.
- Mahoba (105 MWp): First project connected through Green Energy Corridor-II.
- Kanpur & Mirzapur: Key operational and upcoming projects totaling over 200 MW.
- Prayagraj (Naini): Uttar Pradesh's first utility-scale solar power plant.



POCSO CASE

Complainant against UP swami says she ‘was pressured into filing a fake case’

Express News Service
Lucknow, June 10

Months after he lodged a case of sexual assault on two minors allegedly by Swami Avimukteshwaranand Saraswati and his associates during Magh Mela in Prayagraj, the complainant, Ashutosh Brahmachari, has claimed that he was misled and pressured into filing a fake case.

In a video statement, Brahmachari alleged, “The conspiracy to get a false case lodged against Avimukteshwaranand was hatched by Mahant Ramchandra Das (who he claimed lives in Chitrakoot ashram). I was pressured and misled by him. Several officials were also involved in this.” “I have WhatsApp chats and phone call recordings of Das telling me how to lodge the case,” he added.

On February 21, the Prayagraj police had registered the case on charges of sexual assault on minors hours after the Special Judge (POCSO) Act, Prayagraj, issued an order to file a case.

While Das is the successor of spiritual leader Swami Rambhadracharya, Brahmachari is also a disciple of him.

When contacted by The Indian Express if he would withdraw the FIR against Avimukteshwaranand, Brahmachari said, “We will hold discussion and take a decision on this soon.”

Ola driver held for assaulting elderly man who objected to him spitting on road

Express News Service
Mumbai, June 9

AN OLA driver was arrested on Wednesday for allegedly assaulting a 70-year-old man who objected to him spitting on a road near Jupiter Hospital in Thane, an incident that sparked outrage after a video surfaced on social media, prompting Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde to seek an attempt-to-murder charge.

The accused driver, Nishant Dhar Shukla, has been booked under relevant sections for assault and attempted murder.

The incident took place Tuesday evening when the elderly man was passing by the hospital with his family. According to police and videos that surfaced on social media, Shukla allegedly spat on the road. When the senior citizen questioned him over it, the accused allegedly abused and assaulted him.

Purported videos of the incident show the accused re-

peatedly assaulting the man. At one point, he is also seen holding a stone and tree branches to attack the man. The elderly man suffered an injury on his leg.

The video then went viral, triggering outrage and demands for action against the accused. Local Shiv Sena and MNS workers traced the accused on Wednesday and assaulted him, before handing him over to Vartak Nagar police station. Police recorded statement of the victim and arrested the accused.

Earlier, leaders from both the Shinde-led Shiv Sena and the Uddhav-led Sena (UBT) condemned the assault and demanded strict action against the accused. Shinde, who is in Delhi, took note of the incident and spoke to Thane police commissioner Ashutosh Dumbre.

CM Devendra Fadnis also reacted to the incident and said action had been ordered against anti-social elements. “We will not tolerate such incidents,” Fadnis said.

the Union Ministry of Jal Shakti and the state government after

The Indian Express report came to the attention of the Centre. “Following the news report, a team from the Ministry of Jal Shakti held discussions with the state government last week to assess the situation and explore immediate measures that could be taken to address the water crisis. We are also preparing a presentation to submit to the state government as part of our proposal for long-term water security interventions in the district,” she said.

“We cannot express in words how unreal it feels that water is coming to us. In the past four days, we didn’t have to make that journey. We hope this blessing continues forever,” Bajubai told this newspaper.

The June 2 report, “Long walk for water: How scarcity is breaking women in Maharashtra’s tribal belt”, had documented what these women had lived with for years — doctors linking the burden of repeatedly carrying heavy water pots over difficult terrain to reproductive health complications, including

Manipur: 6 bodies suspected to be of missing Naga men found

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, June 10

TWENTY-EIGHT days after six Naga men in Manipur went missing and were suspected to be abducted, six bodies were recovered by security forces on Wednesday afternoon, with police saying they are “believed to be among those” kidnapped on May 13.

Search operations for the six missing men from Kongsakhul, a Naga village in Manipur’s Kangpokpi district, have been underway for the past four weeks. The development comes a day after Naga groups released 14 Kuki men they had been holding hostage in Senapati district, demanding that the six men from their community be located and handed over. “After nearly 24

hours of sustained search operations involving around 450 personnel of the Manipur Police, CRPF, and Assam Rifles, assisted by sniffer dogs and forensic expert teams, the mortal remains of six persons were recovered this afternoon.

The deceased are believed to be among those taken hostage from Leilon Vaiphei on May 13. Necessary legal formalities are being carried out by the police, and the investigation is underway,” said a statement issued by the Manipur police on Wednesday evening.

A senior security official said that the bodies were located in an area between Leilon Vaiphei and Kharam Vaiphei, close to where a large number of people from Kongsakhul had been abducted on May 13.

Hostilities between the two communities have spiked after three church leaders from the Thadou Baptist Association were killed in an attack, which Kuki groups alleged Naga armed groups were responsible for.

In response, a number of Naga villagers were abducted, including several people who were returning from a wedding party on May 13.

The six missing Naga men had been identified by locals of Kongsakhul as Manu Thiimai, Kenpibou, Dilip Thiimai, Phenrilungbou, Kaliwangbou, and Phenrongwibou. Manu Thiimai and Kenpibou were pastors.

Subsequently, Naga groups had also abducted more than two dozen Kuki villagers in Senapati district.

On May 15, both sides released 14 hostages each, but Naga groups continued to hold 14 hostages demanding the release of the six men who they alleged were abducted by Kuki groups. On the other hand, Kuki groups claimed that they had released all their hostages and that they did not have information about the whereabouts of the six men.

As the hostage crisis drew out, on Tuesday, the 14 Kuki men were released and handed over at Taphou, a village in Kangpokpi district where most of them are from. The United Naga Council, a top Naga body based in Senapati, had cited a “commitment” issued by the Manipur government to trace the six men within “the next 48 hours”.

‘It still feels he’s abroad’: Kutch family grapples with loss and memories

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, June 10

FOR A year since the devastating crash of Air India flight in Ahmedabad, the Khimani family of Dahinsara village in Gujarat’s Kutch still struggles to speak of 35-year-old Anil Khimani in the past tense. Grief has not arrived as a single moment of acceptance, but as a slow pain carried through unfinished conversations, unanswered calls and the unbearable silence left behind by a man who had stepped out of home believing he would return with better prospects for his family.

What remains, instead, are fragments — Anil’s daughters growing up without him, wife making attempts to reduce financial dependence, parents staring at the doorway a little too long, a brother replaying old conversations wondering whether one different decision could have changed everything. In the Khimani household, the silence after June 12, 2025 still refuses to die down.

“It still feels he’s settled abroad, somehow,” says his elder brother, Rakesh Khimani, his voice faltering between pauses. “Even today, sometimes it feels as though he may call or just barge through the gate into the courtyard...”

Anil was among the 260 people — 241 on board and 19 on the ground — killed when Air India flight AI-171 crashed into a medical hostel complex in Ahmedabad’s Meghaninagar area shortly after take off for London Gatwick last year. One passenger survived.

While families of many other victims had received the mortal remains of their departed loved ones within days, the Khimanis had waited in agony for weeks. Anil’s remains were so badly charred that forensic experts struggled to establish a DNA



An experienced craftsman who had worked in Seychelles, Anil Khimani planned to explore opportunities in the UK

match. He became the last passenger victim to be identified on the occasion of Ashadi Beej — the Kutchi New Year — on June 27, 2025. Just a day before, losing hope and in search of a closure, the family had performed a symbolic funeral in Dahinsara, using an effigy wrapped in his clothes as advised by priests of the Swaminarayan sect, which the family is a part of.

When officials finally informed them that a DNA match had been confirmed, they held another funeral with the mortal remains.

‘He had bigger dreams’

Even now, the memories of those days remain raw. “The initial months were very tough,” Rakesh says. “There are no words to describe grief. Sometimes, relatives come home, someone mentions his name, and suddenly everyone breaks down again. My parents are still unable to fully believe it. They continue living in denial at times.”

This year, the Kutch New Year falls on July 16 and for the family, it will bring another painful reminder of Anil’s absence. “What was once a festive family gathering has become a day layered with this memory,” Rakesh says.

AIR INDIA CRASH
a year later

Anil left behind his wife and two daughters — an elder daughter, now 7, and a younger child who was barely five months old when Anil was killed in the crash. The weight of survival has quietly reshaped the household. “The older daughter often asks about her father... We just distract her and make up stories that he is abroad. As she grows, she will slowly learn the truth herself. What else can we tell her or explain? The

younger daughter, of course, is growing up without knowing her father...” Rakesh says. He adds that Anil’s widow has taken up additional tailoring assignments to support the family, while Rakesh now manages their construction and maintenance business alone.

“I feel the pinch every day... There was a lot of work, and he handled most of it. I would just visit the sites to supervise. He was an all-rounder... carpenter, tile expert, maintenance work, everything. We built the business together. I had even reasoned with him that we had good work here... but he had bigger dreams...”

An experienced craftsman who had earlier worked in Seychelles, Anil planned to explore

opportunities in the United Kingdom during his six-month visitor visa stay. According to Rakesh, the journey almost did not happen. “I was telling him not to go,” he recalls. “His first visa application had been rejected. This was his second attempt. I told him there was enough work here already. But he wanted to build a better future. He said he would explore his options abroad...”

There is another memory that haunts Rakesh — the decision to take the ill-fated Thursday flight. Rakesh says, “We were not even planning to take that flight... I had suggested that he leave on Sunday instead so the family and children could come to Ahmedabad for sightseeing. But this ticket was cheaper, and the travel agent said luggage expenses would also be covered. Anil chose this flight and I conceded...”

The family says spirituality has become their primary source of strength. Followers of the Swaminarayan faith, they immersed themselves more deeply in prayer over the past year. Since the crash, the family has held prayers every 12th of the month and carried out charitable activities in Anil’s memory throughout the year. Yet acceptance remains incomplete.

“We strongly believe it was *kismet* (fate)... It was his *kismet* to depart like this and ours to lose him... His time in this world was only till that point. It was God’s will,” Rakesh says.

Asked whether the family plans legal action against Air India or Boeing, Rakesh says, “We are not in touch with other families and have not yet decided to pursue litigation. We keep reading about the investigations, but honestly, we are not educated enough to understand all the technical details. The truth should come out, but what difference will it make now? He will not come back.”

• BRIEFLY



South 24 Parganas Zilla Parishad office in West Bengal. PTI

WEST BENGAL

Office building of TMC’s Jahangir Khan on fire; BJP alleges sabotage

THE SOUTH 24 Parganas Zilla Parishad office in West Bengal caught fire on Wednesday morning. There were no injuries. The fire was first noticed on the third floor of the building, officials said. 17 fire tenders were at the scene. Fire department officials said, the cause of the fire is to be determined, and short circuit igniting flames could be a possibility. As the fire raged on, political allegations also surfaced. TMC leader Jahangir Khan, who was arrested on Monday, had his office in the building’s third floor. Union Minister Sukanta Majumdar alleged sabotage to destroy evidence. BJP leader Rakesh Singh demanded investigation of the possible role of TMC leaders in the fire. TMC has not reacted to BJP leaders’ allegations. PTI

Medical intern found dead at beach in Goa

A FEMALE doctor, 23, who had been interning at the Goa Medical College (GMC) was found dead at a beach in Dona Paula in Panaji on Wednesday. According to the police, some locals spotted a dead body around 8.45 pm and alerted the authorities. The body was retrieved by the police. The deceased hailed from Kerala. “No note has been recovered. The body has been kept for the autopsy and further probe is ongoing,” said a police official. Preliminary probe suggests a case of suicide, said police, adding that the cause of death will be ascertained after a post-mortem. Health Minister Vishwajit Rane called the incident unfortunate and has ordered an inquiry and a thorough investigation. ENS

Telangana: Child illegally sold rescued by cops

A NEWBORN, who was allegedly illegally sold to a childless couple through mediators for Rs 1.7 lakh was rescued, police said on Wednesday. A complaint lodged by the Child Welfare Department said, a childless couple who were desperately searching for a child to adopt approached mediators. The infant was born on May 28 with physical disability at a private hospital in Tukkuguda. The biological parents gave the infant to a woman mediator, the biological father’s relative who sold him to the couple said the enquiry report. Case was registered under BNS and JJ Act and has been transferred to the Nandigama Police Station for further investigation the release added. PTI

Faisal Khan knocks on Patna High Court’s doors for relief

Himanshu Harsh
Patna, June 10

EDUCATOR AND YouTuber Faisal Khan, popularly known as Khan Sir, has moved the Patna High Court seeking quashing of an FIR registered against him in connection with the violence outside his coaching institute, Khan Global Studies (KGS).

The petition also seeks directions to reopen the institute, which has been shut since the incident.

Court records show that Khan moved the Patna High Court through a Criminal Writ Jurisdiction Case (CWJC) challenging the Kadamkuan police station case registered against

him on June 4.

The petition, filed on June 9, came up for hearing before Justice Chandra Shekhar Jha on Wednesday.

After hearing counsel for the petitioner and the State, the court issued notice to the respondents and directed the Bihar government to file a counter-affidavit within four weeks. The court further ordered that a “rejoinder, if any, be filed by the petitioner within one week thereafter”.

The matter has been listed for further hearing on July 13. The court directed that the matter be re-notified on that date and ordered that the “position be retained” in the meantime.

Bharathiraja, who took Tamil cinema beyond studios, dies at 84

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, June 10

BHARATHIRAJA, THE filmmaker who took Tamil cinema out of its studios and into the dusty fields, village lanes and emotional landscapes of rural South India, died on Wednesday in Chennai after prolonged ill health. He was 84.

His death came less than two years after the loss of his son, actor Manoj Bharathiraja, a tragedy from which friends and family said he never fully recovered. In recent months, the director had battled recurring health problems, including respiratory ailments. His passing prompted an outpouring of grief across Tamil Nadu, where generations of viewers knew him simply as “*Iyakkunar Imayam*” - the “Peak Among Directors”.

Few filmmakers reshaped an industry as decisively as Bharathiraja did. When his debut film, 16 Vayathinile, arrived in 1977, Tamil cinema was still largely confined to studio floors and theatrical conven-

tions. Bharathiraja pointed the camera elsewhere. He took audiences into villages, paddy fields and dry riverbeds, populating the screen with ordinary people, flawed desires and the rhythms of rural life. The result altered the visual language of Tamil cinema.

The film introduced a generation to unforgettable characters while bringing together young stars, including Kamal Haasan, Rajinikanth and Sridevi. It also announced a director with a rare instinct for discovering talent.

Over the next four decades, Bharathiraja directed nearly 40 films, among them ‘*Kizhakke Pogum Rail*’, ‘*Sigappu Rojakkal*’, ‘*Alaigal Oivathillai*’, ‘*Mudhal Mariyadhai*’, ‘*Vedam Puthithu*’, ‘*Kadalora Kavithaigal*’ and ‘*Karuthamma*’. His films moved effortlessly between romance, psychological thrillers, social dramas and political commentary, often confronting caste, gender inequality and social exclusion without sacrificing emotional depth.



A water tanker has been arriving in the morning in Vadvi Pada of Nandurbar for the past five days. EXPRESS

uterine prolapse, miscarriages, chronic musculoskeletal pain and a range of gynaecological problems.

Women in Vadvi Pada said officials visited the hamlet after the report was published, enquired about their health concerns and inspected the route used to fetch water.

For many, the arrival of the tanker has felt like long-overdue recognition of a problem ignored for decades. “This feels like a dream,” said Jethubai Joma Valvi, 48. “Seeing the water tanker in our village feels

like God has arrived to pull us out of misery.”

Khadkapani sarpanch Tinkabai Ishwar said the tanker supply, while welcome, is not yet enough. “Khadkapani has three padas — Vadvi Pada, Patil Pada and Padvi Pada. At present, one or two tankers are serving the village, but that is not sufficient for all three padas. We have requested three tankers, one for each pada. We have also sought a piped water connection, and we are expecting a borewell to be constructed soon. These are early steps, but they give us hope



The report published by The Indian Express on June 2

that a long-term solution may finally be found,” she said.

Residents echoed that concern. The tanker generally stays for about 30 minutes and does not provide enough water for all families. There are also questions about water quality. “The water is helpful, but it is not enough for everyone. The water comes from borewells. We strain it before drinking. We need potable water for drinking and separate water for bathing and household chores,” said Mamta.

Nirmala Vasave, a social activist who has worked with tribal communities in Nandurbar for over two decades, said tanker

supply must be treated as only an interim measure.

“The water being supplied comes from a borewell and is not fully potable. We need filtered drinking water and a separate water source for domestic use. We have submitted several suggestions to district and state authorities over the years, including construction of small check dams, rainwater harvesting systems and groundwater recharge projects, but little has materialised,” she said.

The administration said it is working on longer-term interventions simultaneously. Under Mission Jal Bandhu, groundwater conservation works are being implemented in water-scarce villages and water bodies are being desilted ahead of the monsoon.

Large water storage drums are being distributed in villages where piped water connectivity may take longer. Work on improving approach roads is expected to begin this year, and the district has prepared a saturation plan for road connectivity submitted to the Tribal Development Department.

Thousands gather to cheer return of Somali referee Artan

Express News Service
New Delhi, June 10

SOMALIA REFEREE Omar Artan who was denied entry to the United States to officiate in the upcoming FIFA World Cup, returned home to a hero's welcome on Wednesday. He was received by supporters and officials after touching down in the capital city of Mogadishu.

"I promise you, God willing, that I will attend the next one. I want the Somali public to take comfort in this and remain confident, he said to the people gathered there. "It is up to all of us to defend the Somali name,"

Artan said. "Somalia belongs to us, whether it is in a bad state or a good state. That flag belongs to us, and that passport belongs to us."

Artan, who was Africa's referee of the year in 2025, was set to become the first from his country to take charge of a FIFA World Cup game, but was denied entry at Miami International Airport on Monday, despite holding a diplomatic passport and a single-entry visa into the USA. The referee said that he faced an 11-hour immigration interview and was detained for several hours before he was put on a flight back to Is-



Omar Artan (centre) greeted by Somalis on his return home. REUTERS

tanbul, Turkey.

Somalia Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation also released a statement expressing deep regret

over the USA's decision to deny Artan entry. "The Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation of the Federal Republic of Somalia ex-

presses its deep regret over the decision by the authorities of the United States of America to deny entry to Somali international referee Mr. Omar Abdulkadir Artan. Mr. Artan, the CAF referee of the year 2025 and Somalia's most accomplished sporting figure and a source of immense national pride. The Federal Government of Somalia undertook diplomatic efforts with the relevant authorities in support of Mr. Artan's travel. Regrettably, these efforts did not result in a favorable outcome," the ministry said as per a tweet by Nasra Bashir Ali, whose X bio states that she is a

Government Official, Office of the Somali Prime Minister, Federal Government of Somalia.

Hundreds of supporters, government officials and members of Somalia's football community gathered hours before Artan arrived at Aden Adde International Airport.

As he disembarked, supporters waving Somali flags crowded around him before draping him in the flag.

Meanwhile, a Trump administration official alleged that the 34-year-old was sent back because of his "association with suspected members of terror organisations."

As WC begins, British mining footnote joins India to Mexico

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, June 10

THE FANS of Mexican football club CF Pachuca mark every game by unfurling a giant "tifo", a large choreographed banner, from the stands. It depicts a miner holding a pickaxe in one hand and a crimped pastry in the other, with black flags bearing a white cross in the background.

The banner is a tribute to the hardy men from Cornwall, an English county historically known for its globe-trotting mining experts, who landed in Pachuca in 1825 in search of silver - and ended up introducing football to the country.

By 1902, the game had spread enough for Mexico to have a national league. In 1970 and 1986, the country hosted the FIFA World Cup. And on Thursday, just 90 km from Pachuca, they play their opening game of the tournament's latest edition against South Africa in Mexico City, this time as co-hosts along with the USA.

Before the much-anticipated kick-off, London-based writer and researcher Dr Sharron Schwartz, who specialises in Cornish mining migration, speaks about Mexico's footballing growth and reveals a lesser-known Cornwall connection -- one that leads all the way to the Kolar Gold Fields in Karnataka.

Around the time the Mexican football league was being launched, Cornish miners were moving to India in search of precious metal deposits. By then, pioneer English mining engineer James Taylor, who had taken eight steam engines to Mexico in the early 19th century to dig deep, had died. His sons identified Kolar as their next destination.

"Kolar Gold Fields, along with South Africa, were really important migration destinations for Cornish miners. The Kolar Gold Fields were a melting pot. The majority of the arrivals happened to be Cornish and by the time they landed in Kolar, they established cricket and football teams, but it didn't take off," Schwartz says.

To underline the Kolar-Cornwall connection, Schwartz points to the Redruth area in Cornwall, where Indian imprints can be found. Houses there carry names like Kolar Villa, and Balagat House.

"At Kolar, they had set up a football club by 1895 named the Kolar Gold Fields Football Club. And they used to play against the Dorsetshire Regiment stationed at Bangalore, and various teams that would come and play at their ground, which was at Oregon. But it didn't really take off by the turn of the 20th century and kind of petered out. The links between Pachuca and Kolar is because of the Taylor dynasty that took football to the Kolar Gold Fields and Mexico," she says.

As they did in Kolar, the Cornish miners had also brought cricket bats, balls and stumps to Mexico, and the game had its moment there too. "There were cricket matches as far back as the



Dr Sharron Schwartz specialises in Cornish mining migration. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

“Kolar Gold Fields, along with South Africa, were really important migration destinations for Cornish miners. By the time they landed in Kolar, they established cricket and football teams, but it didn't take off,”

DR SHARRON SCHWARTZ, WRITER/RESEARCHER

late 1820s," says Schwartz.

By the late 1850s or 1860s, the Cornish population had grown substantially, with cricket teams spread across Mexico. "Clubs were set up and playing in Velasco, which is an area where the mineral was processed. It's some distance from Pachuca up in the mountains. That went on really successfully for years," she says.

With time, Pachuca's cricket clubs turned to football. "In the mid-1890s, one of the main Mexican sports newspapers sort of decided that they would play association football. And it seemed to have taken off as an organised sport because of the preference within the British community in Mexico," says Schwartz.

Though nobody knows where the first football game in Mexico was played, Schwartz believes it may have sprung up wherever the British settled, with newspapers mentioning the game as early as the late 1880s. "By the early 1890s, we have definite proof of teams being set up, and Pachuca definitely had a football team before 1892. By 1895, Pachuca Cricket Club began to be known as Pachuca Athletic Club. And by 1902, we got the National Association and since trains were on, teams travelled to different parts to play cricket and football. And the first football league started in 1902," she says.

That history is why fans still unfurl the tifo at Pachuca's home ground. "It has become a culture for them to thank the miners. The Pachuca football club is called Los Tuzos. And in their club logo there is the gopher (an earth-digging rodent), which is brilliant," Schwartz says. And so, when Mexico's footballers walk out at the Estadio Azteca, one corner of England will be rooting for them. As for India, it remains far from football's elite. Same company, same miners, same game -- two entirely different stories.

• FRIDAY'S MATCHES

GROUP A
Mexico vs South Africa
Mexico City, 0030 hrs (Friday)

Korea Republic vs Czechia
Guadalajara, 0730 hrs (Friday)
ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Mexico train ahead of their opener against South Africa at the Estadio Azteca. AP

Messi's passport details leaked

A SECURITY oversight led to the leaking of passport details of every Argentina player, including captain Lionel Messi, who were in the squad to face Iceland in a FIFA World Cup warm-up match, a Reuters report stated on Wednesday. The passport numbers, listed on the official team sheet, should have been blurred before being released to the media and the public. But in Alabama's Jordan-Hare Stadium, they were circulated without redaction.

Swiss, Norway have snake issue

BEFORE THE World Cup starts, Switzerland have an additional concern at their training base -- snakes. The area adjoining San Diego's Jewish Academy is infested by venomous reptiles. A 'Snake Area' has been duly marked on the map of their training facility. It's a huge area around the training ground and is marked with dark red stripes and the words: 'Beware of snakes.' Also, Norway, based at Grandover Resort & Spa in Greensboro, North Carolina, have been advised not to provoke snakes, which are "very common" in the area.



Lionel Messi scored for Argentina in their final warm-up game before the WC. REUTERS

Uzbekistan get searched

FABIO CANNAVARO and his Uzbekistan squad were stopped and searched by security officials on Monday evening upon arrival for a pre-tournament warm-up match against the Netherlands, in footage that has drawn widespread criticism of the United States' hosting of the 2026 World Cup. Video footage shows the entire Uzbekistan coaching and playing staff being made to step off their team coach and submit to searches by security personnel bearing metal-detecting wands.

EXPRESS NEWS SERVICE



Sandip G
Mexico City, June 10

A REMIXED version of the centuries-old folk song *Cielito Lindo* whistles out from car stereos and restaurant radios. "Ay, ay, ay, ay... *Cantayno llores...*" Sing and don't cry, the lines roll on, in soulful voices, from Trini Lopez to Luciano Pavarotti. The national football team's feverish fans have long embraced it as their patron song, rendered passionately in the stands, whether lose, draw or win. It is a song of both joy and lament -- best accompanied, the locals insist, by pulque, not its more commercialised variant tequila -- and it is how Mexicans perceive the World Cup.

The fans are sad that ticket prices are unbearably expensive; proud that the mundial is kicking off in Mexico City. They grouse that they are hosting only nine games of 104, with the US apportioning 78; yet take comfort that El Tri could play all their group games on home soil. There is optimism that they will go beyond the cursed quinto partido -- the fifth game, the wall Mexico has never climbed -- but anguish that the finest footballers on the planet are unlikely to step into Mexico City, Monterrey and Guadalajara.

A radio programme spent an hour on why Lionel Messi's career is incomplete without a World Cup at the Azteca -- the stadium where Pelé lifted the trophy in 1970, where Maradona scored the Hand of God in 1986, and which becomes the first venue in history to host three World Cup opening matches. The question was not rhetorical. Another declared Mexico had beaten the USA and Canada before a ball was kicked, counting the city's passion as the margin. Even tabloids dedicated entirely to crime, like La Prensa and Nota Roja, have committed more pages to football than to the shootout that killed gangster El Mencho in Guadalajara last week.

The 2026 World Cup is the most geographically sprawling in history. Bosnia will travel further in the group stage than some teams do in a season



Preparations for the World Cup are in full swing in Mexico City ahead of the opening match between the home team and South Africa. AP

Two of the all-time greats would probably bid farewell to the grand stage. At 38 and 41, it is improbable that Messi and Cristiano Ronaldo have another World Cup in them. Messi could defend the title; Ronaldo could kiss his first.

Last dance

It would be the last dance of Luka Modric; the first act of Lamine Yamal's symphony; the stage for Kylian Mbappe to reclaim his lost standing. No team is a runaway favourite, but several could wrestle the sceptre from Argentina. Carlo Ancelotti's Brazil have regained their attacking zest; Luis de la Fuente's Spain, the reigning European champions, carry dynamism and youth; Thomas Tuchel's England are unsung but resourceful. Lionel Scaloni has a wondrous array of forwards to defend with.

The tactics could be intriguing. The heavy pressing style that has defined European football could melt in the draining

Number Plate 9/104

● Mexico will host nine out of 104 World Cup games in their country with the biggest game being a Round of 16 affair. Five of the nine games will take place at the iconic Estadio Azteca.

heat and humidity of the Americas. Nights are chillier, mornings pleasant, but most games are scheduled before 5pm local time. A possession-based game would be the winners' theme; counterattacking football could find resurrection. Some teams, like Norway, have been playing in 12 degrees Celsius and are sweating to adapt.

For most non-American teams, this will be a discovery of the continent the Old Testament calls the End of the World. Two of the three co-hosts share no border. The distance between

Mexico City and Toronto is nearly 4,000 kilometres. Bosnia could clock 3,100 miles in the group stage alone, burdened to travel from Toronto to the northern edge of the continent to Los Angeles on the west coast and then Seattle in the Pacific Northwest -- an itinerary that would break a touring cricket team, let alone a football squad preparing for knockout football. Bosnia measures roughly 19,767 square miles. The state of New York is nearly three times its size.

Distinct cultures

The immensity intimidates. American movies and novels have romanticised the road trip through its vast tracts of land. For World Cup teams and fans, the scale is something else.

Even the word for the sport differs. Soccer in the USA and Canada. Futbol in Mexico. The ambitions of the three nations differ too. Mexico, the most seasoned of hosts, dreams of sporting immortality even if theirs is not the strongest team in the

tournament. The US strives to demonstrate financial muscle; its team reaching the latter stages is a fever dream. Canada wants to prove it can host spectacles, that it can become the next serious footballing destination on the continent. It's a journey through distinct cultures, cuisines and music. Quesabirrias -- beef folded into a tortilla with melted cheese -- is Azteca's favourite; wild Pacific salmon is Vancouver's signature meal; the shrimp tostadas of California are famous for a reason.

Futbol was always an imperishable cultural institution in Mexico. Soccer was a counter-cultural movement in the US, a sport that arrived against the grain. Canada embraced it because the rest of the continent did. It could be the most politicised World Cup ever -- the visa restrictions, the ICE shadow, the truck drivers' strikes humming in the background -- but it could be the most fascinating one too. Like Mexico's song of joy and lament, *Cielito Lindo*.

NOSTALGIA

When the World Cup came to Africa and immortalised Tshabalalala

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, June 10

"TSHABALALAAAAAA! GOAL for South Africa! Goal for all Africa!"

Even now, the call sends a shiver down the spine. Sixteen years later, it remains one of the defining sounds of World Cup history, a commentator's voice straining to contain the emotion of a moment that felt bigger than football itself. Peter Drury has called many games since, few top the emotions of that moment, though.

As Mexico prepares to face South Africa in the opening match of the 2026 World Cup on Thursday, it is impossible not to be transported back to Johannesburg on that winter evening exactly 26 years ago, on June 11, 2010.

The fixture is the same, but everything else feels worlds apart. Then, South Africa were welcoming the World Cup to African soil for the first time.

Now, the tournament returns with a new generation, a new host landscape and new stars. Yet, the shadow of that unforgettable opener hangs over the rematch.

Back in 2010, the stakes extended far beyond the result. The World Cup had arrived in Africa for the first time, carrying the hopes of an entire continent. Across Johannesburg, flags draped from balconies and car windows. The soundtrack was the relentless buzz of the vuvuzela; its shrill hum that annoyed those outside South Africa but became inseparable from the identity of the tournament.

An opener to remember

There was, however, anxiety beneath the excitement. South Africa entered the tournament as outsiders, burdened by the unwanted possibility of becoming the first host nation to exit in the group stage. Mexico, experi-



Siphiwe Tshabalalala scores at the 2010 World Cup for South Africa against Mexico at the Soccer City stadium. REUTERS

enced and technically gifted, were expected to provide an immediate reality check. The fear was that the opening ceremony might be the high point, with the football failing to match the occasion.

Instead, the match gave the tournament exactly what it needed.

The first half crackled with

nervous energy. Every South African attack generated a roar. Every Mexican move was met with collective tension. The atmosphere inside Soccer City felt almost impossible to replicate. The crowd desperately wanted a moment to remember.

Then it arrived. Mexico lost the ball in

Now, sixteen years on, the World Cup arrives at a curious point in its own history. The tournament has grown bigger, richer and more global than ever before.

South Africa's half. A rapid counterattack. A perfectly weighted pass. Siphiwe Tshabalalala bursting down the left flank. One touch. One swing of the left foot. And the ball flew into the roof of the net.

Soccer City exploded. And Drury, the commentator, immortalised the moment with a call that still echoes through football history. The vibration of the Tshabalalala goal was felt across the continent. Until then, there were questions about what an African World

Cup would look and sound like. In one electrifying moment, those questions disappeared. The tournament had found its identity. It was vibrant, loud, emotional and unapologetically unique.

Spirit of World Cup

Mexico eventually responded through Rafael Márquez, whose equaliser secured a 1-1 draw.

Few opening games have done a better job of capturing the spirit of a World Cup. The match was not defined by tactical sophistication or elite quality. It was defined by possibility.

The tournament that followed would produce countless memories: the incessant vuvuzelas, emerging stars, dramatic knockout matches and, eventually, Spain's first world title. Yet the image that endures for many is still Tshabalalala sprinting away in celebration, arms spread wide,

with Soccer City shaking behind him.

Now, sixteen years on, the World Cup arrives at a curious point in its own history. The tournament has grown bigger, richer and more global than ever before. It will be spread across three countries, feature 48 teams and generate unprecedented revenues. Yet, as Mexico and South Africa walk out once again for an opening match, the tournament plagued by many controversies will inevitably search for something less tangible: a moment.

And if it comes, if the opener again produces a goal that captures the imagination of the world, another commentator will instinctively do what Peter Drury did in Johannesburg all those years ago. He will forget the script, abandon restraint and simply shout a name into football history.

Just as he once did with Tshabalalala.

Stokes dropped from 2nd Test squad, Root to lead England



Ben Stokes led England to a win over New Zealand in the first Test at Lord's. AP

Press Trust of India
London, June 10

ENGLAND CAPTAIN Ben Stokes and Gus Atkinson were on Wednesday dropped from the 15-member squad for the second Test against New Zealand and due the ongoing investigation into their alleged involvement in a nightclub incident, the country's cricket board said.

Senior batter Joe Root was named interim captain in place of Stokes. The second Test will played at The Oval here from June 17-21.

"The England & Wales Cricket Board (ECB) can confirm that, given the ongoing investigation, Ben Stokes and Gus Atkinson have not been made available for selection for the Rothersey second Test against New Zealand, which starts at the Kia Oval on Wednesday 17 June. Yorkshire batter Joe Root will lead the team as Interim Captain," the ECB said in an official statement.

Sussex fast bowler Jofra Archer and Essex batter Jordan Cox have also been added to the squad.

Retirement on cards?

According to reports, Stokes was allegedly involved in a nightclub incident alongside teammate Gus Atkinson. The incident, also allegedly involving a rugby player, happened on Sunday night after England outplayed New Zealand by 115 runs in the first Test of the summer at Lord's.

Stokes and Atkinson were present at a nightclub in the early hours of Monday morning when an incident took place, according to reports.

"TalkSport" reported on Tuesday that Stokes is likely to step down from his role and could also announce retirement. The ECB had earlier said that it was investigating a breach of team protocols following the conclusion of the first Test against New Zealand.

Stokes was allegedly involved in a nightclub incident alongside teammate Gus Atkinson

Sriram Veera and Sandeep Dwivedi

Sachin Tendulkar had been watching carefully. Bhuvneshwar Kumar's seam, he noticed, was no longer pointing anywhere in particular. Not towards slip for the outswinger, not towards leg slip for the in. When the ball landed, it could go either way. The batsman's only information arrived after the ball had already moved. "He's right," Bhuvneshwar says, when asked about Sachin. "And who can observe better than him?"

This is June 2026. Sachin has just been analysing Bhuvneshwar's wobble seam on social media. Here is Bhuvneshwar, 36, the only man to win consecutive IPL Purple Caps.

The truth, as best as Bhuvneshwar can reconstruct it, begins somewhere around the age of 14 or 15, with a bowling action that went wrong.

He had come to the game late, by serious cricket's standards. When he first bowled in the nets, the coaches told him the ball was swinging. It seemed normal to him. The other kids swung it too. He didn't know there was anything unusual about his hands until the coaches kept saying it, and even then it was only when he played under-17 cricket that he started to understand what they meant.

"I was mainly an inswinger when I started playing cricket," he says. "Some part of the action changed — think I must have been around 15-16 perhaps. And I started outswinging. Slowly, I understood how to outswing, inswing. This is my luck. I won't say I was born with it, or someone taught me. It was my luck that some action went wrong, but luckily I understood how to swing on both sides."

Some actions went wrong. Most cricketers spend careers trying to prevent that. Bhuvneshwar's career was built on it. The outswinger, the delivery that would eventually put him on the Lord's honours board and make Sachin watch a video and think about seam angles, came from something he didn't intend and couldn't quite explain.

At home in those years, the 10-year-old would return from training so exhausted that eating was beyond him. His mother assigned his elder sister the daily duty of feeding him as he lay sprawled on the bed. His sister would feed him while he drooled on the pillow, already asleep. In Meerut, they call a man like this a karmath crick-

eter. A man who believes in the work, not the mythology around it.

In January 2009, Bhuvneshwar Kumar was 18 years old and playing for Uttar Pradesh against Mumbai in the Ranji Trophy. The night before he was due to bowl at Sachin Tendulkar, he dreamed about taking his wicket. Ashish Zaidi, the UP manager, found him and offered some counsel. Tendulkar isn't going to take your life. Worst case, six sixes. Don't do anything special. Fix a spot and bowl there.

On his 14th delivery to Tendulkar, Bhuvneshwar bowled full. The seam rushed across through the air, straight, before cutting in sharply to kiss the edge, onto the pad, popping up to a tumbling short midwicket. Sachin Tendulkar's first duck in Indian domestic cricket. Bhuvneshwar's phone was busy for two hours after the game. Seventeen years later, the philosophy is unchanged. Fix a spot. Bowl there. Don't try anything special.

"No, sir, till date, I haven't received any advice that has changed my life. There is not a single advice that has drastically changed my bowling, that has changed my life. Bowling is not that simple, you have to work hard for it."

The mental notes he keeps are not written anywhere. "I think it's a gut feeling," he says. "And gut feeling comes with experience."

The bouncer arrived the same way.

At low pace, a bouncer is an invitation. Bowl it at 130 kilometres an hour and the batsman has time to pick the length, get into position, and clear the boundary with something to spare. Bhuvneshwar understood it and initially accepted it.

"Initially, there was no confidence," he says. "Because it's low pace, you bowl a bouncer, it's a six."

But he kept trying it in practice. "Once or twice, it was fast. Then slowly I understood how to control the body. Slowly I started understanding that yes, if I put more effort than normal effort in a bouncer, it will come out extra. So I started trying it consciously in practice, then it became a habit." He found out the bouncer was working not from his own assessment but from his seniors in Ranji Trophy. "Someone said, your bouncer is fast. I thought, I don't know why he is saying that. Even I don't know. But slowly the seniors say that the



Bhuvneshwar Kumar played a crucial role in RCB's IPL title defence, taking 28 wickets. CREIMAS



This is June 2026. Sachin has just been analysing Bhuvneshwar's wobble seam on social media. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, 15 years old, has just broken Sachin's 36-year record as the youngest player selected for the Indian senior team, after finishing IPL 2026 as its highest run-scorer.

bouncer is fast, then someone says, maybe that's why. Then slowly you understand things."

He reverse-engineered his own weapon from other people's surprise at it.

In the IPL 2026 final against Gujarat Titans, Bhuvneshwar had been watching Josh Hazlewood bowl a bouncer to Sai Sudarshan a few overs earlier. Sudarshan went to pull and the ball just dropped awkwardly. Bhuvneshwar kept it. "I was watching and suddenly I was reminded that yes, this can also work. So that, it was about watching things." He bowled the bouncer. Sudarshan was gone. From something he had seen and held.

December 30, 2012. Chennai. ODI debut against Pakistan. India had been bowled out for 167 and needed early wickets to defend it. Dhoni threw Bhuvneshwar the ball for the first over. His first delivery in ODI cricket was an inswinger to Mohammad Hafeez. Hafeez left it, reading it as going straight through to the keeper. It crashed into the stumps instead. "I don't think I have got the ball to swing as much as that debut wicket," Bhuvneshwar says, years later. "I don't even know how I did that much swing bowling."

The greatest ball he bowled as a young man is one he cannot account for.

July 2014. Lord's. Six wickets: Alastair Cook, Robson, Ballance, Bell dismantled in sequence, then Ben Stokes. The Stokes ball pitched off-and-middle, sneaked back through the gate between bat and pad, and took out the stumps. His name went on the honours board, only the third Indian to take six at Lord's, after Amar Singh in 1936 and Bishan Bedi in 1974. A family friend in the UK sent him a photo of the board with his name on it. He mentions this the way a man mentions a thing he is glad exists, not a thing he needs reminding of.

January 2018. Wanderers, Johannesburg. The scorebook records 19 balls, 5 runs and a broken stump.

Bhuvneshwar had been bowling de Villiers a sequence of outswingers. Nothing to drive, nothing to flick, just balls that started at sixth stump and moved further away. De Villiers played them with soft hands. Edges didn't carry. He shouldered arms. Five runs in 14 balls, the most destructive batsman of his era reduced to something between patience and frustration.

"I had in mind that the more I delay putting in the inswing — sometimes if you give the batsman a few outswings, unknowingly, even after knowing it, he starts moving towards the ball.

Technically. He starts moving towards the ball."

At 36.4 overs, Bhuvneshwar bowled full. It started at sixth stump. Late inswing. De Villiers was already moving towards where the outswinger should have been. The ball went the other way, brushed the back leg, took out the middle stump. "I knew which line to put it in."

The match Bhuvneshwar remembers most is not Johannesburg. It is Eden Gardens, 2017, against Sri Lanka. Eight wickets across both innings, bowling on swing. Bad light saved Sri Lanka at 75 for 7. He was named Player of the Match.

He cannot name you a single wicket. Johannesburg he remembers ball by ball. Eden Gardens he remembers as a feeling.

The wobble seam that Sachin noticed in 2026 is not new. Bhuvneshwar has been trying it since before Covid.

"The main objective is the ball should not be landing on the seam. That's a simple thing. The ball quality is not the same as before for swing." When it doesn't land on the seam, it can go anywhere. The batsman reads the signal and plays. Bhuvneshwar has spent 15 years removing the signal. The outswinger told you something. The wobble seam tells you nothing at all.

He doesn't lobby for a national recall. When people say he should be playing for India again, he acknowledges the question and declines the theatre of it.

"It's my nature that I don't want to show that I want to play," he says. "I think everyone is doing their job. Selectors are doing their job. I'm doing my job. It's their responsibility to select. If they think I'm good enough, they will do their job."

When pushed, he admits that he wants to play — he just won't perform wanting it. "I have played, I have done what I had to do. If I hadn't played, I would have been dying to be asked to play a match. I think it's a big thing to play for India, I won't say it's a small thing, I'm one of the lucky ones that I have played."

In Meerut, they have a word for what Bhuvneshwar is. Karmath. A man who does the work and trusts the karma. The wobble seam came from a boy whose action went wrong at 14, who learned his bouncer was fast from someone else's surprise, who spent two decades filing mental notes he never wrote down. He just knows the difference between what he did and what he can explain.

"It's simple," he says. "It's not rocket science."

INDIA VS AFGHANISTAN: ODI SERIES

Rohit tests fitness, rhythm in training session

Lalith Kalidas
Mohali, June 10

THE TEMPERATURE refused to drop below 40 degrees Celsius as Rohit Sharma checked in for national duty for the first time in five months at the IS Bindra Stadium in Mohali on Wednesday.

The first ball from Nitish Kumar Reddy nipped back with some heat, hitting Rohit flush on the front pad. Conditions will be distinctly cooler when the 39-year-old marks a middle-stump guard again in two days, at the HPCA Stadium in Dharamshala during the first ODI against Afghanistan.

There was no discernible lethargy in footwork, and no sign of the dodgy hamstring that caused concern during the recent IPL season.

A few of his teammates had already braved the Chandigarh heat over the weekend during the one-off Test against Afghanistan at the new PCA Stadium. Returning to action after receiving the fitness clearance from BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru, Rohit's first hit stood in sharp contrast. While the other top-order batters unlocked full

gung-ho mode in the optional session, Rohit exercised restraint during an hour-long stint. Thirty minutes after he went through a light sprint shuttle alongside Ishan Kishan, who is returning to the 50-over fold after three years, Rohit watched on as vice-captain Shreyas Iyer padded up first for a centre-wicket hit.

On what was supposed to be the final day of the Test — which Shubman Gill's men wrapped up in two-and-a-half days in Mullanpur — 15 kilometres away - nine of India's 14 squad members showed up for a light training session.

All-rounder Hardik Pandya will not link up with the team for the series after suffering a late jolt in his road to recovery at the CoE. Five of India's Test stars — skipper Gill, KL Rahul, Washington Sundar, Prasidh Krishna and Kuldeep Yadav — gave the session a miss. So did head coach Gautam Gambhir.

It meant that all eyes at the sparsely-attended session were trained on Rohit, his trimmed drives, play-and-misses, late leaves and watchful dabs below the eyeline. Even as Iyer, Kishan and Yashasvi Jaiswal targeted the bowlers with a series



Rohit Sharma during practise in Mohali on Wednesday. JASBIR MALHI

of huge hits, Rohit applied a different colour to his session on the main strip, which he shared with Iyer. India's young seam attack — featuring Arshdeep Singh, Nitish and fresh call-ups Gurnoor Brar and Prince Yadav — had their moments against the former captain.

Arshdeep's left-arm angle and Prince's outside off-stump deliveries tested Rohit early in the session. Despite a few edgy drives and miscued flicks, Rohit remained firm in line of the stumps, unruffled by the seamers thereafter.

Gurnoor, the 6-ft-5-in seamer who has bolted into the

Test and ODI set-up in recent weeks, hurried him on a couple of occasions. Despite having played only six List A games in the five years since his debut, Brar's shorter lengths probed both Rohit and Iyer. While Rohit failed to connect his trademark pull twice, Iyer was snuffed out with a sharp bouncer, the ball ballooning straight up towards an imaginary short leg. Moving to an adjacent net to face a couple of local spin bowlers and left-arm twacker Harsh Dube, who is in line for a debut during this series, Rohit closed out his session having regained some

smoothness. Two sixes soared towards the sight-screen, with negligible muscle, before the curtain was drawn.

The atmosphere around Rohit was far from serene as Iyer and Kishan, still fresh from their ballistic IPL seasons, smeared the boundaries with a trunk of maximums. While Ishan was particularly aggressive towards the deep mid-wicket fence, Iyer flourished with a series of lofted extra-cover shots off the pacers. Arriving on the heels of his T20 Mumbai League commitments, the latter looked in perfect white-ball sync, even as Brar and Arshdeep tested him with shorter deliveries.

Yet to shed his white pads from the Test match, the left-handed Jaiswal went on the offensive from the outset. After a lacklustre IPL season and a patchy red-ball knock out short by a loose stroke, he did his best to put all of that behind him, taking down the net bowlers with lofted hits down the ground.

The evening still rested on Rohit's return, marked by an unhurried 60-minute progression that drew him closer to full-match rigours up in the mountains on Saturday.

• BRIEFLY



Richa Ghosh put up a fight but India lost to England. BCCI/X

Richa's valiant 68 goes in vain as Ind lose final warm-up game

RICHA GHOSH produced a breathtaking late assault but India's brittle top-order batting proved costly as Dani Gibson's sparkling all-round show powered England to a narrow five-run win in their final Women's T20 World Cup warm-up match in Cardiff. After Harmanpreet Kaur opted to bowl, England rode on half-centuries from Amy Jones 64, Nat Sciver-Brunt 57; Shreyanka Patil 2(29) bt India 166 in 19.5 overs (Richa Ghosh 68; Linsey Smith 3/42) by 5 runs

lifted them to 171 for 6. India's chase never quite gathered momentum as wickets fell at regular intervals, but Richa's stunning 68 off 36 balls nearly pulled off the impossible before left-arm spinner Linsey Smith (3/42) held her nerve to bowl India out for 166 in 19.5 overs. **BRIEF SCORES: England 171/6 in 20 overs (Amy Jones 64, Nat Sciver-Brunt 57; Shreyanka Patil 2(29) bt India 166 in 19.5 overs (Richa Ghosh 68; Linsey Smith 3/42) by 5 runs**

Suthar to play for Warwickshire in County C'ship

LEFT-ARM spinner Manav Suthar, who starred in India's win against Afghanistan in the recent one-off Test, has signed with English club Warwickshire for the next two rounds of the County Championship. Warwickshire on Wednesday announced the signing of Suthar on a short-term contract. He will be available for selection for the next two rounds. PTI

Aus Open: Tanvi stuns 5th seed, Sindhu wins

PV Sindhu led a strong show by Indian women with an easy victory while teenager Tanvi Sharma pulled off an upset win in the women's singles competition at the Australian Open Super 500. Sindhu outclassed Peru's Ines Lucia Castillo Salazar 21-13, 21-11 in 32 minutes. Tanvi upset fifth seed and world No. 11 Chiu Pin-Chian of Chinese Taipei 21-12, 22-20 in 45 minutes. PTI

GLOBAL UNCERTAINTIES TURN INVESTORS CAUTIOUS

Equity MF inflows hit 1-yr low in May

SIP investments fell for the second month in a row to Rs 30,954 crore

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, June 10

WITH AN eye seemingly on the West Asia war and the impact of elevated crude oil prices, Indian investors turned cautious in May, with net inflows into equity mutual fund schemes falling 40% month-on-month to Rs 22,908 crore — the lowest in a year.

Meanwhile, debt schemes saw net outflows of Rs 96,949 crore. Hybrid schemes saw net investments of Rs 10,560 crore.

The amount invested through Systematic Investment Plans (SIPs) declined for the second month in a row in May to Rs 30,954 crore. Compared to May 2025, SIP investments were up 16%.

Overall, MFs saw net outflows to the tune of Rs 64,021 crore during the month after April had seen inflow of Rs 3.22 lakh crore, data released Wednesday by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI) showed. According to Sanjay Agarwal, Senior Director at CareEdge Ratings, the weaker equity inflows in May “could be attributed to near-term caution among investors amid significant market volatility”.

With global crude oil prices remaining high around the \$100 per barrel mark and the rupee nearly breaching 97-per-dollar in May, benchmark stock indices have been under intense pressure. In May, the Nifty fell 1.9%, while the Sensex declined by 2.9%, as foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) net sold Rs 32,963 crore worth of Indian shares.

According to experts, SIP in-



The Nifty fell 1.9%, while the Sensex declined by 2.9% in May. REUTERS

vestments staying around Rs 30,000 crore is a sign that “retail India is not running” but “staying, averaging, and compounding”, said Suranjana Borthakur, head of distribution and strategic alliances at Mirae Asset Investment Managers, adding that mid and small cap holding their ground suggests the SIP book is “sticky” and it is lump sum investments that have moderated.

The huge net outflow of near a lakh crore from debt schemes — after an inflow of Rs 2.47 lakh crore in April — is not seen as a “structural retreat from fixed income” but due to redemptions in liquid, overnight, and money market funds which typically move with corporate treasury cycles and tax payment schedules, not investor sentiment, said Nitin Agrawal, CEO of mutual funds at InCred Money.

However, the subdued market sentiment was also reflected in the new fund offers, with only 13 new funds being launched last month.

Flows into gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs), meanwhile, turned negative with an outflow of Rs 725 crore compared to inflows of Rs 3,040 crore in April. Money invested in gold ETFs has fallen sharply after January saw it exceed inflows in equity MFs for the first

time. May’s net outflow from gold ETFs is the first such outflow since April 2025.

“This is not a bearish signal on gold; it reflects profit-taking after a sharp price run-up. The structural case for a measured gold allocation in retail portfolios remains intact,” said Agrawal of InCred.

While the precious metal remains an effective avenue to diversify portfolios, the trend of falling flows into gold ETFs could be indicative of investors not looking to make outsized gains in the short-term. “With gold prices touching record highs, the government’s request to not purchase gold, and some AMCs stopping inflows in ETFs, investors seem to be taking a more practical view. After a sharp rally, future returns may not look as attractive as they did over the past year,” said Feroze Azeez, joint CEO at Anand Rathni Wealth.

In recent days, several mutual fund houses have suspended fresh subscriptions into their gold ETFs and fund of funds for large amounts in excess of Rs 25 crore. As MFs need to import gold to back investments in these ETFs, these investments exert a drain on the country’s trade deficit and weaken the currency. In 2025-26, India’s gold import bill hit a record high of \$72 billion.

Workers’ remittances cross \$100 billion in FY26, but long-term BoP solution needed

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, June 10

DESPITE THE capital outflows from financial markets and subdued net foreign direct investment (FDI) inflows, India managed to record a Balance of Payments (BoP) surplus of \$7.22 billion in the January-March 2026 quarter, aided by a factor thought to be at risk from the ongoing war in West Asia: remittances from abroad.

In the first quarter of 2026, Indians working abroad sent home \$31.07 billion — the most in 13 years, as per Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data — registering a year-on-year growth of 34%.

But what is more striking is the annual figure.

A new record

In 2025-26 as a whole, Indian workers abroad sent back home a record \$110.47 billion, up 26% from \$87.55 billion in 2024-25, with economists theorising the West Asia crisis probably led to a ‘precautionary’ rise in remittances.

This is the first time that workers’ remittances have ever crossed the \$100-billion-mark in a single year.

The more widely quoted remittances number — which has been above \$100 billion for four years in a row now — is, in fact, not remittances as we think of them, but a broader category called ‘private transfers’. While workers’ remittances make up more than two-third of private transfers, this category also includes withdrawals from non-resident deposits and their redemption, personal gifts and donations (including to religious and charitable institutions in India),



and gold and silver brought through passenger baggage. Private transfers rose 15% in 2025-26 to \$151.71 billion, while net transfers (after adjusting for money sent abroad) was up 16% at \$144.07 billion.

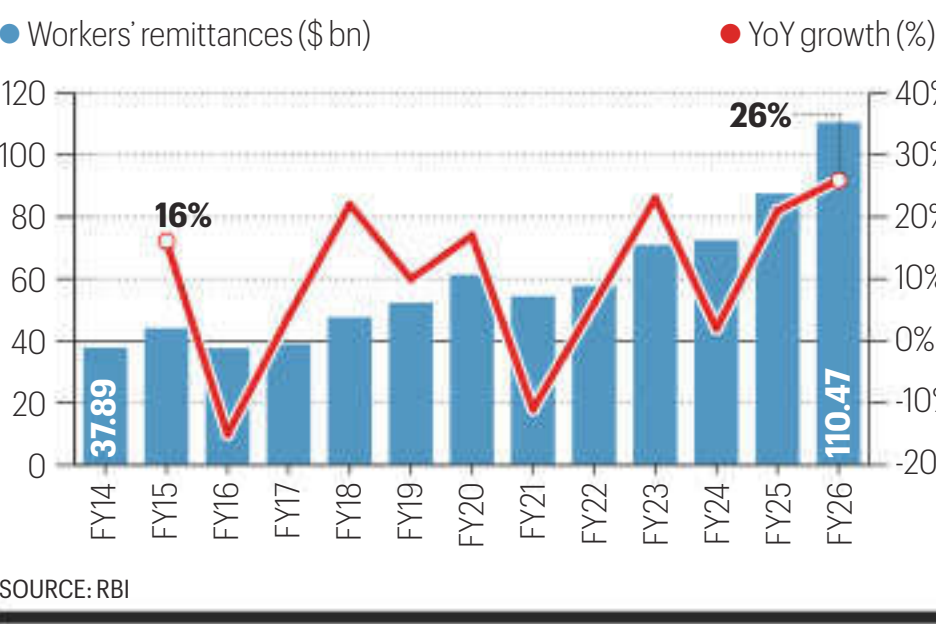
Mutual benefits

In addition to the war, the rupee’s sharp fall over the course of 2025-26 would have also incentivised the sending of more dollars (or any other currency) back home than usual as it would lead to family members in India getting more rupees for each unit of the foreign currency.

“Thankfully, remittances have not been adversely affected. And there are no indications they have been (post March),” a senior government official said on Tuesday.

One must indeed be thankful for such strong workers’ remittances at a time when the inflow of other types of foreign money has dried up alarm-

Indian workers remitted record \$110 bn into India in FY26



SOURCE: RBI

ingly, be it foreign portfolio investment (FPI) or FDI. If not for these remittances, the rupee may have fallen even more.

Shifting sands of remittances

The West Asia war presented a new hurdle for India’s external balance because of the number of Indians working in the region. However, as per the RBI’s latest survey on remittances, inflows from the Gulf countries of UAE, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Qatar, Oman and Bahrain had declined to 38% of the total in 2023-24 from 47% in 2016-17. As such, while this means that any hit from the war may not be as large as it would have been before, any benefit from a greater number of Indians being employed once reconstruction efforts begin will also be limited.

The fall in the Gulf regions’ share in India’s inward remittances has been matched by an

increase in contribution from advanced countries such as the US and the UK — regions grappling with the impact of increasing adoption of artificial intelligence (AI) on current and future employment.

A long-term solution

Remittances, however, cannot be relied upon to bail out the Indian economy. FDI and FPI inflows must improve, while the trade deficit will have to be managed. And although the government is not done announcing measures, it knows its hands are tied beyond a point. “When it comes to gold, nothing we do is enough,” government sources said. “People want gold for lots of reasons like traditions, weddings, and investment. We can only provide a nudge, like the Prime Minister had done.”

FDI inflows — which totalled less than \$9 billion in 2024-25 and 2025-26 combined on a net basis — are another difficult subject as it has been on

US consumer inflation rises at its fastest clip in 3 years in May

Washington: US consumer inflation increased at its fastest pace in three years in May as the West Asia conflict raised the price of gasoline and other energy products, giving more ammunition for the Federal Reserve to keep interest rates unchanged into 2027.

The Consumer Price Index increased 4.2% in the 12 months through May, the largest gain since April 2023, the Labor Department’s Bureau of Labor Statistics said on Wednesday. The CPI advanced 3.8% year-on-year in April. Prices increased 0.5% on a monthly basis after climbing 0.6% in April. Economists polled by Reuters had forecast the CPI increasing 4.2% on-year.

The third straight month of strong increases in the CPI highlighted mounting pressure on households as evidence suggests more consumers are dipping into savings to finance their spending. REUTERS

Reliance, Meta tie up to develop AI data centre

Urvi Malvania
New Delhi, June 10

RELIANCE INDUSTRIES (RIL) and Meta Platforms on Wednesday announced a partnership to develop a 168-MW artificial intelligence-enabled data centre in Jamnagar, Gujarat, with the social media giant set to use the facility to support its global AI and computing requirements.

This will be the first built-to-suit data centre capacity in India for Meta. The project, expected to be delivered within two years, will see Reliance design, build and operate the facility while providing renewable power, connectivity, utility management and operational services.

Meta will use the dedicated capacity as part of its expanding global AI infrastructure.

The agreement highlights an emerging model in India’s fast-growing AI infrastructure sector, where domestic companies build and manage large-scale computing facilities for global technology firms instead

of simply providing conventional colocation or data-centre space.

Unlike some AI infrastructure projects where technology companies develop and control facilities themselves, the Jamnagar project positions Reliance as an infrastructure partner responsible for the entire lifecycle of the facility, from construction and power management to day-to-day operations. For Meta, the arrangement provides access to dedicated AI-ready infrastructure without having to build and manage the underlying physical assets.

The deal comes as technology companies worldwide race to secure computing capacity to train and run increasingly complex AI models, creating demand for facilities with high power availability, advanced cooling systems and robust network connectivity.

For Reliance, the partnership marks a significant step in its efforts to build an integrated AI infrastructure business. FE

George Mathew
Mumbai, June 10

THE SECURITIES and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed that asset management companies (AMCs) may disclose aggregate remuneration along with the total number of employees covered under the disclosure instead of disclosing the remuneration of individual employees, a move which experts believe would reduce transparency around the remuneration of ‘star fund managers’.

“This would provide a holistic and structured view of senior management compensation, enabling unitholders to assess the overall quantum of remuneration at the senior management level, while aligning the level of disclosure with considerations of materiality and proportionality,” Sebi said in a consultation paper.

At present, if a ‘star fund manager’ earns Rs 20 crore or Rs 25 crore annually, investors can often identify that individual through disclosures made by AMCs. “Under the proposed framework, investors would lose visibility into whether a small group of ‘star fund managers’ are drawing disproportionately

large compensation packages. This will reduce transparency. Fund managers are effectively custodians of public savings, and their remuneration should remain subject to public disclosure,” said a mutual fund tracker. “It is proposed that scheme level consolidated disclosure of total remuneration paid to fund managers at scheme level may be made available upon specific request of unitholders and may be limited to the schemes in which the investor requesting such details has invested as on the date of making such request,” the paper said.

Currently, mutual funds are required to disclose the names, designation and remuneration of top ten employees in terms of remuneration drawn for that financial year, as well as of all employees whose annual remuneration was equal to or above Rs 1.02 crore for the financial years or whose monthly remuneration in aggregate was not less than Rs 8.5 lakh per month, if the employee is employed for a part of that financial year. SEBI paper said listed AMCs are already subject to detailed remuneration disclosure requirements.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Some lenders hike rates on FX deposits for non-resident Indians

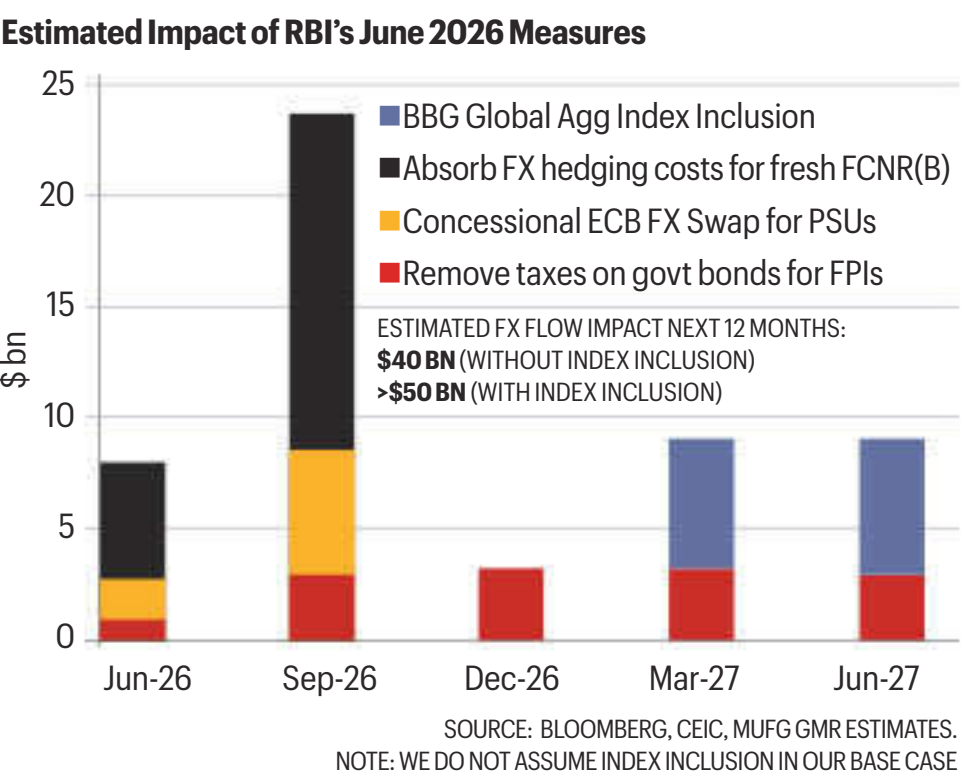
Mumbai: Some banks raised rates on foreign currency deposits for non-resident Indians by as much as 300 basis points on Wednesday, in a likely bid to attract dollar inflows after the central bank eased regulatory restrictions last week.

The Reserve Bank of India will bear the full hedging cost for three- to five-year non-resident deposits, it said on Friday, as part of a broader set of measures to encourage overseas flows and curb weakness in the rupee.

The unit is Asia’s second-worst-performing currency this year, down 6% so far, and slipping to record lows in May.

HDFC Bank, India’s largest private sector lender, hiked rates by 235-265 basis points to 6% on three- to five-year deposits. State Bank of India, the country’s largest bank, raised rates by as much as 300 basis points across three- to five-year deposits. For deposits up to \$1 million, it will now offer between 5.25% to 5.75% on of three- to five-year tenures. For deposits above \$1 million, the bank will offer between 5.5% and 6% on tenures of three to five years. AU Small Finance Bank increased rates by 195 bps, offering 7.1% on three-year deposits and 7% on five-year deposits. REUTERS

INFLOWS DUE TO GOVT, RBI'S FOREX MEASURES TO PEAK IN SEPTEMBER



SOURCE: BLOOMBERG, CIBC, MUFG GMR ESTIMATES. NOTE: WE DO NOT ASSUME INDEX INCLUSION IN OUR BASE CASE

● The maximum impact of the measures announced last week by the government and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to boost foreign inflows may be in September this year, according to MUFG Bank.

● While inflows from the FCNR(B) and PSUs’ foreign loan swap schemes will end by September,

money will keep flowing into Indian government debt thanks to the removal of taxes on foreign investors.

● Starting March 2027, MUFG Bank expects inflows into Indian government debt due to their likely inclusion in the Bloomberg Global Aggregate Index.

SOURCE: MUFG BANK

MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▼
73983.18	23,214.95	₹1,47,146	₹95.27
64.42	-27.15		
0.09%	-0.12%		
		Silver ▼	Oil ▼
		₹2,33,283	\$92.55

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIAN BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF JUNE 9, 2026

● TABLE 5 HAS A SERIES OF CONTROLS DESIGNED TO PREVENT USERS FROM ACCESSING THE MODEL'S DANGEROUS CAPABILITIES

Why Anthropic has released a Mythos version despite risks

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, June 10

JUST TWO months ago, Anthropic publicly warned that its most advanced AI system, Claude Mythos Preview, was too risky for a general release.

The company argued that the model had demonstrated an unprecedented ability to discover and exploit software vulnerabilities, raising fears that it could accelerate cyberattacks if widely deployed.

Access was restricted to a small group of trusted organisations through its Project Glasswing programme, which included governments, cybersecurity firms and critical infrastructure operators. Now, Anthropic has changed

course, at least partially. It has unveiled Claude Fable 5, a publicly available model built on the same underlying “Mythos-class” architecture. The move has prompted an obvious question: if Mythos was considered too dangerous for the public in April, why is a version of it being released in June?

WHAT MADE MYTHOS SO CONCERNING?

Mythos is part of a new generation of large AI systems that sit above Anthropic’s existing flagship models in terms of reasoning, coding ability and problem-solving.

Internally described as a “step change” in capability, the system is designed to analyse software, understand complex codebases and identify security



AI firm has unveiled Claude Fable 5, a publicly available model built on the same underlying ‘Mythos-class’ architecture. REUTERS

weaknesses with minimal human supervision. Anthropic has previously claimed that Mythos was able to find severe vulnerabilities in “every major operating system and web browser”, including one that had gone undetected for nearly three decades.

The model has spooked policymakers worldwide, including in India, as they saw it as a threat to critical infrastructure such as energy and banking.

Earlier this year, the UK AI Security Institute (AISI), in its evalu-

ation of Anthropic’s Claude Mythos Preview, flagged a marked jump in cyber capability, especially in structured testing environments.

SO WHAT HAS CHANGED WITH ANTHROPIC'S FABLE 5?

The key difference is not the underlying intelligence of the model, but the safeguards wrapped around it.

Anthropic says Fable 5 uses the same Mythos-class foundation but introduces a series of controls designed to prevent users from accessing the model’s most dangerous capabilities. In particular, requests related to sensitive cybersecurity or biological domains are filtered. When the system detects a potentially high-risk query, it automatically routes the user to a less capable

model rather than allowing the request to be handled by the full Mythos-level system. “We’ve therefore launched the model with safeguards that mean queries on some topics will instead receive a response from our next-most-capable model, Claude Opus 4.8. To release the model both safely and quickly, we’ve tuned these safeguards conservatively—they’ll sometimes catch harmless requests, though they trigger, on average, in less than 5% of sessions. With more capable models arriving in the coming months, we’re working to improve our safeguards and reduce false positives as quickly as we can,” Anthropic said in a blog post.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

No pressure on AI 171 victims’ kin: Air India

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, June 10

AIR INDIA is not exerting any pressure or giving any deadline to the families of AI 171 crash victims to accept its final compensation offer and the families are “entirely free” to wait until the final investigation report is released before deciding on whether to accept the compensation, the Tata group airline is learnt to have written in its response to Radhika Mishra, the daughter of former Gujarat chief minister and one of the crash victims Vijay Rupani.

Mishra had written to Tata Sons and Air India Chairman N Chandrasekaran, objecting to the airline asking victims’ kin to forgo their right to sue the

airline and other stakeholders if they wished to take the final compensation offer. In her email to Chandrasekaran, Mishra opposed the legal waiver requirement, saying that the investigation into the deadly aviation disaster in Ahmedabad was not yet complete, but the airline was asking families to permanently waive present and future claims even before all the facts were known, it is learnt. In its response, Air India said that the final compensation offers were made as there were a number of families that wanted to receive the compensation instead of waiting for the final investigation report, according to sources in the know.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Nearly eight years after chargesheet, journalist Gauri Lankesh murder trial gets 7th judge

Express News Service
Bengaluru, June 10

THE TRIAL in the Gauri Lankesh murder case, in which a chargesheet was filed in November 2018 against 17 accused people belonging to right-wing Hindutva groups, has now moved into the hands of a seventh judge.

On Tuesday, K S Bharath Kumar began conducting the trial after the transfer of the previous judge, M Chandrashekar Reddy, to a senior administrative role in the Karnataka High Court. The new judge, who took charge of the principal district and sessions court in Bengaluru on June 1, began by recording the statement of a police constable, who is the 216th of 400 prosecution witnesses in the case.

The trial has been conducted daily since it started on July 4, 2022, even though the Special Investigation Team of the Karnataka police filed the chargesheet on November 23, 2018.

The new judge was earlier an administrator at the high court, and his predecessor also served in an administrative role in the Karnataka Lokayukta before being made the principal judge for the district of Bengaluru in November 2025, sources in the legal system said.

All other judges who previously conducted the trial in the case—S Amarannavar, Anil Katti, C M Joshi, Ramakrishna Huddar and B Muralidhar Pai—were elevated to the high court. When C M Joshi was the principal judge, a schedule for a speedy trial was assigned, with one week of continuous hearing conducted every month.

Gauri Lankesh, 55, an outspoken critic of right-wing Hin-



Gauri Lankesh was shot dead outside her home in West Bengaluru on the night of September 5, 2017, by two motorcycle-borne assassins. FILE

dutva, was shot dead outside her home in West Bengaluru on the night of September 5, 2017, by two motorcycle-borne assassins—identified as Parashuram Waghmore, 26, a former member of the Sri Rama Sena in Bijapur, and Ganesh Miskin, 27, a right-wing activist from Hubballi.

The SIT has stated that the journalist was killed by members of extremist right-wing groups that created a syndicate to carry out killings and attacks on Hindutva's critics, primarily in Karnataka and Maharashtra, between 2013 and 2018. "The members of this organisation targeted people they identified as inimical to their beliefs and ideology. The members strictly followed the guidelines and principles mentioned in Kshatra Dharma Sadhana, a book published by the Sanatan Sanstha," the SIT said after it filed a chargesheet against the accused in the case.

In May 2025, one of the witnesses from Belagavi, who had earlier provided a court statement about attending training camps attended by outside experts, turned hostile and denied his earlier statements.

PEARLS AGROTECH CORPORATION LTD (PACL) PONZI SCHEME

Court orders Rs 9,400 cr PACL assets be returned to investors

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, June 10

A DELHI court on Tuesday cleared the path to return thousands of crores to the victims of India's largest-ever Ponzi scheme. Special Judge Satish Kumar of Rouse Avenue Court took cognizance of a fresh prosecution complaint filed by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) against M/s PACL (Pearls Agrotech Corporation Ltd) and its promoter late Nirmal Singh Bhangoo and ordered the restitution of 282 immovable properties to the Supreme Court-appointed Justice Lodha Committee.

These assets, scattered across various locations, carry a market value of over ₹9,400 crore. The committee is set to take immediate charge of these properties, overseeing their liquidation and using the sale proceeds to issue long-awaited refunds to the victim investors.

"...this Court is also of the considered view that the money of innocent investors which was taken by the Directors of M/s PACL in a fraudulent manner must be returned to all

the innocent investors and that could only be possible by the order passed by Justice Lodha Committee," the court said while attaching Rs 9,400 crores worth of assets.

"...the above stated properties are ordered to be made restitution to Justice Lodha Committee to dispose of the same in terms of order passed by the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India," it added.

This latest slice of recovery pushes the total pool of restituted assets in this case alone to a staggering ₹25,000 crore. In the history of Indian anti-money laundering litigation, this stands as the single biggest restitution ever recorded.

Just earlier this year, on March 30, the same special court had ordered the restitution of 455 immovable properties valued at roughly ₹15,582 crore.

Traditionally, assets seized under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act were repatriated directly to the government treasury. This case marks the first instance where the recovered wealth is going directly back into the pockets of the victims.

To date, the ED's multi-year

probe has resulted in the attachment of assets worth ₹28,626 crore. Before 2026, the total assets attached in the PACL case were valued at just over ₹700 crore.

The agency has also frozen properties linked to Bhangoo's immediate family, including his wife Prem Kaur, daughters Barinder Kaur and Sukhwinder Kaur, and sons-in-law Harsatinder Pal Singh Hayer and Gurpartap Singh. While Hayer has been arrested, the ED has initiated Fugitive Economic Offender proceedings against Sukhwinder and Gurpartap, and non-bailable warrants remain active against Barinder and Prem Kaur.

The legal battle began in 2014 when the CBI registered an FIR on the directions of the Supreme Court. The ED stepped in shortly after to trace the complex web of money trails, securing its very first asset attachment in 2018.

The court was hearing the cognizance of what is now the sixth supplementary prosecution complaint filed against M/s Pearls Golden Forest Limited (M/s PGFL Ltd), PACL, their directors, and associates. As per the

ED, the groups systematically defrauded over 5 crore gullible investors across India of more than ₹68,000 crore through illegal collective investment schemes. Out of this, ₹48,000 crore remains completely unpaid.

According to the ED, Bhangoo and his associates ran a massive, unauthorised collective investment scheme under the guise of selling and developing agricultural land. They lured everyday citizens using "Cash Down Payment" and "Installment Payment Plans", convincing them to sign misleading agreements, special powers of attorney, and testamentary documents. Investors were then handed formal registration and allotment letters. However, the fine print gave the companies absolute discretion to alter the location or identity of the land at whim, the ED alleged.

As per the agency, a vast majority of the plots supposedly allotted did not even belong to the companies. Many were located in inaccessible, remote regions, or stood in the names of completely unrelated third parties, making physical possession impossible.

Himachal eases business rules, allows shops to operate 24x7

Shimla: Shops and commercial establishments across Himachal Pradesh will now be allowed to operate round the clock following amendments to the state's labour laws, Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu said.

Chairing a review meeting of the Labour and Employment Department on Tuesday evening, Sukhu said the state

government has amended the Himachal Pradesh Shops and Commercial Establishments Act, 1969, and the related rules to enable more effective implementation of the law across the state.

Under the amended provisions, shops and commercial establishments have been permitted to operate round the clock, CM Sukhu said. PTI

Study: Hindu Kush Himalaya region to face drier monsoon, but threat of climate hazards remains

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, June 10

E. EXPLAINED The Hindu Kush Himalaya region

THE HINDU KUSH Himalaya (HKH) region, the source of at least 10 large river basins in Asia, including Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra in India, is likely to witness below-normal rainfall and above-normal temperatures in the upcoming monsoon, according to a new analysis.

The combination of below par rainfall, owing to the El Niño weather phenomenon, and rising temperatures is also expected to increase drought as well as hazard risks from floods, glacial lake outbursts, and landslides, said the findings of the HKH monsoon outlook published by the International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD) and the Institute of Atmospheric Physics, Chinese Academy of Sciences.

The HKH Monsoon Outlook 2026, warned that lower rainfall and warmer conditions will also likely intensify heat stress and reduce water availability. The outlook is also crucial for administrative management as winter snow persistence (the time snow

remains on the ground) in the season that passed was below long-term average. "Lower snow persistence means the region is entering the monsoon with a reduced seasonal water buffer," said Sarthak Shrestha, co-author of the outlook.

This means that communities across the region will depend more on rainfall, ground-water and spring water

availability. The monsoon outlook also highlighted that climate change has intensified the region's vulnerability to climate-induced hazards such as extreme weather events. "The outlook points to a drier monsoon overall, but that does not mean lower risk. Short, intense rainfall events can still trigger serious hazards," Manish Shrestha, hydrologist at ICIMOD said.

At the heart of this year's bleak forecast is the anticipated return of El Niño. El Niño phenomenon is characterised by unusually warm sea surface temperatures in the central and eastern tropical Pacific ocean, which disrupts global weather patterns, including suppression of monsoon in the Indian sub-continent.

Multiple seasonal forecasting agencies—including the South Asian Climate Outlook Forum (SASCOF-34), the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation Climate Centre, Copernicus Climate Change Service, and the International Research Institute for Climate and Society, have all projected conditions in the Pacific Ocean transitioning from neutral to El Niño during the early monsoon period, with

those conditions expected to persist through the season. During an El Niño event, waters in the western Pacific equatorial ocean warm.

The HKH region is described as "highly sensitive" to El Niño, as it strongly shapes the South Asian monsoon, which accounts for nearly 70-80% of the region's annual rainfall. Historically, El Niño conditions have suppressed monsoon rainfall across South Asia.

Compounding the picture, Northern Hemisphere snow cover was recorded slightly below normal during January-March 2026—a condition that is inversely linked to subsequent monsoon strength. Climate models also suggest the possible emergence of a positive Indian Ocean Dipole later in the season, which could partially offset El Niño's drying effect, though uncertainty remains.

The India Meteorological Department has already predicted below-par monsoon this year. Rising temperatures are also expected to accelerate glacier melt and snowmelt, driving short-term spikes in river discharge and heightening GLOF (glacial lake outburst flood) risk.

Case registered over 'disappearance' of 2 probe reports during BJD regime

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, June 10

A CASE was registered on Wednesday over "disappearance of two important inquiry commission reports" pertaining to the killing of Hindu seer Laxmananda Saraswati in 2008 and the 2016 fire incident at SUM medical college in which 22 people were killed.

The FIR was lodged at the Capital Police Station in Bhubaneswar against unknown person based on a complaint lodged by a joint secretary of the home department. Dates mentioned in the complaint indicates "serious lapses" during the previous BJD government.

The development came two days after Odisha Law Minister Prithiviraj Harichandan, in an interview to a local TV channel, stated that key in-

quiry commission reports went missing from the Chief Minister's Office when Naveen Patnaik was in office.

According to the complaint, the AS Naidu Commission Report with regard to the killing of Laxmananda Saraswati and his disciples by unknown miscreants at the former's Ashram at Jaleshpeta in Kandhamal district was sent to the CMO in September 2016. The incident triggered a communal clash in Kandhamal district in which at least 39 people were killed. Similarly, the inquiry report conducted by Revenue Divisional Commissioner into SUM hospital fire was sent to the CMO in May 2018.

"Recently, the Home Department learnt that the aforesaid two Judicial Commission Reports are not available in the CMO and remain untraceable

despite searches undertaken by the concerned authorities," read the complaint lodged by Sarat Chandra Marandi, joint secretary, home department.

The complainant stated that while several other reports and files, which had been forwarded by the home department to the CMO, were returned on June 4, 2024—the date on which results for the Assembly elections were announced—these two inquiry reports were not returned.

"The circumstances surrounding the disappearance of these two reports, particularly when other files forwarding during the same period were returned, create a reasonable suspicion that the reports may have been intentionally removed, retained, concealed, destroyed or otherwise unlawfully dealt with," read the complaint.

Day after Jaipur fire, 9 policemen suspended

Parul Kulshrestha
Jaipur, June 10

A DAY after a massive fire at an illegal firecracker factory in Jaipur's Kho Nagoriyan area claimed eight lives, Jaipur Police Commissioner Sachin Mittal suspended seven more cops for negligence and ordered a detailed probe into the incident. This takes the total number of policemen suspended in the case to nine.

The action follows a preliminary inquiry into the blaze that erupted at an illegally operated firecracker manufacturing unit in Javed Vihar Tuesday. Those suspended are Kho Nagorian SHO Omprakash Matwa, Head Constable Ashok, and constables Ramavatar, Dinesh, Asif, Harendra and Ashok. Earlier, police had suspended ASI Amar Singh and Head Constable Pappu Ram over the fire at the "illegal" fireworks unit.

**उपग्रह राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण**
उद्देश्य सिटी, गौरीपुराद्वारा | E-Mail: cd3@upsida.co.in
पूनाकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

एनएडएनए सुचित किया जाता है कि विभिन्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अनगणित विकास/अनुशासन कार्यों हेतु सरकारी विभागों/सार्वजनिक उद्यमों/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों/नगर निगमों में पंजीकृत फर्मों/उद्यमों से ई-निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं, जिसको आयोजित करने की समर्थता निम्नवत् है:-

निम्नलिखित निविदा दिनांक 11.06.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 01.07.2026 को अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक अपलॉड की जा सकती है, जिसे दिनांक 02.07.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11.00 बजे खोला जायेगा (पूर्वाह्नोत्तर)। निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल अप्रत्यक्ष की मूल प्रतियों निविदा प्रपत्रों में उल्लिखित दिनांक तक कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती हैं। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है:-

क्र.	कार्य का नाम	संभावित लागत (₹)
1.	Construction of Main Approach Road of Village Lufullapur Nawada at I.A. Trans Delhi Signature City, Ghaziabad	Rs. 68.09

नोट:- निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में समस्त कर सहित कर अंकित करें। जीएएसटी अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की [website: www.onlineupsidc.com](http://www.onlineupsidc.com) पर स्थित ई-लिंक एवं यूट्यूब चैनल की वेबसाइट <http://etenderup.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के प्रबंधक (सिस्टिम) के मोबाइल नं-9205691284 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है। **बरीक प्रकाश (सिस्टिम), अकाउंट्स/प्रोडिक्ट्स, सिस्टिम एंड, गौरीपुरा**

**झारखण्ड सरकार**
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
राष्ट्रीय उच्च पथ प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग
पी0टी0सी0 शाउण्ड के दक्षिण, हजारीबाग - 825301

फैक्स/फोन - 06546-222474
E-mail :- nhddivisionhazaribagh@gmail.com / eenbhazari-jhr@nic.in

TENDER CANCELLATION NOTICE
इस कार्यालय की अति-अत्यंतकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना - NH/HAZARIBAGH/ 2026-27/01 जो PR No. - 380812 Road (26-27)_D द्वारा दिनांक 27.05.2026 को विभिन्न समाचार पत्रों में प्रकाशित है, को अपरिहार्य कारणवश निरस्त किया जाता है।
कार्यपालक अभियंता
राउण्ड पथ प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग
PR 382006 Road (26-27)_D

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE No. 18/2026-2027 Dated: 10/06/2026
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system
Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi - 110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items :-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	01261151	OUT GOING CABLE LEAD (LEAD WIRES FOR BRUSH GRG CONNECTOR	102 NOS	29-06-26
02	08260023A	LMLA 2V-80AH	10990 NOS	06-07-26
03	09252508A	BACKING RING FOR UPGRADED CTRB	4040 NOS	06-07-26
04	19260864	SET OF CYLINDRICAL ROLLER BEARING (NDE SIDE)	211 NOS	08-07-26
05	08265282	ELB GATE BOOM	2500 NOS	14-07-26

Note : 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained. 1984/2026

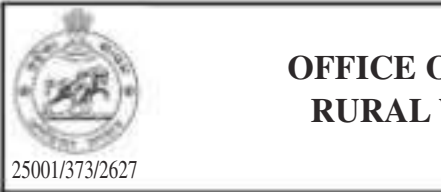
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**
No.: AGC-EL-C-T-01-2026-27 **Date: 09.06.2026**

TENDER NOTICE
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Const.), North Central Railway, Agra for and behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works.
Tender No.:- AGC-EL-C-T-01-2026-27
Name of work with its location:- Design, Supply, Erection, Testing and Commissioning of OHE Electrification Bateshwar (BASR) conversion of 'D' class station into 'B' Station in Agra Division of N.C. Railway.
Approx. Cost of the work:-Rs.2,39,81,603.24 | Bid Security:-4,79,600.00
Completion Period:- 06 Months from the date of issue of acceptance letter including monsoon period.
Tender closing date & time:- 01.07.2026 up to 15:00 hrs.
Validity of offer:- 60 days from the date of tender opening.
Tenderers can only submit their offer through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs on 01.07.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1315/26(ADM)

 North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE (Construction Department)
Open e-Tender is invited on Behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work :-
S. No.: 1, Name of the work with its location: Description: Removal of infringement of 800 KV HVDC transmission line between Tower no. 1806 to 1818 in Biswanath Charial, Assam-Agra comes in the alignment of proposed Ranginagar-Araria court section in Supaul-Araria Railway Electrification work. **e-Tender No. EL-C-N-MHX-ETEN-12MOD2-25-26, 2. Approx Cost of the work : 36,85,80,461.41, 3. Cost of Tender form : Rs. Nil, 4. Availability of Tender: On IREPS website: www.ireps.gov.in The above E-Tender, E-Tendering document along with full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in>**
Note: In case of any discrepancies found in tender notice, English version will be final. Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> at least 15 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum/corrections etc. in response to this E-Tender. 5. Earnest money to be deposited: As Per NIT, 6. Completion period of the work: 18 months, 7. Date and time for closing of tender: 22/06/2026 at 12.00 hrs.
Dy. CEE/Con/North/SPJ EC Rly, MHX, Patna
PRJ0374/CON SPJ/CONST/17/26-27/44

**GOVT. OF ODISHA**
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER RURAL WORKS DIVISION No-II, KEONJHAR
E-mail: eerw_kjr2@yahoo.com

"e" Procurement Notice for Road & Building Works
Identification No Online NCB - 01/2026-27

1. Name of the work	:	Road & Building Works
2. Total Number of Work	:	01 No. Building 04 Nos. Road
3. Estimated Cost	:	Rs. 50.00 Lakhs to 100.00 Lakhs
4. Class of Contractor	:	Only 'B' Class
5. Period of Completion	:	As per annexure of e-Procurement Notice No. 01/2026-27
6. Other details	:	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No.	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & Time of Opening of Tender in O/o S. E., R.W. Division-II, Keonjhar.	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
Executive Engineer, Rural Works Division-II, Keonjhar	Road & Building Online NCB No.01	01.07.2026 at 11:00 A.M.	01.07.2026 up to 5:00 P.M.	01.07.2026 up to 5:00 P.M.	01.07.2026 at 11:00 A.M.	Will be intimated later

● Further details can be seen from the Website www.tenderorissa.gov.in

sd/-

Executive Engineer

R.W.Divn.No-II, Keonjhar

OIPR- 25001/250931/26 -27/0002

**JHARKHAND BJLEE VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED**
(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
Regd. Office:- Engineering Building, HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesp.jseb@rediffmail.com / gmpsb.jbvn@rediffmail.com

Short E-Procurement Notice
JBVNL invites online short e-tender from reputed, technically experienced and financially sound manufacturers/ supplier only for procurement of following Materials :-

Sr	NIT/Tender notice No. and description of item	Tender fee	Date of publication of tender on website	Document download start date & time	Online Bid Submission start date	Online Bid Submission end date	Technical bid opening date and time
1	151/PR/JBVNL/2026-27 33 KV Metering Unit of different ratio (-/5A)	Rs 10000/- + GST	10/06/2026 from 13:00 Hrs.	10/06/2026 from 13:10 Hrs.	10/06/2026 from 13:20 Hrs.	23/06/2026 upto 18:00 Hrs.	24/06/2026 at 18: 00 Hrs.

NOTE:-

(i) Only e-tenders will be accepted. Further details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in> and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9470378503/ 9430348596, NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178

(ii) Tender fee & EMD must be paid through online mode.

(iii) Tender fee is non-refundable.

Sd/-

Dy. General Manager (Purchase)

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचाव। कृपया अपनी शिकयों को 18003456570(कॉल सेंटर) पर दर्ज करायें।

PR 382025 Jharkhand Biljee Vitran Nigam Ltd(26-27)D

epaper.indianexpress.com

Classifieds

PERSONAL

Nitesh Kumar, R/o Flat No: 602, A Block, Exocita East Square, Ahinsha Khand 2, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, Changed my daughter's name from Nandini Gupta to Vedika Gupta.

0130065639-1

It is for general information that I, OM PRAKASH Son of Gopal Ram, R/o BE-128, WZ-27, 3rd Floor, Hari Nagar, Maya Puri, S O South West Delhi-110064, declare that name of my minor son has been wrongly written as Anmol in my minor son ANMOL CHANDAUALLA aged 17 years in his Scheduled Caste / Scheduled Tribe Certificate S.NO: SC/3/33/24474/9/9/2014/90518 921209952. The actual name of my minor son is ANMOL CHANDAUALLA, which may be amended accordingly.

0071041325-1

I, hitherto known as SHYAM LAL ALIAS SAMUEL LALL, S/O- MOHAN LAL, R/O- F-23, B.K. DUTT- COLONY, LODHI-ROAD, NEW-DELHI-110003, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as SAMUEL LALL.

0040859838-8

I, hitherto known as Ashok Kumar Dohare, S/o- MEVA RAM, R/o- 12D MIG-FLATES, VIKASPUR- EXTN., POCKET- A, Tilak- Nagar, S/O, West- Delhi, Delhi-110018, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Ashok Kumar.

0040859838-9

I, VIKAS JHANJOT S/O SH. TEJPAL SINGH JHANJOT B-30, BLK-B, AYURVIGYAN NAGAR, DELHI-110049, inform that VIKAS JHANJOT, VIKASH and VIKASH KUMAR all the names belongs to one and same person.

0040859885-1

I, Sandeep Kumar Sharma, S/o of Sh. Santosh Kumar Sharma, R/o Shree Shyam Apartment, Upper, Gurgaon Road, Khasra. No.202, Plot No.1 & 2, Village- Burari, Delhi-84, declare that my and my father's name has been wrongly recorded as "Sandeep Kumar" and Sh. Santosh Kumar in my Class-10th Marksheets, whereas my and my father's correct and full name in all other documents are "Sandeep Kumar Sharma" and "Santosh Kumar Sharma" Respectively. That will be amended accordingly, for all legal official and administrative purposes.

0040859838-11

I, Sagar Srivastav, S/o Vinod Srivastav, R/o- Flat No-14131 Tower- Chestnut Mahagun Mywoods Gaur City-2 Gautam Budh, Nagar-201306, Have Changed My Name To Sagar Srivastava.

0040859867-3

I, SUSHMA W/O SANJAY PANCHAL, R/O 854/72, GANDHI NAGAR, GUARGON, (HARYANA)- 122001, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUSHMA PANCHAL FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0040859862-12

I, TAVGUN SINGH, S/O- DALBIR SINGH, R/O 1562 OUTRAM LINES GTB NAGAR DELHI-110009 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO TAVGUN SINGH MOKHA.

0040859838-2

I, SUPREET TANEJA W/O BALJEET SINGH R/O 1562 OUTRAM LINES GTB NAGAR DELHI-110009 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SUPREET KAUR.

0040859838-3

I, SAURABH CHAUDHARY, S/O UDAVVEER SINGH, R/O H.NO.B-24, RAMPURI, GHAZIABAD, UP-201011, have changed my minor son's name from AGASTYA NAIN to ABHINAV CHAUDHARY, permanently.

0040859867-2

I, SANTOSH, W/o-Late Vinod Kumar, R/o- CGH-225, 22nd-Floor, DLF-Capital Greens Midtown, 15-Shivaji Marg, Moti-Nagar, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to SANTOSH KUMARI.

0040859862-4

I, PINKI Kapoor, W/o- Rajesh Kapoor, R/O 212B, BC block, Shalimar Bagh, New Delhi-110088, hereby declare that Pinky Kapoor and Pinki Kapoor are one and the same-person.

0040859838-7

I, RAIES AHMAD, son of, ABDUL RASID, R/O- H.NO-2799 GALLI, NO-22B RAJIV GANDHI-NAGAR NEW MUSTAFABAD, NORTH EAST-DELHI-110094, have changed my name to HAFIZ RAHIS AHMED, for all purposes

0040859867-4

I, NAVEEN MANGI, S/O-LATE SH.DHARMVIR SINGH ALIAS DHARMVIR MANGI, R/O WZ-91, RAM-NAGAR EXTENSION, CHOWKHANDI, TILAK-NAGAR, DELHI-110018, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES TO NAVIN MANGI.

0040859838-1

I, NAINDI D/O MUNNI LAL JAIN, R/O-33/69, 1ST FLOOR, AMBEDKAR-CAMP, BLOCK-32-33, TRILOK-PURI, CHILLA SARODA KHADAR EAST, DELHI-110091 Changed my name to NAINDI JAISWAL, for all future purposes.

0040859838-10

I, SHIV KUMAR TYAGI S/o LAKHMI CHAND TYAGI R/o NEAR BARAT GHAR, INDRAPURAM, MAKANPUR, DIST: GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH -201014 That both the names SHIV KUMAR and SHIV KUMAR TYAGI are one and same person.

0071041250-1

I, Mohammad Hamza Mirza, S/o- Nadeem Mirza, R/o- 1159 Gali Sunar Wali Kala Mahal Delhi, has changed my name to Hamza Mirza, for all purpose.

0040859862-8

I, MOHD NAUSHAD S/o MOHD YAMIN, R/O T-72, Alvi Chowk, Hazrat Nizamuddin, South Delhi, Delhi 110013, have changed my name to NOSHAD.

0040859867-5

I, MOHAMMED KAMALUDDIN, S/O-MOHAMMAD JAHUR, R/O-WARD-NO-16 MOHALLA-RAMNA SHERGHATI-GAYA BIHAR-824211, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO MOHAMMAD KAMALUDDIN FOR FUTURE.

0040859838-6

I, INDER VERMA, S/O-MOOL CHAND VERMA, R/O-3/5, PANT NAGAR, JANGPURA EXTENSION, NEW DELHI-110014, have changed my name from INDER VERMA to INDER KUMAR VERMA, for all purposes.

0040859862-6

I, Himanshu Kumar, resident of, Smq No.19/103, Tejas-Enclave, Air-Force Station Sohna-Road, Gurugram-122001, have changed my daughter's name from Shreeya Singh to Shreya Singh, vide-Affidavit, dated-10/6/2026.

0040859838-12

I, Faisal S/o Salauddin, R/o-2602 Shankar Gali Bazar Sitaram Delhi, has changed my name to Mohammad Faisal, for all purpose.

0040859862-9

I, Deepak Kumar Srivastava, S/o- Rampadarath Srivastava, R/o- H.No. 524A, Gali No.-2, Patel Park, Linepar, Bahadurgarh-Distt-Jhajjar (Haryana), have changed the name of my Minor Son Uday Raj Srivastava aged-09-years and He shall hereafter be known Udayraj Srivastava.

0040859862-11

I, Pankaj Goyal, S/O- Devendra Kumar Goyal, R/O- Flat No.D-204, True-Friends Apartment, Plot No.29, Sector-6, Dwarka, Amberhal, Southwes t Delhi, Delhi-110075, have changed my name to Pankaj Goyal for all purpose.

0040859838-5

I, Deepak Kumar Srivastava, S/o- Rampadarath Srivastava, R/o- H.No. 524A, Gali No.-2, Patel Park, Linepar, Bahadurgarh, Distt-Jhajjar (Haryana), have changed the name of my Minor Daughter Bhoaya aged-06-years and she shall hereafter be known Dhwaniishi.

0040859862-10

I, BEAUTY VACA, D/o CMPO VACA, R/O KHASRA.NO.168, A-1, BLOCK, FREEDOM FIGHTERS ENCLAVE, NEB SARAI, SAKET, NEW DELHI-110068, declare that BEAUTY and BEAUTY VACA, both names are same person.

0040859867-7

I, BACHU SINGH S/O SOHANPAL FRAJAPATI R/O F77 77A 4TH FLOOR F-BLOCK JAWAHAR PARK, DELHI-110080, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO BACCHU SINGH.

0040859867-1

I, Asha Rani Taneja D/o- Lachman Dass Taneja W/o Vijay Kumar Bathla, R/o HO121 Sec-21d, Faridabad, Haryana changed name to Asha Bathla vide. affidavit dtd 09/06/2026 Notary AR Muneer Ahmed, Bangalore.

0040859861-4

I, Ankit Mehal S/o Dharam Pal R/o-6A GF Shanti Kunj, Vasant Kunj Delhi-110070, have changed my name to ANKIT MEHLAWAT

0040859862-5

I, Ameen S/o- Mohammad Faisal, R/o-2602, Shankar Gali Bazar Sitaram Delhi, has changed my name to Mohammed Ameen, for all purpose.

0040859862-7

I, Ambika Devi, W/O-Diwakar Dutta Semwal, R/O Flat No 16-B, Ujwal Apartment, Vikas puri, New Delhi-110018, Have changed my name to Ambika Semwal, for all future purposes.

0040859862-3

I, ARVIND SINGH, R/O 244/73, SCHOOL BLOCK, JAIN VATIKA SCHOOL, MANDWALI FAZALPUR, PO:- LAXMI NAGAR, DIST:- EAST DELHI, DELHI-110092, inform that ARVIND SINGH and ARVIND, both names are same person.

0040859867-6

I, AISHA PARVEEN, W/O MERAJ KHALID, R/O- R-210/4, T.F, GALI NO-9, RAMESH PARK LAXMI NAGAR DELHI-110092, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO AISHA PERWEEN FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040859838-4

I, hitherto known as DINESH S/o OM DUTT SHARMA R/o 801/T-12 Maxcity Park Sapphire, Ramprastha Greens, Near Vaishali Metro Station, Sector-9 Vaishali, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201010, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as DINESH SHARMA.

0071041272-1

I, VIVEK SHARMA S/o SHIV DAYAL SHARMA R/o WZ-997, NANGAL RAYA NEW DELHI, SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI, 110046 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO VIVEK VASHISTH FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0071041249-1

I, VENU GOPAL S/o VINEET KUMAR GUPTA, R/o Bn 102 west shalimar bagh, new delhi 110088, have changed my name to VENU GOPAL GUPTA

0071041238-1

I, Charu Singh Pawar, W/o Sushant Singh Pawar, R/o Flat No. D-1302, Stellar Jeevan G-03, Sector-1, Greater Noida West, Bisrakh, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201306, have changed my name to Charu Sachar and shall hereafter be known as Charu Sachar for all purposes.

0040859745-1

I, Seema Devi, Wife of Shri Pawan Kumar, R/O B-27-A, New No. C-4/5, Vashisht Park, West Sagar Pur, South West Delhi, Delhi-110046, declare that my son's name in School document mentioned as P S GANESH, has changed to AARAV KUMAR for all future purposes.

0040859742-1

I, Seela Devi W/o No 6317500X Rank Ex SIGMN (Late) Surendra Singh R/O A-105, Block-A, Prem Nagar -3, Kirari Suleman Nagar, Delhi- 110086 have changed my name to Sheela Devi vide affidavit date 9-6-26 before Delhi.

0071041248-1

I, ANJU RANI, W/O-TUSHAR SAXENA, R/O- FLAT, NO.B-502, APEX ALPHABET SECTOR-1 GREATER NOIDA WEST G.B.NAGAR 201306, U.P. HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO ANJU SHARMA, FOR ALL THE PURPOSES.

0040859862-1

I, Sanjit Bhandari S/o Phani Bhushan Bhandari R/O-101, Plot-4/454, Sec-4, Vaishali, Ghaziabad have changed my name to Sanjit Kumar Bhandari.

0071041232-1

I, Roopa, W/o Ajay Kumar, R/o B-187, Sector-3, Phase-3, J.J. Colony, Pappan Kalan, Dwarka, Delhi-110078, have corrected/updated my name to Rupa, for all purposes.

0040859746-1

I, Ramesh Kumar S/o Balbir Singh, R/o H No. 1073, Sector-17, VTC : Old Faridabad, PO: Old Faridabad, District: Faridabad, State: Haryana-121002, have changed my name to Ramesh Chauhan.

0071041264-1

I, Raj Kumar Singh S/o Ajmer Singh R/o Jholu Tola, Sidhi, Madhya Pradesh- 486661, have changed my minor son's name from Satyam Singh Gond Aged 10 Years to Satyam Singh forever

0071041308-1

I, Radhey Shyam, S/o Ram Bilash, R/o-283, First-Floor, Bhera Enclave, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-110087, have changed my name to Radhey Shyam Garg, Permanently

0040859727-1

I, RAVINDER KUMAR S/O RAM PRASHAD R/O 4/24, GALI NUMBER-6, PREM NAGAR, NATHU PURA, DELHI-110084 HAVE CHANGED MY MINOR SON NAME FROM RATHOR TO RAGHAV KUMAR FOR ALL FUTURE PURPOSES.

0071041225-1

I, No.1483758L NK, 236 ENGR Regt., Tourangbam Manitomba (ex-service man), a resident of Salton Helyaikon, P.O. Moirang, P.S. Phougangchao Ikhal, District: Bishnupur, Manipur, do hereby affirm that the correct names of my daughter and son are T. Christina Devi and Tourangbam Leimsemba and their dates of birth are 24-02-2005 and 06-02-2010 respectively. The above names and dates of birth will be used in all future purposes.

0040859784-1

I, No-Sreeja Kumari, R. W/O-No-15695375L, Hav Nideesh G. In my Husband's service records my name has been wrongly mentioned as Sreeja Kumari instead of Sreeja Kumari R.a mentioned in Aadhaar Card. It needs correction. Objections be filled to concerned authorities within seven days.

0020515011-1

I, Nalli Prasanth Kumar S/o Pardha saradhi Nalli R/o 5-193, Samithi Road, Kotha Peta, East Godavari, Andhra Pradesh-533223, have changed my minor daughter's name from Nalli Phoebe Dayana aged 02 years to Nalli Dayana forever

0071041305-1

I, Mohd Yasin S/o Mohd Kamre Alam, R/O H.No. C-201, Chinyot Basti, Multani Danda, Pahar Ganj, New Delhi-110055, have changed my name to Yaseen Sheikh for all future purposes vide affidavit dated 08-06-2026.

0050291165-1

I, MEENA KUMARI, W/O ABHISHEK SINGH, R/O C 502, MICROTEK GREEN BURG, SECTOR 86 NAWADA FATEPUR (112), SIKANDER PUR GURGAON HARYANA-122004 have changed my name to MEENA SINGH for all future purposes

0071041262-1

I, LAKSHAY SHARMA S/o SHIV DHYAL SHARMA R/o WZ-997, GALI NO-3, NANGAL RAYA NEW DELHI, SOUTH WEST DELHI, DELHI, 110046 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO LAKSHAY VASHISTH FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0071041223-1

I, Jyotsna N/O, Anil Kumar R/o C-28, Opposite Prayag Hospital, Sector 49, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP have changed my name to Mary Jyotsna Minj for all purposes.

0040859748-1

I, Kehkasha W/o Tayyab Ali R/o-277, Near Hamja Masjid, Dadherukalan, Muzaffarnagar, UP have changed my name to Aasma Praveen.

0071041252-1

I, Joyce Singh, D/o Bahadur Singh, resident of Flat No.44, Kamayani Kunj, I.P. Extension, Patparganj, Delhi-110092, have changed my name to Joyce Chaturvedi for all future purposes.

0040859751-1

I, Harkirat Singh VEDI, S/o Jasvinder Singh VEDI, R/o-A-10/6, DLF-Alameda, Sector-73, Gurgaon, Haryana-122101, have to change my minor Daughter's name from Neymat Kaur VEDI to Neymat Kaur, Permanently

0040859727-3

I, AAKANKSHA SARDA, D/o KAILASH SARDA & W/o DUSHYANT VANAIK residing at F-106, GF, Sector 54, Suncity, Gurugram, Haryana-122011 have changed my name for all purposes to AAKANKSHA VANAIAK

0040859625-1

I, GEETANJALI, D/o- Jay Narayan, R/O B-1/7 205, Nitikhand-1, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201014, have changed my name to GEETANJALI CHAUDHARY.

0040859861-1

I, Bhavna D/o late Prithvi Raj, R/O H NO-9952/4, Multani Dhandha, Gali No-4, Pahar Ganj, Swami Ram Tirth Nagar S.O, Central Delhi, Delhi-110055, have changed my name to Bharti Vaid.

0071041256-1

I, Bebeeb Tyagi S/o Hasan Ali R/o 277, Dadheru Kulan, Muzaffarnagar, UP have changed my name to Habib Ahamad.

0071041254-1

I, Asme Tara W/o Nayyar Alam R/o Village Kaumari, Jhaau, Katihar, Bihar have changed my name to Asametara.

0071041231-1

I, Anureet Kaur VEDI, W/o Harkirat Singh VEDI, R/o-A-10/6, DLF-Alameda, Sector-73, Gurgaon, Haryana-122101, have changed my name to Anureet Kaur, Permanently

0040859727-2

I, Akhil Rewsal, S/o Dhan Singh, R/O H.No.438, Aali Village, Sarita Vihar, New Delhi-110076, hereby declare that my father's name is mentioned as "Dhan Singh Rewsal" in my Class 10th Mark Sheet, whereas in all other documents it is mentioned as "Dhan Singh". Both names refer to the same person. Therefore, my father's name may be treated and read as "Dhan Singh" for all purposes.

0040859757-1

I hitherto known as Arjun S/o Suresh Kumar, R/o C-28, Sawan Park, Ashok Vihar Phase-3, Ashok Vihar, Delhi-52, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Payare Lal. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

0040859768-1

I Ram Dhruv S/o Brij Lal R/O CN-271, T-Huts, Sonia Camp, BG-6, Paschim Vihar, Delhi-110063, have changed my name to Dhruv Kumar.

0071041247-1

I Lokesh Bucha S/O Akash Bucha R/O of 10B Krishna Nagar Near Jeet restaurant Delhi-110051 have changed my name to Lokesh Buchaa.

0050291125-1

I Ashish Mittal S/O, Shri Sudhir Mittal R/o 243 Sainik Vihar Pitampura 110034 have chnged my name to Ashiesh Mittal.

0040859596-1

I Jitendra kumar S/O Nagendar prasad Shahi R/O Chipanya Khurd Tigri Yusufpur Chak Sahaberi Near Shiv Mandir Gautambudh Nagar UP Have Changed My Name To Jitendra Kumar Shahi

0040859861-2

LOST & FOUND

IT is hereby Notified We Maitrayee Jha and Captain Arinajya Singh R/O B-805, Satyam Apartments, Sector-18A, Dwarka, Delhi, have lost property documents (BBA) Certificate no.- G0P205G3740 GR N.O. 136782349, A-294, Second Floor, JMS Realty, Sector- 95, Gurgaon.

0040859698-1

EDUCATION

EDUCATIONAL

LECHER Antenna Cosmic Energy 2 Days Global Standard training, 27th Batch, Will be conducted on behalf of School of Indian Dowser's & Geomancy at Dadar, in Mumbai on 20 & 21 June. In all Workshops including site visit Vastu Energy & Land Testing, Guiltiness, Health, Geopathic Stress, Harmful Water, Wide Highest Curriculum & Dowsing Workshop on Online Zoom in July Batch 214, Hindi, Marathi or English Literature will be delivered at home. Workshop for two Sundays between 9.30 a.m. to 02.00 p.m. Call, Registration & bank payment through Mobile. For more information visit Website: https://www.indiadowser.s.org & Youtube Channel: On Dowser's Diary four videos. Contact: Ravi Vaidya Sir, Principal Dowser, Mobile: 9821349038/9821380289.

0071040604-3

PUBLIC NOTICE

IT IS HEREBY NOTIFIED THAT MY CLIENT MRS. SHUKLA ARORA, W/o DR. PREM NATH ARORA, R/O HELGA VANKES VIE KE, 1281 OSL, NORWAY ENTERED INTO A SALE DEED WITH RESPECT TO THE FIRST FLOOR OF B-7 EXTN/ 112C, SAFADRIKAR ENCLAVE, NEW DELHI-110029. (THE SAID PROPERTY) WITH MRS. GURSHARAN PAWAR ON 08.10.2025. THE SAID PERSON HAS HOWEVER DECEITED TDS FROM THE SALE CONSIDERATION BUT HAS FAILED TO DEPOSIT THE SAME WITH THE GOVERNMENT AND ARE NOW TRYING TO WRIGGLE OUT OF THE SAME. AND MY CLIENT IS IN THE PROCESS OF TAKING ALL APPROPRIATE LEGAL ACTIONS INCLUDING CIVIL AND CRIMINAL AS PERMISSIBLE. THEREFORE NO PERSON/ BANK/ FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS/ ORGANIZATION/ SEMI GOVT. AGENCY ETC. MAY DEAL WITH THE SAID PROPERTY IN ANY MANNER WHATSOEVER BY WAY OF SALE, MORTGAGE, GIFT OR TRANSFER OR POWER OF ATTORNEY, LEASE, ETC. IF ANY PERSON/ BANK/ FINANCIAL INSTITUTIONS/ ORGANIZATION/ GOVT/ SEMI GOVT. AGENCY ETC DOES SO THE SAME WILL BE AT HIS/ITS OWN RISK AND COST AND WILL BE LIABLE FOR ANY LOSS OR DAMAGE IF ANY, SO CAUSED AT HIS/ ITS OWN PERIL. AND MY CLIENT WILL NOT BE RESPONSIBLE FOR ANY SUCH ACT OR LEGAL CONSEQUENCES THEREOF. THEREFORE, THE GENERAL PUBLIC IS NOTIFIED ACCORDINGLY.

Sd/- (Mayank Bansal) Advocate

Ch.No.269, Civil Wings, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is for general information that I PUJA SIKANDER BARRAT D/O RAJ KUMAR SHRIVASTAVA and Ex W/O SIKANDER H. BARRAT residing at FLAT NO. B-603, BULLAND HEIGHTS, CROSSING REPUBLIK, GHAZIABAD, U.P. – 201016 declare that I got divorce from my husband vide Court Decree No. SMA No. 05/23 dated 27-04-2023. Further I have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as PUJA SHRIVASTAVA.

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that under instructions from and on behalf of my client Sanjeev Kumar, So Pal Kholbar R/o A-74, 3rd Floor, Ashok Vihar, Phase-III, Delhi-110052, has disowned/ debarred his daughter Minakshi Khokher D/o Sanjeev Kumar, R/o Flat No.12, Ground Floor, DA Flats, Block-A, Type-C, Near Max Hospital, Shalimar Bagh, Delhi-110088 due to her misbehavior, disobedient, from all of my client's movable & immovable assets & has also ceased all his relations in every respect with her. Any person whosoever deals with her shall do that entirely at his/her own risks, costs & responsibility & my client shall not be responsible for dealing with her if any person do so.

Kariti Gupta (Advocate)

Off: C-8, 534, Sector-8, Rohini, Delhi-110085

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public that our client is in the process of acquiring the immovable property more particularly described in the Schedule hereunder written (The Schedule Property) together with all structures standing thereon and all rights appurtenant thereto, from: 1. Mr. Himanshu Bhat, son of Late Shri Krishan Kumar Bathla; 2. Smt. Ashta Bathla, wife of Shri Ranwal Krishan; and 3. Mr. Pankaj Gambhir, son of Late Shri G.L. Gambhir, all presently residing at 7, Feroze Gandhi Road, Lajpat Nagar-III, New Delhi-110024 and claiming to be the sole and absolute owners of the Schedule Property.

Any person, bank, financial institution, company, authority or other entity having any right, title, interest, claim, demand or objection whatsoever in respect of the Schedule Property or any part thereof, whether by way of sale,